A Concise PUBLIC SPEAKING HANDBOOK

SIXTH EDITION



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Sixth Edition

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Preface

This sixth edition of *A Concise Public Speaking Handbook* integrates the steps in preparing and delivering a speech with the ongoing process of considering the audience. Although developed and delivered by the speaker, a good speech is centered on the needs, values, and hopes of the audience. Therefore, the speaker should keep the audience in mind during every step of the speech crafting and delivery process. Being "audience-centered" means that, as a speaker, you are constantly aware of and striving to adapt to the cultural, gender, and experiential diversity of the people to whom you are speaking. Adapting to diverse audiences is incorporated into every step of the audience-centered approach.

A Concise Public Speaking Handbook, sixth edition, also emphasizes that an effective speaker is an ethical speaker. Ethical speakers articulate truthful messages, formulated to give the audience free choice in responding to the message, while also using effective means of ensuring message clarity and credibility. In addition to emphasizing ethics throughout the text and in Chapter 4, "Ethics and Free Speech," we provide an Ethics Assessment question at the end of each chapter to spark thought and discussion on ethical issues in public speaking.

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Special Features for Public Speaking Students Revel offers students a whole new way to study the content and topics relevant to public speaking. Rather than simply offering opportunities to read about and study public speaking, Revel facilitates deep, engaging interactions with the concepts that matter most. For example, as part of our commitment to boosting students' communication confidence, our discussion of improving your confidence in Chapter 2 features the Personal Report of Public Speaking Anxiety. Students can take this assessment in the context of our chapter, get their score, and read about how to improve their own level of confidence. In addition, students are presented with video examples throughout the text on topics such as improving listening skills, how technology has changed public speaking, audience analysis, primary sources, speech delivery, using presentation aids, the importance of speech preparation, and the fear of public speaking. By providing opportunities to read about and practice public speaking in tandem, Revel engages students directly and immediately, which leads to a better understanding of course material. A wealth of student and instructor resources and interactive materials can be found within Revel. Some of our favorites include the following:

- **Videos and Video Self-Checks**
  Video clips appear throughout the narrative to boost mastery, and many videos have correlating self-checks, enabling students to test their knowledge.
- **Interactive Figures**
  Interactive figures help students understand hard-to-grasp concepts through visualizations.
- **Audio Excerpts**
  Throughout the text, audio excerpts highlight effective speech examples. Students can listen to audio clips

while they read, bringing examples to life in a way that a printed text cannot. These audio examples reinforce learning and add dimension to the printed text.

- **Integrated Writing Opportunities**

  To help students connect chapter content with personal meaning, each chapter offers two varieties of writing exercises: the journal prompt, which elicits free-form, topic-specific responses addressing content at the module level, and the shared writing prompt, which encourages students to share and respond to each other's brief responses to high-interest topics in the chapter.

For more information about all the tools and resources in Revel and access to your own Revel account for *A Concise Public Speaking Handbook*, sixth edition, go to www.pearson.com/revel.

New to the Sixth Edition

- New and **expanded examples** throughout the text ensure that the examples are contemporary and useful for students.
- Updated **How To** boxes provide clear instructions for applying textbook concepts to real-life public speaking.
- Because the rapid growth of communication technology has changed the way we live and our interactions with people, we've added a new chapter on mediated public speaking. (This content was previously covered in an online appendix.) We have also incorporated mediated public speaking topics throughout the text.
- Chapter 2 (*Improving Your Confidence*) and Chapter 18 (*Verbal Communication*) include new research on the benefits of using virtual reality technology when rehearsing a speech.
- Figure 3.1 has been redesigned to more clearly indicate how considering the audience is at the center of the model of the speechmaking process.

- In our discussion on the ethical limitations to free speech in Chapter 4 (*Ethics and Free Speech*), we have added new examples on the Black Lives Matter and #MeToo movements, as well as on the spread of misleading and false information during the COVID-19 pandemic. The sample oral citation box has been updated with a new example about Naloxone, a drug used to treat opioid overdoses.
- New research has also been added to Chapter 5 (*Listening*) on the benefits of taking notes longhand compared to on a computer.
- Coverage of sex and gender, ethnicity and race, and culture has been updated and revised in Chapter 6 (*Analyzing Your Audience*).
- Section 7.4 (*Adapt to Diverse Listeners*) has been significantly revised and updated with new strategies for capturing the attention of diverse audience members.
- We've added a definition of the term "fake news" in our discussion of evaluating internet resources in Chapter 9 (*Gathering Supporting Material*).
- In Chapter 11 (*Organizing Your Speech*) we have updated our discussion of cultural differences in organization to remind students that speakers from other cultures may use organizational strategies different from those presented in our text.
- A new example about COVID-19 has been added to our explanation of crisis rhetoric in Chapter 15 (*Using Words Well*).
- Our discussion about pronunciation in Chapter 18 (*Verbal Communication*) now emphasizes that standard pronunciation does not reflect the expectations of all listeners and that *different* does not mean *wrong*. Built-in microphones are now included in our discussion of microphones.
- Chapter 20 (*Selecting Presentation Aids*) features a new discussion on flowcharts and how they can be used to graphically illustrate a step-by-step process

or sequence of events. The chapter also explains how storyboards can be used to plan visual messages.

- We've added suggestions on how to demystify complex processes by using comparisons or vivid, descriptive word pictures in Chapter 22 (*Informative Speaking*).
- In Chapter 24 (*Using Persuasive Strategies*), we've added a description of the Toulmin Model of Argument. Our discussion of faulty reasoning contains new material on the slippery slope fallacy.
- Chapter 26 (*Speaking in Small Groups*) has been streamlined for clarity and to eliminate repetitive topics.

Every chapter contains a number of effective, pedagogical features, including:

- **Learning Objectives** at the beginning of every chapter provide a preview of chapter content and help students focus their study. Objectives are also repeated at the start of every section.
- **Quick Checks** list items that can be checked off as each step in the process of preparing a speech is completed.
- **How To** boxes provide clear instructions for applying textbook concepts to real-life public speaking.
- **Study Guides** at the end of each chapter summarize chapter content that reinforces the learning objectives listed at the beginning of the chapter. Each end-of-chapter Study Guide also includes (1) Self-Assessment questions to help readers evaluate how prepared they are to apply the chapter material in their own speeches; (2) Ethics Assessment questions to encourage consideration of ethical issues; and (3) Critical Assessment questions that provide a variety of speechmaking scenarios to help students think critically and further apply chapter concepts.

Strategies to Improve Speaker Confidence

To help students manage the anxiety they may experience when they think about speaking to an audience,

an entire chapter (Chapter 2) is devoted to improving speaker confidence. Techniques for managing speaker apprehension, such as how to look for positive listener support when delivering a message, are also included throughout the text.

Critical Listening Skills

Besides learning how to speak in public, one of the most valued benefits of studying public speaking is becoming a more discriminating listener. A section on listening, critical thinking, and analyzing and evaluating speeches helps students better understand their roles as speakers and listeners, and Critical Assessment questions at the ends of chapters offer further critical thinking, listening, and analysis opportunities.

Instructor and Student Resources

Key instructor resources include an Instructor's Manual, Test Bank, and PowerPoint™ Presentation Package available at www.pearsonhighered.com (instructor login required). MyTest online test-generating software is available at www.pearsonmytest.com (instructor login required). For a complete list of the instructor and student resources available with the text, please visit the Pearson Communication catalog, at www.pearsonhighered.com/communication.

Shared Media

Share, assign, and assess a variety of media easily and meaningfully with Shared Media and Video Quiz assignments in Revel. Shared Media assignments allow instructors and students to comment on videos and other media, including recorded public speaking performances, and assess them using instructor and peer review rubrics. Robust privacy settings ensure that student videos are uploaded and managed in a secure learning environment. Video Quiz assignments make a typically passive activity into an active learning experience. Set up time-stamped questions on video

assignments to ensure students are really engaged with and mastering concepts.

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PART 1
Introduction



SPEAKING IN PUBLIC

OBJECTIVES

- **1.1** Explain why it is important to study public speaking.
- **1.2** Discuss in brief the history of public speaking.
- **1.3** Sketch and explain a model that illustrates the components and the process of communication.

WHY STUDY PUBLIC SPEAKING?

1.1 Explain why it is important to study public speaking.

As you study **public speaking**, you will learn and practice strategies for effective delivery and critical listening. You will discover new applications for skills you may already have, such as focusing and organizing ideas and gathering information from print and electronic sources. In addition to learning and applying these fundamental skills, you will gain long-term advantages related to *empowerment* and *employment*.

The ability to speak with competence and confidence will provide **empowerment**. It will give you an edge that less-skilled communicators lack—even those who may have superior ideas, training, or experience.

Perhaps an even more compelling reason to study public speaking is that the skills you develop may someday help you get a job. In a nationwide survey, prospective employers of college graduates said they seek candidates with "public speaking and presentation ability."[1] Surveys of personnel managers, both in the United States and internationally, have consistently confirmed that they consider communication skills, including public speaking skills, *the top factor* in helping graduating college students obtain employment.[2]

THE RICH HERITAGE OF PUBLIC SPEAKING

1.2 Discuss in brief the history of public speaking.

When you study public speaking, you are also joining a long history with many traditions, including the following:

- **Fourth to first centuries BCE.** During this golden age of public speaking, the Greek philosopher Aristotle formulated, and Roman orators refined, guidelines for speakers that we still follow today.
- **Nineteenth century.** Students of public speaking practiced the arts of **declamation**—the delivery of an already famous address—and **elocution**—the expression of emotion through posture, movement, gestures, facial expression, and voice.
- **Twentieth and twenty-first centuries.** Audio, video, computer, and mobile technologies let speakers reach worldwide audiences and expand the parameters of public speaking, as they draw on age-old public speaking traditions to address some of the most difficult challenges in history.

THE COMMUNICATION PROCESS

1.3 Sketch and explain a model that illustrates the components and the process of communication.

Even the earliest communication theorists recognized that communication is a process. The models they formulated were linear, suggesting a simple transfer of meaning from sender to receiver. More recently, theorists have created models that better demonstrate the complexity of the communication process.

Communication as Action

- A public speaker is a **source** of information and ideas for an audience.
- The job of the source or speaker is to **encode**, or translate, the ideas and images in their mind into a

code, made up of verbal or nonverbal symbols, that an audience can recognize. The speaker may encode into words (e.g., "The fabric should be two inches square") or into gestures (showing the size with their hands).

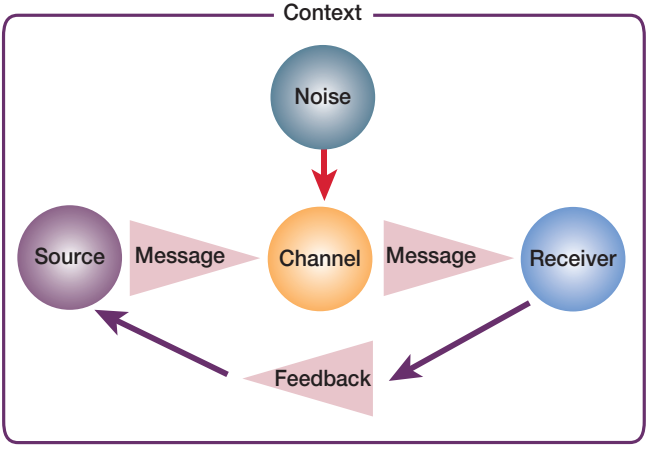
- The **message** in public speaking is the speech itself—both what is said and how it is said.
- If a speaker has trouble finding words to convey their ideas or sends contradictory nonverbal symbols, listeners may not be able to **decode** the speaker's verbal and nonverbal symbols back into a message.
- A message is usually transmitted from sender to receiver via two **channels**: *visual* and *auditory*. Audience members see and decode the speaker's nonverbal symbols—eye contact (or lack of it), facial expressions, posture, gestures, and dress. If the speaker uses any visual aids, such as PowerPoint slides or models, these too are transmitted along the visual channel. The auditory channel opens as the speaker speaks. Then the audience members hear words and such vocal cues as inflection, rate, and voice quality.
- The **receiver** of the message is the individual audience member, whose decoding of the message will depend on their own particular blend of past experiences, attitudes, beliefs, and values. An effective public speaker should be receiver- or audience-centered.
- Anything that interferes with the communication of a message is called *noise*. A noisy air conditioner or incessant coughing is an example of **external noise**. **Internal noise** may stem from either *physiological* or *psychological* causes and may directly affect either the source or the receiver. A bad cold (physiological noise) may cloud a speaker's memory or subdue their delivery. An audience member who is worried about an upcoming exam (psychological noise) is unlikely to remember much of what the speaker says. Noise interferes with the transmission of a message.

Communication as Interaction

One way that public speaking differs from casual conversation is that the public speaker does most or all of the talking. But public speaking is still interactive. See Figure 1.1 for an interactive model of communication. Without an audience to hear and provide **feedback**, public speaking serves little purpose.

The **context** of a public speaking experience is the environment or situation in which the speech occurs. For example, if a room is hot, crowded, or poorly lit, these conditions can affect both speaker and audience. In addition to the physical context, it's also important to consider the cultural context, which includes such elements as the speaker's and audience's cultural traditions and expectations. It can also include people's identification with groups and society, as well as their level of perceived power, influence, and social standing. These cultural elements affect with whom we communicate, and what may be perceived as appropriate or inappropriate communication based on cultural expectations and norms.

Figure 1.1 An Interactive Model of Communication.



Communication as Transaction

The most recent communication models focus on communication as a simultaneous process. For example, in a two-person communication transaction, both individuals are sending and receiving *at the same time*. In public speaking, listeners nonverbally express their thoughts and feelings at the same time the speaker is talking.

Public Speaking and Conversation

Models of communication suggest that public speaking has much in common with conversation. Public speaking also differs from conversation in the following key ways.

Public Speaking Requires More Pvparation Public speaking is more planned than conversation. A public speaker might spend hours or even days planning and practicing their speech.

Public Speaking Is More Formal A public speaker's delivery is more formal than the way most people engage in ordinary conversation. The slang or casual language we often use in conversation is usually not appropriate for most public speaking. Audiences expect speakers to use standard English grammar and vocabulary.

Public Speaking Involves More Clearly Defined Roles for Speaker and Audience Public speaking is more structured and less interactive than conversation. People in conversation may alternately talk and listen and perhaps even interrupt one another, but in public speaking, the roles of speaker and audience are more clearly defined and remain stable. Rarely do audience members interrupt or talk back to speakers.



Respond to Audience Messages

When you have a conversation, you have to make decisions "on your feet." For example, if your friends look puzzled or interrupt with questions, you may need to explain your idea a second time. You can use the same audience-centered skills to help you become an effective and confident speaker. Pay attention to the nods, facial expressions, and murmurings of the audience. Respond to those messages by adjusting your rate of speaking, volume, vocabulary, or other variables. As a bonus, focusing on the needs of your audience can keep you from focusing on any nervousness you might be feeling.

QUICK CHECK

Become an Effective Public Speaker

- Plan your speech.
- Focus and vocalize your thoughts.
- Adapt your speaking to your listeners.
- Use standard English vocabulary and grammar.
- Use more formal nonverbal communication.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

1.1 Explain why it is important to study public speaking.

Public speaking can empower you and help you secure employment or advance your career.

1.2 Discuss in brief the history of public speaking.

Speakers today use many technologies to deliver speeches, but rely on guidelines formulated more than two thousand years ago in ancient Greece and Rome.

1.3 Sketch and explain a model that illustrates the components and the process of communication.

Public speaking is an example of the communication process, by which a source transmits a message through a channel to a receiver within a particular context. Senders and receivers simultaneously exchange messages and feedback to build a shared meaning. Public speaking is more formal and planned, with clearly defined roles, than conversation.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** As you begin a course in public speaking, take stock of your general skill and experience as a speaker. Write a summary of your current perception of yourself as a speaker, including strengths and areas for development. At the end of the course, revise what you have written to assess how you have improved.
2. **Ethics Assessment** *Declamation* is defined as "the delivery of an already famous address." Is it ethical to deliver a speech that was written or already delivered by someone else? Explain your answer.
3. **Critical Assessment** Reflect on the most recent public speaking situation in which you were an audience member. Identify the specific elements in the communication model presented in Figure 1.1. Which elements of the model explain the speaker's effectiveness? (For example, the message was interesting and there was little noise.) If the speaker was ineffective, which elements in the model explain why the speaker was ineffective?



IMPROVING YOUR CONFIDENCE

OBJECTIVES

2.1 Explain the reasons for and processes involved in nervousness about public speaking.

2.2 Describe effective strategies for building public speaking confidence.

UNDERSTANDING YOUR NERVOUSNESS

2.1 Explain the reasons for and processes involved in nervousness about public speaking.

It's *normal* to be nervous about giving a speech. Research continues to confirm that most people are apprehensive about giving a speech.[1] More than 80 percent of people report feeling anxious about public speaking,[2] and one in five college students feels "highly apprehensive" about speaking in front of others.[3] In one classic survey, respondents said that they were more afraid of public speaking than of death![4]

Even if your anxiety is not overwhelming, you can benefit from learning some positive approaches that allow your nervousness to work *for you*.[5]

Know Your Reasons for Anxiety

Understanding why you and many others may experience apprehension can give you insights into how to better address your anxiety.[6] One study found several reasons people feel anxious about public speaking: fear of humiliation, concern about not being prepared, worry about their appearance, pressure to perform, personal insecurity, concern that the audience won't be interested in them or the speech, lack of experience, fear of making mistakes, and

an overall fear of failure.[7] There is also evidence that being a perfectionist may be linked to increased apprehension.[8]

Additionally, some people may have inherited a trait, or genetic tendency, to feel more anxiety than others would in any speechmaking situation.[9] Even if you have a biological tendency to feel nervous, you can use strategies to help manage your apprehension.[10]

Use Your Anxiety

Begin by realizing that you are going to feel more nervous than you look. Your audience cannot see evidence of everything you feel. Nor are listeners likely to detect your nervousness from your voice.[11] If you worry that you are going to appear nervous to others, you may, in fact, increase your own internal symptoms of anxiety.[12]

Realize Your Body Is Helping You Although it may seem counterintuitive, your heightened state of readiness can help you speak better, especially if you view the public speaking event positively instead of negatively. Speakers who label their increased feelings of physiological arousal as "nervousness" are more likely to feel anxious and fearful, but the same physiological feelings could also be labeled as "enthusiasm" or "excitement."[13] So stay positive and allow your brain to give you some extra help. Don't let your initial anxiety convince you that you cannot speak effectively.

HOW TO BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

2.2 Describe effective strategies for building public speaking confidence.

There are several additional things you can do to help manage your nervousness and anxiety.

Know Your Audience

Learn as much about your audience as you can. The more you can anticipate the kind of reaction your listeners will have to your speech, the more comfortable you will be in delivering your message.[14]

Don't Procrastinate

People who feel more apprehensive about public speaking tend to put off working on their speeches, in contrast to those who feel less anxious.[15] The lack of thorough preparation often results in a poorer speech performance, which reinforces a speaker's perception that public speaking is difficult. Don't let fear freeze you into inaction. Prepare early.

Select an Appropriate Topic

You will feel less nervous if you talk about something with which you are familiar or in which you have a lot of interest. Your comfort with the subject of your speech will be reflected in your delivery.

Be Prepared

Being prepared means that you have researched your topic, developed a logically coherent outline, and practiced your speech several times before you deliver it.[16]

Be Organized

For many listeners, speeches should follow a logical outline pattern and have a clear beginning, middle, and end. Anxiety about a speech assignment decreases and confidence increases when you closely follow the directions and rules for developing a speech.[17]

Know Your Introduction and Conclusion

You are likely to feel the most anxious during the opening moments of your speech. Being familiar with your introduction will help you feel more comfortable about the entire speech.

If you know how you will end your speech, you will have a safe harbor in case you lose your place. If you

need to end your speech prematurely, a well-delivered conclusion can permit you to make a graceful exit.

Make Practice Real

Practice aloud. Stand up. Vividly imagine the room where you will give your speech, or consider rehearsing in the actual room. Picture what you will be wearing and what the audience will look like. If your speech is virtual, rehearse in front of your computer with the software you plan to use. If you plan to have someone record your speech, rehearse with that person.

Use Virtual Reality When You Rehearse

In addition to your imagination, consider using virtual reality (VR) technology to help you make your rehearsal even more realistic. Using Meta (Facebook's approach to virtual space), avatars, or other virtual reality technologies can help augment your rehearsal experience and diminish your nervousness.[18]

Breathe

Nervous speakers tend to take short, shallow breaths. Break that pattern: Take a few slow, deep breaths before you start speaking. Besides breathing deeply, try to relax your entire body.

Channel Your Nervous Energy

An adrenaline boost before speaking can make you jittery. Channel the energy, using tips from the How To box.

Visualize Your Success

Imagine yourself giving your speech. Picture yourself delivering your well-prepared opening remarks. Visualize yourself as a controlled, confident speaker. Imagine yourself calm and in command.



Dissipate Nervous Energy

- Take a leisurely walk or deep, calming breaths before you arrive at your speech location.
- While seated and waiting to speak, keep both feet on the floor and wiggle your toes.
- Gently (and without calling attention to yourself) grab the edge of your chair and squeeze it.
- Unobtrusively, lightly tense and release the muscles in your legs and arms.
- As you wait to be introduced, focus on remaining calm.
- Walk to the front of the room in a calm and collected manner. Or if you are giving a virtual talk while seated in front of your computer, center yourself with calm breathing then look directly into the camera lens.
- Take a moment to look for a friendly, supportive face before you begin.

Give Yourself a Mental Pep Talk

Replace any negative, anxious thoughts with positive messages, such as the following:

Negative Thought	Positive Self-Talk
I'm going to forget what I'm supposed to say.	I've practiced this speech many times. I've got notes to prompt me. If I forget or lose my place, no one will know I'm not following my outline.
So many people are looking at me.	I can do this! My listeners want me to do a good job. I'll seek out friendly faces when I feel nervous.

Look for Positive Support

Evidence suggests that if you think you see audience members looking critically at you or your message, you may feel more apprehensive and nervous when you speak.[19] Alternatively, when you are aware of positive

audience support, you will feel more confident and less nervous. One study found that speakers experienced less apprehension if they had a support group or a small "learning community" that provided positive feedback and reinforcement.[20] And when you are listening, be sure to support other speakers with your full attention.

Seek Speaking Opportunities

The more experience you gain as a public speaker, the less nervous you will feel.[21] As you develop a track record of successfully delivering speeches, you will have more confidence.[22]

Focus on What You Have Accomplished and Not on Your Fear

When you finish your speech, celebrate your accomplishment. Say to yourself, "I did it! I spoke and people listened." Don't replay your mental image of yourself as nervous and fearful. Instead, mentally replay your success in communicating with your listeners.[23]

QUICK CHECK

Build Your Confidence

- Prepare your speech early.
- Know your audience and select an appropriate topic.
- Be prepared and well-organized. Know your introduction and conclusion.
- Recreate the speech environment when you practice.
- Use deep-breathing techniques.
- Channel your nervous energy.
- Visualize your success.
- Give yourself a mental pep talk.
- Look for positive listener support.
- Seek speaking opportunities.
- After your speech, focus on your accomplishment and not on your fear.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

2.1 Explain the reasons for and processes involved in nervousness about public speaking.

Genetic traits, as well as several specific reasons, can cause anxiety. Physical symptoms, such as a racing heart, are signs your body is trying to support you. Speakers can also experience different types of anxiety.

2.2 Describe effective strategies for building public speaking confidence.

Manage your apprehension by being prepared and knowing your audience, imagining the speech environment when you rehearse, and using relaxation techniques, such as visualization, deep breathing, and focusing thoughts away from your fears.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Take a quiz, available at www.jamescmccroskey.com/measures/prca24.htm, to assess your level of communication apprehension. At the end of your public speaking class, reassess your level of communication apprehension to see if the course has had an effect on your overall level of communication apprehension.
2. **Ethics Assessment** Should speakers reveal to their audience that they are nervous?
3. **Critical Assessment** Mike Roberts, president of his fraternity, is nervous about his first report to the university academic council. What advice would you give him?

PRESENTING YOUR FIRST SPEECH



OBJECTIVES

- **3.1** Explain why it is important to be audience-centered during each step of the speechmaking process.
- **3.2** Select and narrow an appropriate topic for a speech.
- **3.3** Differentiate between a general speech purpose and a specific speech purpose.
- **3.4** Develop a sentence that captures the central idea of a speech.
- **3.5** Identify three strategies for generating the main ideas for a speech.
- **3.6** Describe several types of supporting material that could be used to support speech ideas.
- **3.7** Develop a speech with three main organizational parts—an introduction, a body, and a conclusion.
- **3.8** Identify successful strategies for rehearsing a speech.
- **3.9** Describe the essential elements of effective speech delivery.

CONSIDER YOUR AUDIENCE

3.1 Explain why it is important to be audience-centered during each step of the speechmaking process.

Although you have heard countless speeches, you may still have questions about how a speaker prepares and presents a speech. To help you begin, this chapter provides an overview of the steps and skills you need for your first speech. Those steps are diagrammed in Figure 3.1.

Considering your audience is at the center of the model because your audience influences the topic you choose and every step of the speechmaking process. Considering the audience is a continuous process rather than a step in preparing a speech.

Figure 3.1 This model of the speechmaking process emphasizes the importance of considering your audience as you work on each task in the process of designing and presenting a speech.



Being audience-centered involves making decisions about the content and style of your speech *before* you speak, based on knowledge of your audience's interests, needs, and values. If you learn new information about your audience at any point during the process of preparing your speech, you may need to revise your thinking or your material. It also means being sensitive to your audience's responses *during* the speech so that you can make appropriate adjustments.

To be effective, an audience-centered speaker also needs to understand, affirm, and adapt to diverse audiences. Most audiences reflect an array of ages and genders, as well as cultural and ethnic backgrounds. Being sensitive to your audience and adapting your message accordingly will serve you well not only when addressing listeners with backgrounds different from your own but also in all types of situations. Depending on who your

audience members are and what topics they are interested in, you will want to adjust your delivery style and possibly your topic, pattern of organization, and the examples you select.

SELECT AND NARROW YOUR TOPIC

3.2 Select and narrow an appropriate topic for a speech.

While keeping your audience foremost in mind, determine what you will talk about and how to limit your topic to fit the constraints of your speaking assignment.

You might be asked to speak about a specific subject. Often, though, the task of selecting and narrowing a topic will be yours. You may discover a topic by asking three standard questions:

1. Who is the audience?
2. What are my interests, talents, and experiences?
3. What is the occasion?

Give yourself plenty of time to select and narrow your topic. Don't wait until the last minute to ponder what you might talk about. *The amount of time you spend preparing for your speech is one of the best predictors of a good grade on your speech.*[1]

DETERMINE YOUR PURPOSE

3.3 Differentiate between a general speech purpose and a specific speech purpose.

Decide on both a general purpose and a specific purpose before you start the research process. There are three **general purposes** for giving speeches:

1. **To inform.** When you inform, you teach, define, illustrate, clarify, or elaborate on a topic. The primary objective of class lectures, seminars, and workshops is to inform.
2. **To persuade.** A speech to persuade seeks to change or reinforce listeners' attitudes, beliefs, values, or behavior.

TV and radio commercials, and pop-up ads on the internet; sermons; political speeches; and sales presentations are examples of messages designed to persuade.

3. **To entertain.** After-dinner speeches and comedic monologues are intended mainly as entertainment. The key to an effective, entertaining speech lies in your choice of stories, examples, and illustrations, as well as in your delivery.

After you are sure you understand your general purpose, formulate a **specific purpose**, which is a concise statement indicating what you want your listeners to be able to do, remember, or feel when you finish your speech. For example, "At the end of my speech, the audience will be able to identify three counseling facilities on campus and describe the best way to get help at each one."



Create and Use a Specific-Purpose Statement

- Always consider your audience.
- Start with the phrase *At the end of my speech, the audience will [be able to]…*
- Use an action verb like identify, list, describe, and explain to formulate a fine-tuned, audience-centered statement describing a behavior that can be observed and measured.
- Write down your specific purpose, and keep it before you as you read and gather ideas for your talk.
- Use your specific purpose to guide your research and help you choose supporting materials.
- Modify your purpose, if necessary, as you continue to work on your speech.

DEVELOP YOUR CENTRAL IDEA

3.4 Develop a sentence that captures the central idea of a speech.

You should now be able to write the **central idea** of your speech, sometimes called your *thesis statement*. Your

central idea identifies the essence of your message. Think of it as a one-sentence summary of your speech. If you met someone in the elevator after your speech, and this person asked you to summarize the speech as you traveled between floors, you would be stating your central idea. Here is an example:

Topic:	British TV shows that inspired American TV shows
General Purpose:	To inform
Specific Purpose:	At the end of my speech, the audience will be able to identify three classic British TV shows that inspired American versions.
Central Idea:	*The Office*, *Antiques Roadshow*, and *House of Cards* began as British TV programs that have become successful American TV shows.

GENERATE THE MAIN IDEAS

3.5 Identify three strategies for generating the main ideas for a speech.

Effective speakers are good thinkers; they know how to play with words and thoughts to develop their **main ideas**. The ancient Romans called this skill **invention**—the ability to develop or discover ideas that result in new insights or new approaches to old problems.

Once you have an appropriate topic, a specific purpose, and a well-worded central idea, your next task is to identify the major divisions of your speech or key points that you wish to develop. To determine how to subdivide your central idea into key points, ask these three questions:

1. *Does the central idea have logical divisions?* For example, if the central idea is "There are three ways to interpret the stock market page of your local newspaper or financial website," your speech can be organized

into three parts. You will simply identify the three ways to interpret stock market information and use each as a major point.

2. *Can you think of several reasons the central idea is true?* If, for example, your central idea is "New legislation is needed to ensure that US citizens' privacy is protected," each major point of your speech could be a reason why you think new privacy laws are needed.
3. *Can you support the central idea with a series of steps?* Suppose your central idea is "Running for a campus office is easy to do." Your speech could be developed around a series of steps, telling your listeners what to do first, second, and third to get elected.

Your time limit, topic, and the information gleaned from your research will determine how many major ideas will be in your speech. A three- to five-minute speech might have only two major ideas. For some short speeches, you may develop only one major idea with examples, illustrations, and other forms of support.

GATHER SUPPORTING MATERIAL

3.6 Describe several types of supporting material that could be used to support speech ideas.

With your main idea or ideas in mind, your next job is to gather **supporting material**—facts, examples, definitions, and quotations from others that illustrate, amplify, clarify, provide evidence, or tell a story. As you gather and prepare your supporting material, think about how you can connect stories, descriptions, facts, or statistics to the lives of your audience.

- Tell stories based on your own experiences, and help the audience see how the stories relate to them.

- Supporting material should be personal, concrete, and appeal to your listeners' senses. The more senses you trigger with words, the more interesting your talk will be.
- Relate abstract statistics to something tangible. It is easier for an audience to understand that a company sells 2.6 billion pounds of snack food each year if you also tell them that 2.6 billion pounds is triple the weight of the Empire State Building.[2]

You can find interesting and relevant supporting material by developing good research skills. Although it is important to have good ideas, it is equally important to know how to build on existing knowledge. To speak intelligently about a topic to an audience, you will probably need to do some research.

- Learn to use the various electronic databases your library subscribes to, your library's computerized catalog, an e-version of *Bartlett's Familiar Quotations*, and a wide assortment of internet indexes such as Google Scholar.
- Be on the lookout as you read, watch TV, stream content online, listen to podcasts, access social media, and search the internet for examples, illustrations, and quotations that could be used in a speech.

QUICK CHECK

Gather Effective Supporting Material

- Learn to research internet and library resources.
- Look for materials throughout your daily life.
- Relate materials to your audience.
- Tell stories and give vivid descriptions.
- Make statistics understandable.

ORGANIZE YOUR SPEECH

3.7 Develop a speech with three main organizational parts—an introduction, a body, and a conclusion.

A clearly and logically structured speech helps your audience remember what you say. A logical structure also helps you feel more in control of your speech, and greater control helps you feel more comfortable while delivering your message.

Divide Your Speech

Every well-prepared speech has three major divisions:

1. The introduction helps capture people's attention, serves as an overview of the speech, and provides the audience with reasons to listen to you.
2. The body presents the main content of your speech.
3. The conclusion summarizes your key ideas.

Because your introduction previews the body of your speech and your conclusion summarizes it, prepare your introduction and conclusion *after* you have carefully organized the body of your talk.

Outline Your Speech

If you have already generated your major ideas on the basis of logical divisions, reasons, or steps, you are well on your way to developing an outline.

Indicate your major ideas with Roman numerals. Use capital letters for your supporting points. Use Arabic numerals if you need to subdivide your ideas further.

Do not write your speech word for word. Writing and then reading or memorizing your speech will sound mechanical and less appealing to your audience. It may be useful, however, to use brief notes—written cues on note cards—instead of a complete manuscript. Increasingly, many speakers use handheld computer tablets or smartphones to display their speaking notes.

REHEARSE YOUR SPEECH

3.8 Identify successful strategies for rehearsing a speech.

A speech is a performance. As with any stage performance, be it music, dance, or theater, you need to rehearse. Rehearsing your speech is a way to measure your message so that you get it right when you present it to your audience. Consider the following rehearsal suggestions.

- Rehearse standing up if that's how you plan to deliver your speech. Make eye contact with your imaginary audience as often as you can. If your speech is virtual, practice with the camera and software you plan to use.
- Rehearse early. Spending time rehearsing your delivery well in advance of your speaking date will enhance the overall quality of your speech.[3]
- Speak loudly enough for all in the room to hear.
- If you are not sure what to do with your hands when you rehearse, just keep them at your side. Focus on your message, rather than worrying about how to gesture. If you plan to present your speech on camera, avoid using overly animated gestures or facial expressions.
- Don't memorize your speech. Rehearse just long enough so that you can discuss your ideas and supporting material without leaving out major parts of your speech.
- Rehearse your speech using the same notes you plan to use when presenting it.

The words you choose and your arrangement of those words make up the style of your speech. To be a good speaker, you must become familiar with the language your listeners are used to hearing, and you must know how to select the right word or phrase to communicate an idea.

DELIVER YOUR SPEECH

3.9 Describe the essential elements of effective speech delivery.

Delivery is the final step in the preparation process. Before you begin your presentation, look at your listeners to see if they are who you expected. Or do you need to make last-minute changes in your message to adjust to a different mix of audience members?

- When you are introduced, walk calmly and confidently to the front of the room. Or, if your speech is virtual, take a breath and then think calm and centering thoughts.
- Establish eye contact with your audience.
- Smile naturally.
- Deliver your attention-catching opening sentence.
- Concentrate on your message and your audience.
- Deliver your speech using a conversational tone.
- Deliver your speech just as you rehearsed it before your imaginary audience:

  Maintain eye contact.

  Speak loudly enough to be heard.

  Use some natural variation in pitch.
- Remember the advice of columnist Ann Landers: "Be sincere, be brief, and be seated."



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

3.1 Explain why it is important to be audience-centered during each step of the speechmaking process.

Your audience influences your topic selection and every aspect of presenting a speech.

3.2 Select and narrow an appropriate topic for a speech.

Answers to three questions can help you select and narrow your speech topic: Who is the audience? What are my interests, talents, and experiences? And what is the occasion?

3.3 Differentiate between a general speech purpose and a specific speech purpose.

Your general purpose is the overarching goal of your speech (to inform, persuade, entertain, or some combination of these purposes). Your specific purpose is a concise statement of what you want your listeners to be able to do when you finish your speech.

3.4 Develop a sentence that captures the central idea of a speech.

A central idea states the essence of your speech in a one-sentence summary.

3.5 Identify three strategies for generating the main ideas for a speech.

Virtually any speech can be organized by answering the following three questions: Does the central idea have logical divisions? Can you think of several reasons the central idea is true? Can you support the central idea with a series of steps?

3.6 Describe several types of supporting material that could be used to support speech ideas.

Supporting material consists of facts, examples, definitions, and quotations from others that illustrate, amplify, clarify, provide evidence, or tell a story. You can find supporting material through the internet, library resources, other people, or your daily life.

3.7 Develop a speech with three main organizational parts—an introduction, a body, and a conclusion.

Your introduction provides an overview of your main points, the body of your speech presents the key points, and the conclusion summarizes what you have said.

3.8 Identify successful strategies for rehearsing a speech.

Rehearse your speech several times in a way that recreates the actual speech presentation experience.

3.9 Describe the essential elements of effective speech delivery.

The essential aspects of effective delivery include good eye contact with your listeners, a voice that can be heard by all, and appropriate gestures and posture that seem natural.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Explain how you think your culture influences your expectations of a public speaker.
2. **Ethics Assessment** One of your friends took public speaking last year and still has a file of speech outlines. Is it ethical to use one of your friend's outlines as the basis for a speech you will deliver? Explain your answer.
3. **Critical Assessment** Shara is preparing to address the city council to tell its members about the Food for Friendship program they have organized in the neighborhood. What steps should Shara follow to prepare and deliver an effective speech?



ETHICS AND FREE SPEECH

OBJECTIVES

- **4.1** Describe the relationships among ethics, free speech, and credibility.
- **4.2** Explain how free speech has been both challenged and defended throughout US history.
- **4.3** List and explain five criteria for ethical public speaking.

ETHICS

4.1 Describe the relationships among ethics, free speech, and credibility.

Ethics are the beliefs, values, and moral principles by which people determine what is right or wrong. Ethics serve as criteria for many of the decisions we make in our personal and professional lives and also for our judgments of others' behavior.

Ethics and Free Speech

Although you are undoubtedly familiar with ethical issues, you may have given less thought to those that arise in public speaking. In a country where **free speech** is protected by law, the right to speak freely must be balanced by the responsibility to speak ethically.

Ethical considerations should guide every step of the public speaking process. The National Communication Association Credo for Communication Ethics emphasizes the essential role of ethics: "Ethical communication is fundamental to responsible thinking, decision making,

and the development of relationships and communities within and across contexts, cultures, channels, and media."[1]

Ethics and Speaker Credibility

Aristotle used the term *ethos*—the root word of *ethics* and *ethical*—to refer to a speaker's **credibility**, or believability. A credible speaker is one whom an audience perceives to be competent, knowledgeable, dynamic, and trustworthy. The last of those four factors—trustworthiness—is dependent in large part on the speaker's known consistent adherence to ethical principles.

THE HISTORY OF FREE AND ETHICAL SPEECH

4.2 Explain how free speech has been both challenged and defended throughout US history.

The history of the United States reflects our evolving thought on the ethical limitations to free speech:

1791 The **First Amendment** to the US Constitution guaranteed that "Congress shall make no law… abridging the freedom of speech."

1919 Supreme Court ruled that it was lawful to restrict speech that presented "a clear and present danger" to the nation. This led to the founding of the American Civil Liberties Union, the first organization formed to protect free speech.

1940 Congress declared it illegal to urge the violent overthrow of the federal government. However, for most of the last half of the twentieth century, the Supreme Court continued to protect rather than to limit free speech, upholding it as "the core aspect of democracy."[2]

1964 Supreme Court narrowed the definition of slander and ruled that before public officials can recover damages for slander, they must prove that the slanderous statement was made with "actual malice."[3]

1989 Supreme Court defended the burning of the US flag as a **"speech act"** protected by the First Amendment.

1997 Supreme Court struck down the federal Communications Decency Act of 1996 and ruled that "the interest in encouraging freedom of expression in a democratic society outweighs any theoretical but unproven benefit of censorship."[4]

2001 The September 11 terrorist attacks sparked passage of the Patriot Act and new debate over the balance between national security and free speech.[5]

2013 In the wake of the acquittal of the shooter of unarmed black teenager Treyvon Martin, Black Lives Matter gains traction in protesting racism and anti-Black brutality.

2017 The hashtag #MeToo becomes the slogan of a free speech movement for survivors of sexual harassment and assault.

2021 Amnesty International claims that social media platforms have contributed to the spread of false and misleading information during the COVID-19 pandemic.

SPEAKING ETHICALLY

4.3 List and explain five criteria for ethical public speaking.

As the boundaries of free speech expand, the importance of **ethical speech** increases. Although there is no definitive ethical creed for public speaking, teachers and practitioners generally agree that an ethical speaker is one who has a clear, responsible goal; uses sound evidence and reasoning; is sensitive to and tolerant of differences; acts honestly; and avoids plagiarism.

Have a Clear, Responsible Goal

The goal of a public speech should be clear to the audience. A socially responsible goal conveys respect and offers the listener choices, whereas an irresponsible, unethical goal is demeaning or psychologically coercive or oppressive.

If your overall objective is to inform or persuade, it is probably ethical; if your goal is to demean, coerce, or manipulate, it is unethical.

Use Sound Evidence and Reasoning

Ethical speakers use critical-thinking skills such as analysis and evaluation to formulate arguments and draw conclusions. Unethical speakers substitute false claims for evidence and logical arguments. It may sometimes be tempting to resort to false claims to gain power over others, but it is always unethical to do so.

One important requirement for the ethical use of evidence and reasoning is to share with your audience all information that might help them reach a sound decision, including information that may be potentially damaging to your case. Even if you proceed to refute the opposing evidence and arguments, you have fulfilled your ethical responsibility by presenting the perspective of the other side.

Be Sensitive to, and Tolerant of, Differences

Being audience-centered requires that you become as aware as possible of others' feelings, needs, interests, and backgrounds. Sometimes called **accommodation**, sensitivity to differences does not mean that you must abandon your own convictions. It does mean that you should demonstrate a willingness to listen to opposing viewpoints and learn about different beliefs and values. Such willingness not only communicates respect but can also help you to select a topic, formulate a purpose, and design strategies to motivate an audience.

A speaker who is sensitive to differences also uses respectful and inclusive language. Learn more about avoiding biased or offensive language in Chapter 15.

Be Honest

Knowingly offering false or misleading information to an audience is an ethical violation. However, many speakers rely on hypothetical illustrations—stories that never

actually occurred but that *might* happen. To use hypothetical illustrations ethically, make it clear to the audience that the story is indeed hypothetical. For example, begin with a phrase such as, "Imagine that…".

Do *Not* Plagiarize

Honesty also requires that speakers give credit for ideas and information that are not their own. Using the words, sentence structures, or ideas of others without crediting them is called **plagiarism**.

Perhaps you can remember copying a grade-school report directly from an online or printed encyclopedia, or maybe you've even purchased or "borrowed" a paper to submit for an assignment. These are obvious forms of plagiarism. A less obvious, but still serious, form is **patchwriting**—lacing a speech with compelling phrases that you find in a source but do not credit.[6] A speaker whose sentences were similar to those used in a news article would be patchwriting if they did not acknowledge that the phrasing came from the article.

Do Your Own Work The most flagrant cases of plagiarism result from speakers not doing their work. Another way speakers may attempt to shortcut the speech preparation process is to ask another person to edit their speech so extensively that it becomes more that other person's work than their own. This is another form of plagiarism and another way of cheating themselves out of the skills they need to develop.

Acknowledge Your Sources Ethical speakers are responsible for doing their own research and then sharing the results of that research with audience members. Some information is so widely known that you do not have to acknowledge a source for it. For example, you need not credit a source if you say that a person must be infected with HIV to develop AIDS. This information is widely available in a variety of reference sources. However, if you decide to use any of the following in your speech, then you must give credit to the source:

- direct quotations, even if they are only brief phrases
- opinions, assertions, or ideas of others, even if you paraphrase them rather than quote them verbatim
- statistics
- any unoriginal visual materials, including graphs, tables, and pictures

Take Careful Notes To be able to acknowledge your sources, you must first practice careful and systematic notetaking. Indicate with quotation marks any phrases or sentences that you photocopy, copy by hand, or electronically cut and paste verbatim from a source. Be sure to record the author, title, publisher or website, publication date, and page numbers for all sources from which you take quotations, ideas, statistics, or visual materials.

Cite Sources Correctly In addition to keeping careful records of your sources, you must also know how to cite your sources for your audience, both orally and in writing. The How To box offers advice for integrating an **oral citation** smoothly into a speech.



Present an Oral Citation

- Provide the date and specify the type of resource.
- Give the title and provide the author or source.
- Pause briefly to signal that you are about to begin quoting.
- Quote the source.
- Pause again to indicate that you are ending the quoted passage.

Here is a sample oral citation:
On a 2022 web page titled "Naloxone Drug Facts," the National Institutes of Health says that "Naloxone should be given to any person who shows signs of an opioid overdose or when an overdose is suspected. Naloxone can be given as a nasal spray or it can be injected into the muscle, under the skin, or into the veins."

You can also provide a **written citation** for a source. Style guides, such as those published by the Modern Language Association (MLA) or the American Psychological Association (APA), are now available online as well as in print format. Here is an example of a written citation in APA format for the source quoted in the sample oral citation:

> National Institutes of Health. (2022). *Naloxone drug-facts*. Retrieved from nida.nih.gov

What about those times when you are not certain whether information or ideas are common knowledge? A good rule is this: When in doubt, document. You would never be guilty of plagiarism if you documented something you didn't need to, but you could be committing plagiarism if you did not document something you really should have.

QUICK CHECK

Deliver an Ethical Speech

- Have a clear, responsible goal.
- Use sound evidence and reasoning.
- Share all evidence that will help your audience reach a sound decision.
- Be sensitive to, and tolerant of, differences.
- Be honest and do your own work.
- Avoid plagiarism, and give credit for any ideas and information that are not your own.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

4.1 Describe the relationships among ethics, free speech, and credibility.

In the United States, citizens have the right to speak freely, but that right comes with the responsibility to

speak ethically. Speaking ethically allows your audience to trust you. Being trustworthy is an important part of being credible, or believable.

4.2 Explain how free speech has been both challenged and defended throughout US history.

Although the US Congress and courts have occasionally limited the constitutional right to free speech, more often they have protected and broadened its application. Social media offer a new context for twenty-first-century challenges to free speech.

4.3 List and explain five criteria for ethical public speaking.

An ethical public speaker should have a clear, responsible goal; use sound evidence and reasoning; be sensitive to, and tolerant of, differences; be honest; and take appropriate steps to avoid plagiarism. Avoid plagiarizing by doing your own work and acknowledging—orally, in writing, or both—the sources for any quotations, ideas, statistics, or visual materials you use in a speech.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** You have found the perfect pie chart for your talk in *USA Today*. It shows US Census figures for population trends. If you tell the audience that the source of the visual is *USA Today*, do you also need to cite the US Census Bureau?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Speechwriters have written many of the best speeches made by US presidents. Is such use of speechwriters ethical? Is it ethical for presidents to get the credit for the speeches?
3. **Critical Assessment** As you listen to classmates' speeches, try to identify specific ways in which they try to gain your trust.

PART 2
Analyzing an Audience



LISTENING

OBJECTIVES

- **5.1** List and describe five barriers to effective listening.
- **5.2** Identify and implement strategies for becoming a better listener.
- **5.3** Identify and implement strategies for improving your critical listening and thinking skills.
- **5.4** Use criteria to effectively and appropriately evaluate speeches.

OVERCOMING BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE LISTENING

5.1 List and describe five barriers to effective listening.

You hear more than 1 billion words each year. Yet how much information do you retain? Improving your listening skills will make you not only a better listener but also a better speaker. **Listening** requires you to do all of the following:

- **Select** or single out a message from several competing messages. Your job as a speaker is to motivate listeners to focus on *your* message.
- **Attend** to, or focus on, the message.
- **Understand**, or assign meaning to the message.
- **Remember** ideas and information.
- **Respond**, or react with behavior that demonstrates you listened to the message.

Listening barriers are created when you fail to perform any of these activities effectively.

Information Overload

According to the **working memory theory of listening**, as listeners, we find it harder to concentrate on and remember messages when our working memory is full.[1] As a public speaker, you can keep your audience from tuning out by balancing new information and your key points with interesting supporting material. You can also build redundancy into your message so if listeners miss an idea the first time you present it, perhaps they will catch it during your concluding summary. As a listener, try increasing your concentration if you find yourself tuning a speaker out. Sitting up straight and looking at the speaker can also help you focus.

Personal Concerns

Are you thinking about the upcoming weekend while your instructor speaks? As a listener, recognize when your own agenda keeps you from listening and then make a special effort to focus on the speaker's message. As a speaker, consciously work to maintain your audience's attention by delivering your message with enthusiasm. When sharing key information, use an occasional "wake-up" message such as "Now listen carefully, because …".

Outside Distractions

As a listener, do your best to control the listening situation.

- Move to another seat.
- Close the blinds.
- Turn up the heat.
- Turn off the lights.
- Close the door.
- Turn off and put away your phone, laptop, and tablet (unless you are using one of these devices to take notes).
- Close down any applications that might distract you if you're listening to a virtual speech or presentation.
- Do whatever is necessary to minimize distractions.

When you are a speaker, use the tips in the How To box.



Minimize Listeners' Distractions

- Arrive early at the speaking space so you can assess the physical arrangements before you speak.
- Sit where your audience will be seated.
- Listen and look around you for any possible distractions.
- Reduce or eliminate distractions before listeners need to do it themselves.
- Tactfully discourage whispering in the audience.
- If you're presenting your speech virtually, eliminate anything within the camera frame that might be visually distracting.
- Wear single neutral colors if you plan to be on camera.

Prejudice

Are you convinced speakers from another political party have nothing useful to say? As a listener, guard against becoming so critical of a message that you don't listen to it or, doing the opposite, becoming so impressed that you decide too quickly that the speaker is trustworthy.[2]

To counteract **prejudice** when you are the speaker, use your opening statements to grab the audience's attention so they will listen to your message. If you think audience members are likely to disagree with you, ask them to withhold evaluation until they have heard your entire speech. In addition, use clear arguments and credible evidence rather than strong emotional appeals.

Differences between Speech Rate and Thought Rate

Most people talk at a rate of 125 words a minute,[3] but you are able to listen to as many as 700 or 1,200 words a minute. This difference gives you time to ignore a speaker periodically. Eventually, you stop listening. You can enhance your listening effectiveness by mentally summarizing what the speaker has said from time to time.

QUICK CHECK

Overcoming Your Listening Barriers

- Decide what is important in a speech and focus on that.
- Force yourself to focus on the speaker's message.
- Try to minimize outside distractions.
- Don't prejudge a message or speaker.
- Use the time lag created by the difference between speech rate and thought rate to summarize what the speaker is saying.

As a speaker, be aware of your listeners' tendency to stop paying attention. Build in message redundancy and internal summaries, use clear transitions, be well organized, and make your major ideas clear.

HOW TO BECOME A BETTER LISTENER

5.2 Identify and implement strategies for becoming a better listener.

Good listeners focus on a speaker's message and not on delivery style. Although poor speakers are a challenge to good listening, you also need to be wary of glib, well-polished speakers. An attractive style of delivery does not necessarily mean that a speaker's message is credible.

Listen with Your Eyes

Nonverbal clues play a major role in communicating a speaker's emotions and messages.[4] Interpret the speaker's expressions, posture, and gestures in the context of the speaker's words; look for clusters of cues that occur together; and look for cues that show the speaker's level of power, attitude toward listeners, and responsiveness to listeners.

If you have trouble understanding a speaker's words, move closer so you can see the speaker's mouth. A good view can increase your level of attention and improve your understanding.

Listen Mindfully

Good listeners are open-minded. They put their own thoughts aside so they can be present mentally as well as physically. They invest time in listening and make a conscious, mindful effort to listen. If you get off task and find that you're not doing these things, periodically remind yourself why the message can be helpful or important to you.[5]

Monitor Your Emotional Reaction to a Message

If you become angry or emotional in response to something a speaker says, your listening comprehension decreases. Don't let your anger toward a speaker's language get in the way of listening and understanding.

Be a Selfish Listener

If you find your attention waning, ask yourself questions such as, "What's in this for me?" Find ways to benefit from the information you are receiving, and try to connect it with your own experiences and needs.

Listen for Major Ideas

Listen for major ideas and principles. In speeches, facts as well as examples are used primarily to support major ideas. Facts are useful only when you can connect them to a principle or concept. As you listen, try to mentally summarize the major ideas that the specific facts support.

Practice Effective Listening

Listening skills do not develop automatically. Skill develops as you practice listening to speeches, music, and programs with demanding content.

Understand Your Listening Style

There are at least four different **listening styles**. Understanding your listening style can help you become a better and more flexible listener.[6]

- **Relational-oriented listeners** are comfortable listening to others express feelings and emotions.
- **Task-oriented listeners** listen for actions that need to be taken. Task-oriented listeners tend to be skeptical and prefer being given evidence to support recommendations for action.
- **Analytical listeners** prefer to listen to complex information laced with facts and details. They often withhold judgment before reaching a specific conclusion.
- **Critical listeners** spend time evaluating messages. They are likely to catch inconsistencies and errors in the overall reasoning and evidence used to reach a conclusion.

Become an Active Listener

An active listener is one who remains alert and mentally re-sorts, rephrases, and repeats key information when listening to a speech.[7] To be a more active speaker:

- **Re-sort.** Use your listening time to re-sort disorganized or disjointed ideas.[8] Figure out ways to rearrange them into a new, more logical pattern. For example, put a series of examples into chronological order.
- **Rephrase.** Mentally summarize the key points or information you want to remember. Listen for the main ideas and then paraphrase them in your own words. Looking for "information handles" in the form of previews, transitions, signposts, and summary statements can also help you remain actively involved as a listener.
- **Repeat.** Periodically *repeat* key points you want to remember. Go back to essential ideas and restate them to yourself.

Take Effective Notes

Research indicates that you will do a better job of remembering what you hear if you write your notes in longhand rather than type them on a computer.[9] When you are more mentally engaged with what you are listening to, your ability to remember what you hear increases.

Listen Ethically

Audience members share responsibility with speakers for ethical communication. The following guidelines for ethical listening incorporate what contemporary rhetorician Harold Barrett calls "attributes of the good audience."[10]

Communicate Your Expectations and Feedback As an audience member, you have the right—even the responsibility—to enter into a communication situation with expectations about the message and how the speaker will deliver it.

- Know what information and ideas you want to get out of the communication transaction.
- Expect a coherent, organized, and competently delivered presentation.
- Communicate your objectives, and react to the speaker's message and delivery with appropriate nonverbal and verbal feedback.

Be Sensitive to and Tolerant of Differences As an ethical listener, remember that your preferred approach to speaking and listening may differ from the speaker's. But your preference doesn't make the speaker's approach a wrong one. Also keep in mind that different cultures often have different styles of speaking.[11] Ethical listeners appropriately adapt their listening style to maximize their comprehension of a message.

QUICK CHECK

Become a Better Listener

- Listen with your eyes.
- Listen mindfully.
- Monitor your emotional reaction to a message.
- Stay on task and be a selfish listener.
- Listen for major ideas.
- Understand your listening style, practice effective listening, and become an active listener.
- Take notes.
- Listen ethically

HOW TO IMPROVE CRITICAL LISTENING AND THINKING SKILLS

5.3 Identify and implement strategies for improving your critical listening and thinking skills.

Critical listening is the process of listening to evaluate the quality, appropriateness, value, and importance of the information you hear. Related to being a critical listener is being a critical thinker. **Critical thinking** is the mental process of making accurate judgments about the conclusions presented in what you see, hear, and read. Your goal as a critical listener and thinker is to assess the quality of the information and the validity of the conclusions presented.

Distinguish between Facts and Inferences

Facts are information that has been proven true by direct observation. An **inference** is a conclusion based on partial information or an evaluation that has not been directly observed. The ability to separate facts from inferences is a basic critical thinking and listening skill.

Evaluate the Quality of Evidence

Evidence consists of the facts, examples, opinions, and statistics that a speaker uses to support a conclusion. Without credible supporting evidence, it would not be wise to agree with a speaker's conclusion. What should you listen for when trying to decide whether evidence is credible?

- Determine whether a stated fact is actually a fact. Has it been verified based on direct observation?
- Decide whether the speaker has used **examples** effectively to support their key points. Are the examples recent and from a credible source? Are they representative of other examples or atypical? Are there enough examples to reach a reasonable conclusion?
- An **opinion** is a quoted comment from someone. The most credible opinions come from reliable, unbiased, expert, and trustworthy sources.
- A **statistic** is a number that summarizes a collection of examples. Are the statistics reliable, unbiased, recent, representative, and valid?

HOW TO ANALYZE AND EVALUATE SPEECHES

5.4 Use criteria to effectively and appropriately evaluate speeches.

When you evaluate something, you judge its value and appropriateness. When making a judgment about the value of something, such as a speech, it's important to use relevant criteria. **Rhetorical criticism** is the process of using a method or criteria to evaluate the effectiveness and appropriateness of messages.

Tips for Giving Feedback to Others

When you have an opportunity to critique a speech, follow these guidelines to give feedback.

1. **Be descriptive.** In a neutral way, describe what you saw the speaker doing. For example, say, "You made eye contact during about half of your speech" rather than, "Your eye contact was lousy."
2. **Be specific.** Make sure your descriptions are precise enough. Instead of saying, "I liked your visuals," say, "Dawn, the use of color in your PowerPoint slides helped to keep my attention."
3. **Be positive.** Begin and end your feedback with positive comments. Beginning with negative comments immediately puts the speaker on the defensive and can create so much internal noise that they stop listening.
4. **Be constructive.** Give the speaker some suggestions or alternatives for improvement.
5. **Be sensitive.** Use *I-statements* as a way of phrasing your feedback so that your comments reflect your personal point of view ("I found my attention drifting during your speech"). A *you-statement* is less sensitive because it implies that the other person did something wrong ("You didn't summarize well in your conclusion").
6. **Be realistic.** Provide usable information. Offer feedback about things over which the speaker has control.

Tips for Giving Feedback to Yourself

Consider the following suggestions for enhancing your own self-critiquing skills.

1. **Look for and reinforce your skills and speaking abilities.** Note how your audience analysis, organization, and delivery were effective in achieving your objectives.
2. **Evaluate your effectiveness based on your specific speaking situation and audience.** Give yourself permission to adapt principles and practices to specific speech situations.

3. **Identify one or two areas for improvement.** Identify what you did right; then give yourself a suggestion or two for ways to improve. Concentrate on one or two key skills you would like to develop.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

5.1 List and describe five barriers to effective listening.

Barriers to listening include information overload, personal concerns, outside distractions, prejudice, and differences between speech rate and thought rate.

5.2 Identify and implement strategies for becoming a better listener.

"Listen" to nonverbal messages with your eyes. Understand your listening style. Listen mindfully, monitoring your emotional reactions to messages, and avoid jumping to conclusions. Listen for major ideas. Re-sort, restate, or repeat key messages. Be an ethical listener.

5.3 Identify and implement strategies for improving your critical listening and thinking skills.

Evaluate the speaker's use of facts, examples, opinions, and statistics as evidence.

5.4 Use criteria to effectively and appropriately evaluate speeches.

A good speech is understandable to the audience and achieves its intended effect. When offering feedback to yourself or others, be descriptive, specific, positive, constructive, sensitive, and realistic.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** One of your professors does nothing during lectures but read in a monotone voice from old notes. What are some strategies you can use to increase your listening effectiveness in this challenging situation?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Janice thought her classmate's speech was pretty good, but she gave the speaker low marks because she strongly disagreed with what the speaker was saying. Was this an ethical evaluation?
3. **Critical Assessment** For some reason, when Alberto hears the president speak, he just tunes out. What are some of the barriers that may keep Alberto from focusing on the message he is hearing?



ANALYZING YOUR AUDIENCE

OBJECTIVES

- **6.1** Use informal and formal methods of gathering information about your audience.
- **6.2** Explain how to analyze and use information to adapt to your audience.
- **6.3** Explain how to identify demographic information about your audience.
- **6.4** Explain how to identify psychological information about your audience.
- **6.5** Describe the speaking situation.
- **6.6** Use strategies to assess audience reactions after your speech.

GATHERING INFORMATION ABOUT YOUR AUDIENCE

6.1 Use informal and formal methods of gathering information about your audience.

As an audience-centered speaker, try to find out as much as you can about the audience before planning the speech. There are two approaches you can take: informal and formal.

Gathering Information Informally

Observe your audience informally and ask questions of people who know something about the audience you will be addressing. What is the audience's average age? What are their political views, religious beliefs, and attitudes toward your topic?

Gathering Information Formally

If time and resources permit, you may want to conduct a more formal survey of your listeners. Your topic and the speaking occasion can help you determine what you want to know about your audience that you don't already know. You may want to ask questions about audience members' age, gender, occupation, and memberships in professional organizations. Whenever possible, you should also ask specific questions about their attitudes. You can ask two basic types of questions:

1. **Open-ended questions** allow for unrestricted, more detailed answers without limiting responses to specific choices or alternatives. Essay questions, for example, are open-ended.
2. **Closed-ended questions** offer alternatives from which to choose. Multiple-choice, true/false, and agree/disagree questions are examples of closed-ended questions.

After you develop your own questions, test them out on a small group of people to make sure they are clear and will encourage meaningful answers.

ANALYZE AUDIENCE INFORMATION

6.2 Explain how to analyze and use information to adapt to your audience.

Once you have gathered information, you can begin the processes of **audience analysis**, examining information about your listeners, and **audience adaptation**, ethically using your information to customize your speech to the audience.

Use the results of your audience analysis to tailor your message so that listeners will understand it and you will achieve your speaking goal. Ethically adapt your topic, speech goal, content—including organization, information, examples, and visual aids—as well as your delivery.[1]



Analyze Audience Information

As you examine your data, look for these three things:

- **Audience member similarities**, whether in demographics or in beliefs and attitudes, can help you craft a message that resonates in the same way with many of your listeners.
- **Audience member differences** will alert you to the range of people you must reach with your message.
- **Common ground** with your audience refers to the ways you and your listeners are alike. The more you have in common with your audience, the easier it will be to establish a **relationship** with them that helps them understand your message and helps you achieve your purpose.

For example, use popular culture references your listeners are likely to know. *Adapting ethically means you do not tell your listeners only what they want to hear or fabricate information simply to please your audience or achieve your goal.*

IDENTIFYING DEMOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

6.3 Explain how to identify demographic information about your audience.

Demographics are statistics about such audience characteristics as age, gender, sexual orientation, race, ethnicity, culture, group membership, and socioeconomic status. Demographic information can help you develop a clear and effective message by providing clues about your listeners. Use caution in making inferences based on general information, however, because they may lead to faulty conclusions.

Age

The audience's age can suggest topics, as well as the kinds of examples, humor, illustrations, and other types of supporting material to use in your speech. Be careful, however, about generalizing from only one factor.

Gender, Sex, and Sexual Orientation

Gender is the culturally constructed and psychologically based perception of one's self as feminine, masculine, or **androgynous** (a combination of both feminine and masculine traits). Listeners' gender identities can fall anywhere along a continuum from female to male and may or may not reflect their biological **sex**. Your listeners may also reflect a range of sexual orientations. Keep in mind that gender identity is distinct from sexual orientation. As an audience-centered speaker, avoid assumptions about gender identity and sexual orientation, as well as sexist language or remarks. Take time to educate yourself about what words, phrases, or perspectives are likely to offend or create psychological noise and distract your audience from listening. For example, when referring to an individual whose gender is unknown, use the singular "they" instead of "he" or "she." Make your language, and your message, as inclusive of all gender identities and sexual orientations as possible.

Culture, Ethnicity, and Race

Culture is a learned system of knowledge, behavior, attitudes, beliefs, values, and norms shared by a group of people. **Ethnicity** is a *social classification* based on a variety of factors, such as nationality, religion, language, and ancestral heritage, that are shared by a group of people who also share a common geographic origin. **Race** is a term that has evolved to include a group of people with a common cultural history, nationality, or geographical location, as well as genetically transmitted physical attributes.[2] To be an effective speaker, adapt to differences in culture, race, and ethnicity.

Ethnocentrism is the assumption that your own cultural traditions and perspectives are superior to those of others. Be sensitive to human differences and avoid remarks that would disparage the cultural traditions or identification of the audience.[3]

Group Membership

Knowing what political, social, service, professional, work, or religious groups your listeners belong to can help you tailor your speech to your specific audience. Use great care, however, when touching on religious beliefs or an audience's values.

Socioeconomic Status

Socioeconomic status is a person's perceived importance and influence based on such factors as income, occupation, and educational level. The amount of disposable income your listeners have can influence your topic and your approach to the topic. Knowing what people do for a living can give you useful information about how to adapt your message to them. Knowing the educational background of your audience can also help you make decisions about your choice of vocabulary, language style, and use of examples and illustrations.

QUICK CHECK

Analyze Audience Demographics

- Know the age of your audience.
- Avoid making sweeping judgments based on gender stereotypes.
- Make your language and your message as inclusive as possible.
- Avoid an ethnocentric mindset and use great care when touching on religious beliefs.
- Learn what groups, clubs, or organizations to which your audience belongs.
- Consider the socioeconomic status of audience members.
- Remember that your audience will be made up of diverse individuals.

EXAMINING PSYCHOLOGICAL INFORMATION

6.4 Explain how to identify psychological information about your audience.

A **psychological audience analysis** explores an audience's attitudes, beliefs, and values toward your topic, purpose, and you. Learning whether members of your audience agree or disagree with your purpose may provide specific clues to help you anticipate their reactions to your message.

- An **attitude** reflects likes or dislikes.
- A **belief** is what you hold to be true or false.
- A **value** is an enduring concept of good and bad, right and wrong. More deeply ingrained than either attitudes or beliefs, values are also more resistant to change.

Identify Your Audience's Attitudes, Beliefs, and Values about Your Topic

Knowing how members of an audience feel about your topic lets you adjust your message accordingly. Try to categorize your audience and their attitudes according to the following three dimensions.

Interested–Uninterested With an interested audience, your task is simply to hold and amplify interest throughout the speech. If your audience is uninterested, you need to find ways to hook them. Tell listeners why your message relates to their needs and interests. Visual aids may also help you to gain and maintain the attention of apathetic listeners.

Favorable–Unfavorable You may also want to gauge how *favorable* or *unfavorable* your audience may feel toward you and your message before you begin to speak. Some audiences may be neither; instead, they may be neutral, apathetic, or simply uninformed about your topic. If they are already favorable, use their interest

to move them closer to your speaking goal. If not, be realistic. Acknowledge their opposing point of view and consider using facts to refute misperceptions they may hold.

Captive–Voluntary A captive audience has externally imposed reasons for being there (such as a requirement to attend class). Your goal with a captive audience is to make your speech just as interesting and effective as one designed for a voluntary audience. You still have an obligation to address your listeners' needs and interests and to keep them engaged in what you have to say. If your audience is attending voluntarily, anticipate why they are coming and speak about the issues they want you to address.

Identify Your Audience's Attitudes toward You, the Speaker

Regardless of how audience members feel about your topic or purpose, if they regard you as credible—others' perception of you as trustworthy, knowledgeable, and interesting—they will be much more likely to be interested in, and supportive of, what you have to say.

If you establish your **credibility** before you begin, your listeners will be more likely to believe what you say and to think that you are knowledgeable, interesting, and dynamic. Make a connection between you, your topic, and your audience: Tell your listeners why you are interested in the topic, describe your personal experience with the subject matter, or explain why you are passionate about your message.[4]

CONSIDERING THE SPEAKING SITUATION

6.5 Describe the speaking situation.

Situational audience analysis includes an examination of the time and place of your speech, the size of your audience, and the speaking occasion.[5] Table 6.1 summarizes situational audience analysis.

Table 6.1 Analyzing the Situation

Factor	Importance
Time	
• What time of day will you speak? • At what point in the program will you speak? • For how long are you scheduled to talk?	• Listeners may be tired in the afternoon or after listening to several other speakers. • Be sure to end your talk right on time or a little early.
Location	
• Can you visit before you speak? • How will the room be arranged? • How close will you be to the audience? • Will you be on a stage or raised platform? • Will you speak from a lectern? • Do you need to use a microphone? • Will you have the appropriate equipment and lighting for your visual aids?	• Visit, if possible. Determine what you can and cannot change about the location. • Adapt your speech and visual aids to factors you cannot change. • Rehearse appropriate movements and gestures for the conditions. • Arrive early to practice with microphones and equipment. • If you are presenting via video, it is important to be mindful of your physical surroundings and to ensure that the background is not distracting.
Size of Audience	
• How many people are expected to attend?	• Larger audiences tend to expect a more formal style. • You can take questions during your talk from a group of ten or fewer.
Occasion	
• What is the occasion that brings the audience together?	• Knowing the occasion can help you predict audience demographics and state of mind.

REFLECTING ON YOUR AUDIENCE AFTER YOU SPEAK

6.6 Use strategies to assess audience reactions after your speech.

After you have given your speech, evaluate your audience's positive or negative response to your message. Use your evaluation to help you prepare your next speech.

Observe Nonverbal Responses

The most obvious nonverbal response is applause. Is the audience simply clapping politely, or is the applause robust and enthusiastic, indicating pleasure and acceptance? Responsive facial expressions, smiles, and nods are signs that the speech was received well. Remember, however, that listeners from different cultures respond to speeches with different behavior and levels of enthusiasm.[6]

Listen to Verbal Responses

If you have the chance, try to ask audience members how they responded to the speech in general as well as to points you are particularly interested in. Their specific comments can indicate where you succeeded and where you need improvement.

Consider Survey Responses

You can use the same survey techniques discussed previously. Develop survey questions that will help you determine the general reactions to you and your speech, as well as specific responses to your ideas and supporting materials.

Observe Behavioral Responses

Your listeners' actions are the best indicators of your speaking success. If the purpose of your speech was to persuade your listeners to do something, you will want to learn whether they ultimately behave as you intended.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

6.1 Use informal and formal methods of gathering information about your audience.

Gather information through informally observing listeners and questioning people who know them. Use open-ended and close-ended questions to formally survey listeners.

6.2 Explain how to analyze and use information to adapt to your audience.

Look for similarities and differences among listeners and common ground between you and the audience. Use information to ethically adapt your topic, content, and delivery to help the audience understand and to achieve your goal.

6.3 Explain how to identify demographic information about your audience.

Identifying demographic information about your audience can help you develop a clear and effective message. Your language and your message should be as inclusive as possible. Avoid words, phrases, or perspectives that could offend or create psychological noise for your audience.

6.4 Explain how to identify psychological information about your audience.

Learn whether listeners attend your speech voluntarily or as a captive audience. Know their level of interest and support of your topic or position. You must also consider their opinions about your credibility.

6.5 Describe the speaking situation.

Ethically adapt your speech depending on the time and location for it, the size of the audience, and the occasion.

6.6 Use strategies to assess audience reactions after your speech.

Use nonverbal, verbal, survey, and behavioral responses to assess your effectiveness.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** After your next speech, describe the extent to which you accomplished your speaking goal, based on assessment techniques described in this chapter.
2. **Ethics Assessment** Tynisha wants to convince her audience to ban off-leash hours for dogs in city parks, except for fenced dog runs. Her survey results suggest that 85 percent of her audience support the current policy of permitting dogs to be off their leashes until 9 a.m. and after 9 p.m. in unfenced areas. Should she change her purpose to fit the existing attitudes of her audience?
3. **Critical Assessment** Dr. Ruiz assumes the audience for her speech on birth control would be women of childbearing age. However, after preparing her speech, she discovers that the women in her audience are at least 20 years older than she expected. What changes, if any, should she make to her speech?



ADAPTING TO YOUR AUDIENCE AS YOU SPEAK

OBJECTIVES

- **7.1** Explain how to read nonverbal cues to understand listeners' reactions to your speech.
- **7.2** Describe several adaptations you can make to respond to listeners' nonverbal cues.
- **7.3** List several ways you can customize your message to your audience.
- **7.4** Identify and use strategies for adapting to a diverse audience.

READ NONVERBAL CUES

7.1 Explain how to read nonverbal cues to understand listeners' reactions to your speech.

Audience analysis and adaptation do not end when you have crafted your speech. They continue as you deliver your speech. Once you begin speaking, you must rely on nonverbal cues from the audience to judge how people are responding to the message. Learn to be aware of the often unspoken clues that your audience is either hanging on your every word or is bored.

Eye Contact

The best way to determine whether your listeners are maintaining interest in your speech is to note the amount of eye contact they have with you. The more contact they have, the more likely it is that they are listening to your message. If you find them repeatedly looking at their phones, checking email,

tapping out a text message, looking down at the program or, worse yet, closing their eyes, you can reasonably guess that they have lost interest in what you're talking about.

Facial Expression

Members of an attentive audience not only make direct eye contact but also have attentive facial expressions. Beware of a frozen, unresponsive face; we call this sort of expression the "listener-stupor" look. The classic listener-stupor expression consists of a slightly tilted head, a faint, frozen smile, and often a hand holding up the chin. This expression may give the appearance of interest, but more often it means that the person is daydreaming or thinking of something other than your topic.

Movement and Posture

An attentive audience doesn't move much. Squirming, feet shuffling, and general body movement often indicate that members of the audience have lost interest in your message. A slight forward lean is a good sign your listeners are interested and paying attention.

Nonverbal Responsiveness

Frequent applause and nods of agreement are indicators of interest and support. An interested audience also responds when encouraged or invited to do so by the speaker. If you ask for a show of hands and audience members sheepishly look at one another and eventually raise a finger or two, you can reasonably infer lack of interest and enthusiasm.

RESPOND TO NONVERBAL CUES

7.2 Describe several adaptations you can make to respond to listeners' nonverbal cues.

After learning to "read" your listeners, you can use a repertoire of behaviors to help you connect with them.

If your audience seems inattentive or bored:

- Tell a story.
- Use an example to which the audience can relate, or use a personal example.
- Remind your listeners why your message should be of interest to them.
- Eliminate some abstract facts and statistics.
- Use appropriate humor. If listeners do not respond to your humor, use more stories or personal illustrations.
- Make direct references to the audience.
- Encourage audience participation by asking questions or requesting examples.
- Ask for a direct response, such as a show of hands, to see whether your listeners agree or disagree with you.
- Speed up the pace of your delivery or pause for dramatic effect.

If your audience seems confused or doesn't seem to understand your point:

- Be more redundant. Repeat key points.
- Phrase your information in another way or think of a more concrete example to illustrate your point.
- Use a visual aid, such as a chalkboard or flipchart, to clarify your point.
- If you have been speaking rapidly, slow your speaking rate.
- Ask for feedback from audience members to help you discover what may be unclear to them.
- Ask someone in the audience to summarize the key points you are making.

If your audience seems to be disagreeing with your message:

- Provide additional data and evidence to support your point.
- Remind your listeners of your credibility, credentials, or background.



Adapt Your Speech While You Are Speaking

- Watch the audience and notice listeners' nonverbal cues.
- If listeners seem interested, supportive, and attentive, continue speaking as you have planned, based on your pre-speech analysis.
- If the audience is not interested and responsive, or is disagreeing with you, try one of the ideas listed in this chapter.
- If the audience's responses do not change, try another adaptation.
- If all else fails, you may need to abandon a formal speaker–listener relationship with your audience and open up your topic for discussion.
- Continue to listen and monitor so that you may learn more about the audience.

- Rely less on anecdotes and more on facts to present your case. Write facts and data on a chalkboard, whiteboard, or flipchart if one is available.
- If you don't have the answers and data you need, tell listeners you will provide more information by mail, telephone, email, or social media (and make sure you get back in touch with them).

CUSTOMIZE YOUR MESSAGE TO YOUR AUDIENCE

7.3 List several ways you can customize your message to your audience.

Audiences prefer messages that are adapted just to them. What are some ways to communicate to your listeners that your message is designed specifically for them? Here are a few suggestions.

- Appropriately use audience members' names to relate information to specific people. Before you speak, ask those people for permission to use their names in your talk.

- Make a specific reference to the place where you are speaking.
- Refer to a significant event that happened on the date of your speech. An internet search for "this day in history" should reveal a number of interesting events. Link the event to the topic and audience. For example, "Today is the anniversary of one of the great battles of the Civil War. Today, I want to tell you about another battle in our country. The outcome will change all our lives."
- Refer to a recent news event. Visit the website or local news source of an institution or group to whom you are speaking for stories that you can connect to the central idea of your talk.
- Refer to a group or organization. If you're speaking to an audience of service, religious, political, or work group members, incorporate a specific and positive comment about them into your speech. But be honest; don't offer false praise; audiences can sniff out phony flattery.
- Find ways to apply facts, statistics, and examples to the people in your audience. For example, "Forty percent of women listening to me now are likely to experience gender discrimination. That means of the twenty women in this audience, eight of you are likely to be discriminated against."

ADAPT TO DIVERSE LISTENERS

7.4 Identify and use strategies for adapting to a diverse audience.

Audience diversity involves more factors than just ethnic and cultural differences. *Diversity* simply means differences. As we discussed in Chapter 6, it is important to identify what you have in common with your audience.

You should also consider the differences between you and your listeners. Being aware of these differences can help you better identify with your audience.

Because of your efforts to gather information about your audience, you should know something about the people who will likely be present for your talk. Based on your information, you may want to identify a **target audience**, a specific segment of your audience that you most want to address or influence. When consciously focusing on a target audience, the challenge is not to lose or alienate the rest of your listeners. You'll want to keep the entire audience in mind while simultaneously making a specific attempt to hit your target segment.

When adapting to a diverse audience, either separately or in combination with a target audience focus, consider using the following strategies to reach the different listeners in your audience:

- Use a variety of supporting materials, including illustrations, examples, statistics, and opinions.
- Remember the power of stories. People from most cultures appreciate a good story. But if you're uncertain about cultural preferences, use a balance of both logical support (statistics, facts, specific examples) and emotional support (stories and illustrations).
- Consider showing the audience a brief outline to provide an overview of your key ideas, using PowerPoint or Prezi. If there is a language barrier between you and your audience, being able to read portions of your speech as they hear you speaking may improve audience members' comprehension.
- Use visuals that transcend language differences. Pictures and other images can communicate universal messages—especially emotional ones.

QUICK CHECK

Adapt to a Culturally Diverse Audience

- Identify with them.
- Be aware of key differences among audience members and how you may be different from your listeners.
- Focus on a target audience without losing or alienating the rest of your listeners.
- Use diverse supporting materials that reflect a balance of logical and emotional support.
- Use visual aids, including both images and an outline of your key points.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

7.1 Explain how to read nonverbal cues to understand listeners' reactions to your speech.

While speaking, pay attention to your listeners' eye contact with you, their facial expressions and amount of movement, and their verbal and nonverbal responses to you.

7.2 Describe several adaptations you can make to respond to listeners' nonverbal cues.

When you receive clues that listeners are bored, don't understand, or disagree with you, change what you are doing. You can try many strategies to communicate more effectively.

7.3 List several ways you can customize your message to your audience.

Adapt to your specific audience by using audience members' names or mentioning the group they belong to; relating your speech to the location where you are speaking or to a historical or recent event; and relating statistics to your specific audience.

7.4 Identify and use strategies for adapting to a diverse audience.

Being aware of similarities and differences between you and your audience members can help you better identify with them. Consider directing your message toward a target audience. Use a variety of supporting materials, including images and an outline of your key points.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Consider a recent speech you gave. How did you adapt it to your specific audience? How could you have better customized the speech?
2. **Ethics Assessment** How can you ethically address the interests of all audience members if you direct your message toward a target audience?
3. **Critical Assessment** In the middle of a presentation, Brandon notices a few of the audience members losing eye contact with him, shifting in their seats, and glancing at their phones. What is happening, and what should Brandon do?

PART 3
Preparing a Speech



DEVELOPING YOUR SPEECH

OBJECTIVES

- **8.1** Select and narrow a topic for a speech.
- **8.2** Write an audience-centered, specific-purpose statement for a speech.
- **8.3** State a central idea for a speech.
- **8.4** Apply three ways of generating main ideas from a central idea.

SELECT YOUR TOPIC

8.1 Select and narrow a topic for a speech.

Your first task is to choose a topic for your speech. You will then need to narrow this topic to fit your time limits. But how do you go about choosing an appropriate, interesting topic?

Consider the Audience

As you search for potential speech topics, keep in mind each audience's interests and expectations. Your topic should be relevant to the *interests* and *expectations* of your listeners, and it should take into account the *knowledge* listeners already have about the subject.

Choose topics that are important—topics that matter to your listeners, as well as to yourself. Table 8.1 offers examples of topics appropriate for the interests, expectations, knowledge, and concerns of given audiences.

Consider the Occasion

To be successful, a topic must be appropriate to the occasion. For example, you may not want to give a bawdy, humorous after-dinner speech at the birthday party of a

Table 8.1 Sample Audience-Centered Topics

Audience	Topic
Retirees	Prescription drug benefits
Military veterans	The Invictus Games
Civic organization	Starting a community food bank
First graders	What to do in case of a fire at home
Teachers	Building children's self-esteem
College fraternities	Campus service opportunities

dignified elder or criticize an organization while speaking at the opening of its new headquarters.

Consider Yourself

The best public speaking topics are those that reflect your personal experience or especially interest you. You can select a topic with which you are already familiar or one you would like to learn more about. Your interest will motivate both your research and your eventual delivery of the speech.

Brainstorm

Follow the guidelines in the How To box to use the time-tested technique of **brainstorming** to generate ideas for speech topics.[1]



Brainstorm Speech Topics

- Start with a blank sheet of paper or computer screen.
- Set a time limit for brainstorming.
- Begin writing as many possible speech topics as you can.
- Do not stop to evaluate your topics; just write them down.
- One topic may remind you of another possibility. Write it down. Such "piggybacking" of ideas is okay.
- Continue without restraint until your time is up. At this stage, anything goes.
- Later, evaluate the list to choose a viable topic.

Listening and Reading for Topic Ideas

Often, something you see, hear, or read triggers an idea for a speech. A current news story or social trend or issue you see on TV, read in your favorite news source, or receive via social media may suggest a topic. You can also consider randomly browsing the categories of a web directory such as Best of the Web (*botw.org*) until you see a topic that piques your interest. Chances are that a topic covered in one medium has been covered in another as well, allowing for extended research.

Just as you jotted down possible topics generated by brainstorming sessions, remember to write down topic ideas you get from what's trending on your Twitter or Facebook feeds or on TikTok, other media, class lectures, or informal conversations.

Don't Procrastinate!

For most brief classroom speeches (less than ten minutes), you should allow at least one week to develop and research your speech. A week gives you enough time to develop and research your speech. The whole process will be far easier than if you delay work until the night before you are supposed to deliver your speech.

Narrow Your Topic

Now that you have a topic, you need to narrow it so that it fits within the time limits set by your assignment. Write your general topic—perhaps it is *Weather*—at

QUICK CHECK

Selecting a Topic

- Is the topic relevant and important to your audience?
- How much does your audience know about the topic?
- Is the topic appropriate to the occasion?
- Is the topic of interest and importance to you?

the top of a list. Add entries to the list, making each one more specific than the previous entry. Under "Weather," for example, you might write, "National Weather Service," then "Storm Prediction Center," and so on. Eventually, you will have a topic specific enough for the length of your speech ("Severe thunderstorm and tornado watches"). Be careful not to narrow your topic so much that you cannot find enough information for even a three-minute talk. If you do, just go back a step to a broader topic.

Determine Your General Purpose

The **general purpose** of any speech is either to inform, to persuade, or to entertain.

- Informative speakers give listeners information. They define, describe, or explain a thing, person, place, concept, process, or function.
- Persuasive speakers try to get you to believe or do something. They may offer information, but they use the information to try to change or reinforce an audience's beliefs or to urge some sort of action.
- Entertaining speakers aim to get listeners to relax, smile, perhaps laugh, and generally enjoy themselves.

DETERMINE YOUR SPECIFIC PURPOSE

8.2 Write an audience-centered, specific-purpose statement for a speech.

Now that you have a topic and you know generally whether your speech should inform, persuade, or entertain, it is time you decided on its specific purpose. A **specific purpose** is a concise audience-centered statement of what your listeners should be able to do by the time you finish your speech.

Formulating the Specific Purpose

Specific-purpose statements begin with the same nine words: "At the end of my speech, the audience will…." The next word should be a verb that names an observable, measurable action that the audience should be able to do by the end of the speech.

Use verbs such as *list, explain, describe*, or *write*. Do not use words such as *know, understand*, or *believe*. You can discover what your listeners know, understand, or believe only by having them show you by performing some measurable activity.

Clarify the Specific Purpose

After you write your specific-purpose statement, make sure it follows these guidelines:

- Your specific purpose reflects the interests, expectations, and knowledge level of your audience.
- Your specific-purpose statement expresses only one single idea. The purpose, "At the end of my speech, the audience will write a simple computer program in Just BASIC and play the video game Minecraft," has more than one idea. If you try to achieve more than one specific purpose, you will have trouble covering all your ideas, and your speech may seem unfocused.
- Your specific-purpose statement should use words that specify observable or measurable audience behavior.

Using Your Specific Purpose

Everything you do while preparing and delivering your speech should contribute to your specific purpose. The specific purpose can help you assess the supporting material you are gathering for your speech. For example, you may find that an interesting statistic, although related to your topic, does not help you achieve your

specific purpose. In that case, you can substitute material that directly advances your purpose.

DEVELOP YOUR CENTRAL IDEA

8.3 State a central idea for a speech.

The **central idea** is a one-sentence summary of your speech. The central idea (sometimes called the *thesis statement*), like the specific-purpose statement, restates the speech topic. But whereas a specific-purpose statement focuses on audience behavior, the central idea focuses on the content of the speech.

- The central idea should reflect consideration of the audience. You considered your audience when selecting and narrowing your topic and when composing your specific-purpose statement. In the same way, you should consider your audience's needs, interests, expectations, and knowledge when stating your central idea. If you do not consider your listeners, you run the risk of losing their attention before you even begin developing your speech.
- The central idea should be a single idea. Having more than one central idea, like more than one idea in a specific-purpose statement, only leads to confusion and a lack of coherence in a speech.
- The central idea should be a complete **declarative sentence**—not a phrase (such as *toxic waste dumping*) or clause (such as *stop dumping toxic waste*) and not a question ("Why is toxic waste a problem?").
- The central idea should be stated in direct, specific language. An example of a good central idea is, "Toxic waste dumping is a major environmental problem in the United States today." Avoid qualifiers such as *in my opinion.* Avoid a central idea that is too vague, such as "Toxic waste is a reason to worry."

GENERATE AND PREVIEW YOUR MAIN IDEAS

8.4 Apply three ways of generating main ideas from a central idea.

Write your central idea at the top of a clean sheet of paper. Then ask these three questions:

1. Does the central idea have *natural divisions*? (These may be indicated by such phrases as "three types" or "four means.")
2. Can you think of several *reasons* why the central idea is true?
3. Can you support your central idea by tracing a series of *steps* or a chronological progression?

You should be able to answer yes to one or more of these questions. These are your **main ideas**. Main ideas might, for example, be three *types* of birds of prey, four *reasons* the local park needs new lighting, or four *steps* in writing your own wedding vows.

Consult your specific-purpose statement as you generate your main ideas. If your main ideas do not help you achieve your specific purpose, you need to rethink your speech. You may change either your specific purpose or your main ideas. Whichever you do, be sure to synchronize these two elements. Remember, it is much easier to make changes at this stage than after you have done your research and produced a detailed outline.

Once you have generated your main ideas, you can produce a **blueprint** for your speech by adding a preview of those main ideas to your central idea. An example of a blueprint is, "Toxic waste dumping is a major environmental problem in the United States today. It endangers animals and poisons the water that humans drink." Preview your main ideas in the same order you plan to discuss them in your speech.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

8.1 Select and narrow a topic for a speech.

Brainstorm, read, and listen to find topic ideas. Effective speech topics are appropriate for your audience, yourself, and your occasion.

8.2 Write an audience-centered, specific-purpose statement for a speech.

A specific-purpose statement begins, "At the end of my speech, the audience will …" and describes a single measurable action the audience should take. It should guide you during all speech preparation activities.

8.3 State a central idea for a speech.

A central idea summarizes the topic of your speech with direct, specific language in a complete declarative sentence.

8.4 Apply three ways of generating main ideas from a central idea.

Divide your central idea into main ideas by asking yourself if the central idea has natural divisions, if there are several reasons the central idea is true, and if the central idea can be supported with a series of steps.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Refer to Table 8.1. For each of the audiences listed in the left-hand column, generate at least one additional audience-centered topic.
2. **Ethics Assessment** You overhear another student describing their paper about abolishing the death penalty and the book they used to research it.

Would it be ethical to "borrow" their topic and consult the book they mentioned to prepare a speech for your public speaking class?

3. **Critical Assessment** Use information from this chapter to critique and rewrite, if needed, the following specific-purpose statements. After you have made necessary corrections, pick one statement and use it to practice generating a central idea and main points.

   (1) At the end of my speech, the audience will know more about the Mexican free-tailed bat.
   (2) I will explain some differences between viruses and bacteria.
   (3) At the end of my speech, the audience will be able to list some reasons for xeriscaping one's yard.
   (4) At the end of my speech, the audience will be able to prepare a realistic monthly budget.
   (5) The advantages and disadvantages of living in a college dormitory.

GATHERING SUPPORTING MATERIAL



OBJECTIVES

- **9.1** Describe how personal knowledge and experience can serve as a source of supporting material for a speech.
- **9.2** Locate and evaluate internet resources for a speech.
- **9.3** Explain how to use online databases to find supporting material for a speech.
- **9.4** Describe traditional library holdings that can provide supporting material for a speech.
- **9.5** Summarize how to conduct an effective interview.
- **9.6** Explain five strategies for a methodical research process.

Creating a successful speech requires knowledge of both the sources and the types of supporting material that speechmakers typically use.

PERSONAL KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERIENCE

9.1 Describe how personal knowledge and experience can serve as a source of supporting material for a speech.

Because you will probably give speeches on topics you are particularly interested in, you may find that *you* are your own best source. You may be able to provide an effective illustration, explanation, definition, or other type of supporting material from your own knowledge and experience. As an audience-centered speaker, you should realize, too, that personal knowledge often has the additional advantage of heightening your credibility in the minds of your listeners. They will accord you more respect as an authority when they realize that you have firsthand knowledge of a topic.

THE INTERNET

9.2 Locate and evaluate internet resources for a speech.

Understanding how to locate and evaluate various types of internet resources can help make your search for supporting material more productive.

Locating Internet Resources

You have undoubtedly used Google to access material on the web. If you feel overwhelmed by the number of sites a Google search can yield, a more specialized **vertical search engine** can help you narrow your search. For example, Google Scholar indexes academic sources and Indeed indexes job sites. You can also use various strategies to narrow your results. For example, try enclosing your search phrase in quotation marks or parenthesis so that your search yields only those sites on which the exact phrase appears.

Exploring Internet Resources

As you begin to explore the search results you've generated, you will discover a wide variety of sites—from web pages that try to sell you something to the official sites of government agencies and news organizations. One clue to the type of site you have found is the **domain**, indicated by the last three letters of the site's URL (e.g., *.com* or *.org*). Although sites can be classified in several different ways, most fall into one of the following five categories.[1]

- **Commercial.** The purpose of this type of website is to sell products or services. The domain is often *.com*. News and entertainment sites also often have *.com* domains.
- **Educational.** This type of site provides information about an educational entity. The domain is usually *.edu*.
- **Government.** The purpose of this type of website is to provide information produced by government agencies, offices, and departments. The domain is usually *.gov*.

- **Military.** Information about or from the military is usually indicated by internet addresses that end in *.mil*.
- **Organizational.** The purpose of this type of website is to advocate a group's point of view. The domain is usually *.org*.

Evaluating Internet Resources

Although the web was founded on the principle of free speech, the lack of legal, financial, or editorial restriction on what is published online presents both a logistical and an ethical challenge to researchers. The term **fake news** describes reported information that is fabricated. To distinguish fake news from fact, propaganda, or satire requires critical thinking and fact-checking tools. As you begin to explore the sites generated by your search, you will need to evaluate them in a similar manner. The following six criteria can serve as a consistent standard.[2]

Accountability Find out what individual or organization is responsible for the website.

- The individual or organization responsible for the site may be clear from the title of the site or its URL.
- See whether the site is signed.
- Follow links or search the author's name to determine their expertise and authority.
- If the site is unsigned, search for a sponsoring organization. Follow links, search the organization's name, or consider the domain to determine reputability.
- If you cannot identify or verify the author or sponsor of a website, be extremely wary of the site.

Accuracy It may be difficult to determine whether the information a site contains is accurate unless you are an expert in the area the site addresses. These steps can help.

- Consider whether the author or sponsor is a credible authority. If so, the information is more likely to be accurate.

- Assess the care with which the site has been written. A site should be relatively free of writing errors.
- Conduct additional research into the information on the site. You may be able to verify or refute the information by consulting another resource.

Objectivity Objectivity is related to accountability. Once you know who is accountable for a site, consider the interests, philosophical or political biases, and the source of financial support for the author or sponsor of the site. The more objective the author, the more credible the facts and information presented. Consider, too, any advertisements on the site that might influence its content.

Timeliness Look for evidence that the site has recent posts or has been kept current. At the bottom of many sites, you will find a statement specifying when the site was created and when it was last updated. When you are concerned with factual data, the more recent, the better.

Usability The site should load fairly quickly. The layout and design of the site should facilitate its use. Also consider whether there is a fee to gain access to any of the information on the site.

Diversity An inclusive website will be free of material that communicates bias against any gender, ethnicity, race, culture, or sexual orientation; and against people with disabilities.[3] It should also be accessible.

No discussion of evaluating internet resources would be complete without mentioning *Wikipedia*, the resource that often appears as the first result from a web search. *Wikipedia* can be useful for general information about current events and new technology that may not find its way into print resources for years. But keep in mind that because anyone, regardless of expertise, can add to or change the content of a *Wikipedia* entry, the site's reliability and appropriateness for academic use are limited. For this reason, many instructors consider *Wikipedia* an inappropriate source of information for student speeches.

QUICK CHECK

Evaluate Internet Resources

- I know who is accountable for the website.
- I can verify the accuracy of the information.
- The site is objective.
- The site is current.
- The site is easy to use and provides links to other sites.
- The site is culturally diverse and free of bias.

ONLINE DATABASES

9.3 Explain how to use online databases to find supporting material for a speech.

Online databases provide access to bibliographic information, abstracts, and full texts for a variety of resources. Like websites, online databases are reached via a networked computer. Unlike websites, however, most databases are restricted to the patrons of libraries that subscribe to them. Your library may subscribe to several or all of the following popular full-text, searchable databases:

- **Academic Search Ultimate.** This database offers many full-text articles from 1887 to the present, covering a wide variety of subjects.
- **JSTOR.** This is a multi-subject, full-text database of journal articles from the first volume to the present.
- **Nexis Uni.** Focusing on business, finance, industry, and law, this database provides many full-text articles from newspapers, magazines, journals, newsletters, and wire services. Dates of coverage vary.
- **Newspaper Source Plus.** This database offers full-text articles from nearly 1,200 US and international newspapers, as well as television and radio news transcripts from ABC News, CBS News, CNN, CNN International, FOX News, National Public Radio, and others.

TRADITIONAL LIBRARY HOLDINGS

9.4 Describe traditional library holdings that can provide supporting material for a speech.

Despite the rapid development of internet and database resources, the more traditional holdings of libraries, both paper and electronic, remain rich sources of supporting material.

- **Books** Libraries' collections of books are called the **stacks**. They are organized by call numbers, which you can find by searching your library's computerized card catalog. Many libraries offer a location guide or map to help you find the floor or section of the stacks housing the books with the call numbers you are interested in.

  Do not wait until the last minute to conduct library research for your speech. Increasing numbers of libraries are beginning to house some of their stacks off-site. You may have to fill out a request form and allow some wait time before a book becomes available to you.
- **Reference resources** The call numbers of print reference resources will have the prefix *ref*, indicating that they are housed in the reference section of the library. Print reference resources are usually available only for in-house research and cannot be checked out. If you plan to use the reference section, visit the library during daytime hours when a full-time reference librarian is more likely to be available to help you.

INTERVIEWS

9.5 Summarize how to conduct an effective interview.

Consider conducting an interview if you need more detailed information from an expert for your speech. But before you decide that an interview is necessary, be sure that your questions cannot be answered easily by doing online or library research.

Preparing for the Interview

If you decide that only an interview can give you the material you need, you should prepare for it in advance.

Determine Your Purpose Specifically, what do you need to find out?

Schedule a Meeting Once you have a specific purpose for the interview, decide whom you need to speak with, and arrange a face-to-face or mediated meeting.

Using your electronic device to record audio or video of the interview can free you from having to take copious notes and make it easy to refer to the interviewee's exact words. If you are considering recording the interview, ask for the interviewee's okay during this initial contact. If the person does not grant permission, be prepared to take notes instead.

Plan Your Questions Before your interview, find out as much as you can about both your subject and the person you are interviewing. Prepare questions that take full advantage of the interviewee's specific knowledge of your subject.

Combine closed-ended and open-ended questions. Open-ended questions often follow closed-ended questions: When the person you are interviewing answers a closed-ended question with a simple "yes" or "no," you may wish to follow up by asking "Why?"

Conduct the Interview

Follow the suggestions in the How To box to conduct effective interviews.



Conduct an Effective Interview

- **Dress appropriately.** Conservative, businesslike clothes show that you are serious about the interview.
- **Bring note-taking supplies.** Even if you plan to record the interview, you may want to turn off the recording at some point or your device may malfunction.
- **Arrive a few minutes ahead of schedule.** Be prepared, however, to wait patiently, if necessary.

- **Prepare your equipment.** If you have decided to use a recorder, set up your device as needed. If you are going to take written notes, get your supplies ready.
- **Follow your plan.** Use the questions you have prepared as a guide. Listen carefully to the person's answers and ask follow up questions. Request clarification if needed.
- **Be ready to adjust the plan.** Listen closely to the person's words and their intended meaning. If the interviewee mentions something you did not think of, don't be afraid to pursue the point.

After an Interview

As soon as possible after the interview, read through your notes carefully and revise any portions that may be illegible or unclear. If you recorded the interview, save and label the file with the date and the interviewee's name. Send a note of thanks to your interviewee.

RESEARCH STRATEGIES

9.6 Explain five strategies for a methodical research process.

Adopting methodical research strategies will make finding supporting material easier and more efficient. You need to develop a preliminary bibliography, locate resources, evaluate their usefulness, read and record, and identify possible visual aids.

Develop a Preliminary Bibliography

Creating a **preliminary bibliography** or list of promising resources should be your first goal. You will probably discover more resources than you will actually look at or refer to in your speech; at this stage, the bibliography simply serves as a menu of possibilities. How many resources should you list in a preliminary bibliography for, say, a ten-minute speech? A reasonable number might be ten or twelve. If you have many more, you may feel

overwhelmed. If you have fewer, you may have too little information.

You will need to develop a system for keeping track of your resources. Web browsers let you bookmark pages for future reference and ready access. If you are searching an online catalog or database, you can compile a record of the references you find. Also consider using a web-based **citation manager** to collect, organize, and format citation information for the resources you discover. RefWorks, EndNote, and Zotero are examples of popular citation managers that may be available through your university library.

Locate Resources

If you have used a citation manager, you can locate online resources by simply clicking on your entries. For other items in your preliminary bibliography, you will need to locate the resources yourself. Refer to the discussion earlier in this chapter on traditional library holdings.

Assess the Usefulness of Resources

It makes sense to gauge the potential usefulness of your resources before you begin to read more closely and take notes. The instructions in the How To box can help you.



Evaluate Source Material

Before you read in depth and take notes from your resources, take a little time to figure out which ones are likely to be of most use for your speech.

- Glance over the tables of contents of books.
- Flip quickly through books or scroll websites or database articles to note any charts, graphs, or other materials that could be used as visual aids.
- Browse a key chapter or two. Skim websites and articles as well.

Read and Record

Once you have located your resources and assessed their usefulness, you are ready to begin more careful reading and recording.

- Beginning with the resources that you think have the greatest potential, record any examples, statistics, opinions, or other supporting material that might be useful to your speech. Depending on the resource, you can save supporting material on your computer, photocopy it, or print it.
- If you copy a phrase, sentence, or paragraph verbatim from a source, be sure to put quotation marks around it. You may need to know later whether it is a direct quote or a paraphrase. (This information will be obvious, of course, on printouts or photocopies.)
- To avoid the possibility of committing unintentional plagiarism, keep track of your sources as you take notes.

Identify Possible Presentation Aids

In addition to discovering verbal and written supporting material in your sources, you may also find charts, graphs, photographs, and other potentially valuable visual material. Keep copies or make a list of any potential presentation aids you find.

QUICK CHECK

Research Strategies

- Develop a preliminary bibliography.
- Locate sources.
- Assess the usefulness of sources.
- Read and record.
- Identify possible presentation aids.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

9.1 Describe how personal knowledge and experience can serve as a source of supporting material for a speech.

Personal experiences and knowledge can provide some of your source material and can raise your credibility with the audience.

9.2 Locate and evaluate internet resources for a speech.

A more specialized vertical search engine can help you narrow your search. Evaluate internet resources to determine who is accountable for the sources and whether they are accurate, objective, current, usable, and sensitive to diversity.

9.3 Explain how to use online databases to find supporting material for a speech.

Online databases offer abstracts and full-text of articles, news, and more. They are typically available through libraries that subscribe to them.

9.4 Describe traditional library holdings that can provide supporting material for a speech.

Books, stored in the library's stacks, and print reference resources, which cannot be checked out, can provide information unavailable online. Be sure to allow plenty of time for library research.

9.5 Summarize how to conduct an effective interview.

Prepare carefully for an interview by researching and creating a list of questions. Treat interviewees' time with respect and listen carefully to their responses to questions in order to follow up with clarification questions.

9.6 Explain five strategies for a methodical research process.

To conduct an efficient search, you need to develop a preliminary bibliography, locate resources, assess the usefulness of resources, read and record, and identify possible presentation aids.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Explain how you might use each of the five key sources of supporting material to help you develop an informative speech on how to choose a new computer.
2. **Ethics Assessment** Electronic and print indexes and databases sometimes include abstracts of books and articles rather than full texts. If you have read only the abstract of a source, is it ethical to include that source in your preliminary bibliography?
3. **Critical Assessment** You neglected to record complete bibliographic information for one of your best information sources, a journal article you found on a database. You discover your omission as you are reviewing your outline just before you deliver your speech and now you have no way to look up the information. How can you solve your problem in an ethical way? What are some ways you could have avoided this problem?

SUPPORTING YOUR SPEECH



OBJECTIVES

- **10.1** Explain the importance of and best practices for using illustrations in a speech.
- **10.2** Differentiate how descriptions and explanations are used in speeches.
- **10.3** Summarize how to use definitions in a speech.
- **10.4** Describe how to use analogies in a speech.
- **10.5** Explain how to effectively present statistics in a speech.
- **10.6** Describe the value of using opinions in a speech.
- **10.7** Select the best supporting material for a speech.

Once you have gathered a variety of appropriate supporting material, you will need to decide how to use your information to best advantage in your speech. Be sure to use oral or written citations as described in Chapter 4 to properly acknowledge sources of supporting material.

USE ILLUSTRATIONS

10.1 Explain the importance of and best practices for using illustrations in a speech.

A story or anecdote, also known as an **illustration**, almost always guarantees audience interest by appealing to their emotions.

- **Brief illustrations** are often no longer than a sentence or two. Sometimes a series of brief illustrations can have more impact than either a single brief illustration or a more detailed, extended illustration. Although an audience could dismiss a single illustration as an exception, two or more strongly suggest a trend or norm.

- **Extended illustrations** are longer and more detailed than brief illustrations; they resemble a story. They are vividly descriptive and they have a plot, which includes an opening, complications, a climax, and a resolution. Longer stories take more time, but they can be dramatic and emotionally compelling. Extended illustrations can work well as speech introductions.
- A **personal illustration**—sharing an experience with the audience—can help a speaker gain conviction and credibility. If you have had personal experience with your topic, consider relating that experience to the audience.
- **Hypothetical illustrations** describe situations or events that have not actually occurred but that *might* happen. Ethical speakers make their listeners aware that an illustration is hypothetical by using an introductory phrase such as, "Imagine that …".

To use illustrations effectively, be certain that your stories are directly relevant to the idea or point they are supposed to support. They should be typical of a situation or represent a trend. The best illustrations are personal ones that your listeners can imagine experiencing themselves. Include enough details to make the story vivid and specific to listeners.

USE DESCRIPTIONS AND EXPLANATIONS

10.2 Differentiate how descriptions and explanations are used in speeches.

An effective **description** provides the details that allow audience members to develop a mental picture of what a speaker is talking about. Good descriptions are vivid, accurate, and specific; they make people, places, and events come alive for the audience.

An **explanation** is a statement that clarifies how something is done or why it exists in its present form or existed in its past form. Speakers who discuss or

demonstrate processes of any kind rely at least in part on explanations of *how* those processes work. Explaining *why* involves giving causes or reasons for a policy, principle, or event. Explaining why some condition or event exists provides an analysis that often leads to better solutions.



Use Descriptions and Explanations

- Avoid overuse. Alternate descriptions and explanations with other types of support.
- Keep them brief. Supply only the necessary details.
- Be specific. Use vivid, concrete language that appeals to the senses.

PROVIDE DEFINITIONS

10.3 Summarize how to use definitions in a speech.

Definitions have two uses in speeches. First, speakers should be sure to define any and all specialized, technical, or little-known terms in their speeches. Such definitions are usually achieved by **classification**, the kind of definition you would find in a dictionary. Second, a speaker may define a term by showing how it works or how it is applied in a specific instance—what is known as an **operational definition**. For example, a speaker may define a disease such as rickets by explaining the effects on people who develop it, rather than using a dictionary definition.



Use Definitions Effectively

- Use a definition only when needed.
- Make definitions immediately and easily understandable to your audience.
- Be certain that your definition and your use of a term are consistent throughout a speech.

USE ANALOGIES

10.4 Describe how to use analogies in a speech.

An **analogy** is a comparison. Like a definition, an analogy increases understanding; unlike a definition, it deals with relationships and comparisons—between the new and the old, the unknown and the known, or any other pair of ideas or things. Analogies can help your listeners understand unfamiliar ideas, things, and situations by showing how these are similar to something they already know.

Literal Analogies

A **literal analogy** is a comparison between two similar things. For example, one speaker compared crustaceans, such as shrimp, to insects, noting that both are arthropods.[1] Literal analogies can help listeners from a different culture understand terms they may not be familiar with. To help the audience understand, make sure the two things you compare in a literal analogy are very similar.

Figurative Analogies

If you describe the relationships among a group of coworkers as a seething snake pit, filled with hissing gossip and sharp-fanged attacks, you are using a **figurative analogy**. A figurative analogy relies on imaginative insights. Be sure that the essential similarity between the two objects in a figurative analogy is readily apparent. For example, the main similarity between the snake pit and the work group is the strife between those in the same group. If the comparison is unclear, your audience can end up wondering what in the world you are talking about.

USE STATISTICS AS SUPPORT

10.5 Explain how to effectively present statistics in a speech.

Just as three or four brief examples may be more effective than just one, a statistic that represents hundreds or thousands of individuals may be more persuasive still. **Statistics** can help a speaker express the magnitude or seriousness of a situation. Or statistics can express the relationship of a part to the whole.

Use Reliable Sources

Statistics can be exploited to support almost any conclusion desired. As an ethical speaker, your goal is to cite *reputable*, *authoritative*, and *unbiased* sources.

- Reputable sources are those known to have expertise in research or the subject of the statistics.
- The most authoritative source is the *primary source*—the original collector and interpreter of the data. Go to the primary source as often as possible. Do not assume that a secondhand account, or *secondary source*, has reported the statistic accurately and fairly.
- Unbiased sources have no special interest in their statistics supporting any particular viewpoint. Government statistics and those from independent sources are generally considered unbiased.

As you evaluate your sources, try to find out how the statistics were gathered. For example, if a statistic relies on a sample, how was the sample taken? Sample sizes and survey methods do vary widely, but most legitimate polls involve samples of 500 to 2,000 people selected at random from a larger population.

Interpret Statistics Accurately

People are often swayed by statistics that sound good but have, in fact, been wrongly calculated or misinterpreted.

Both as a user of statistics in your own speeches and as a consumer of statistics in articles, books, and speeches, be constantly alert to what the statistics mean.

Making Statistics Understandable and Memorable

You can make your statistics easier to understand and more memorable in several ways.

- Dramatize a statistic by strategically choosing the perspective from which you present it. Does a genetic condition protect 10 percent of people from high blood pressure or, more dramatically, make it easier for 90 percent to develop high blood pressure?[2]
- Compact a statistic or express it in units that are more meaningful or more easily understandable to your audience. For example, you might express the amount of the national debt as the number of dollars per US adult.[3]
- Explode statistics. Exploded statistics are created by adding or multiplying related numbers—for example, cost per unit times number of units. Because it is larger, the exploded statistic seems more significant than the original figures from which it was derived.
- Compare statistics. Comparing your statistic with another heightens its impact.

QUICK CHECK

Select Effective Statistics

- Are the data from primary sources?
- Are the sources reputable, unbiased, and authoritative?
- Did you interpret the statistics accurately?
- Are the statistics easy to understand?
- Are they memorable?
- Can you convert the statistics into visual aids?

- Use visual aids to present your statistics. Displaying numbers in a table or graph in front of your listeners enables them to more easily grasp the statistics.

USE OPINIONS

10.6 Describe the value of using opinions in a speech.

Expert testimony, an opinion offered by someone who is an authority on a subject, can add a great deal of weight to your arguments. You may quote experts directly or paraphrase their words, if you are careful not to alter the intent of their remarks.

Like illustrations, **lay testimony** from someone who has experienced the event or situation firsthand can stir an audience's emotions. And, although neither as authoritative nor as unbiased as expert testimony, lay testimony is often more memorable.

Another way to make a point memorable is to include a **literary quotation** in your speech. You can easily access quotation dictionaries on the Web and in the reference sections of most libraries. Brief, pointed quotations usually have greater audience impact than longer ones.

Here are a few suggestions for using opinions effectively in your speeches.

- Be certain that any authority you cite is unbiased and an expert on the subject you are discussing.
- Cite your source properly and be sure to quote accurately.
- Use opinions that are representative of prevailing opinion.
- Limit quotations to one or two per speech.

SELECT THE BEST SUPPORTING MATERIAL

10.7 Select the best supporting material for a speech.

As previously discussed, you should consider accountability, accuracy, objectivity, timeliness, usability, and

diversity when evaluating any supporting material you hope to use. How do you decide what to use and what to eliminate?

- **Magnitude.** Bigger is better. The larger the numbers, the more convincing your statistics will be. The more experts who support your point of view, the more your expert testimony will command your audience's attention.
- **Relevance.** The best supporting material is whatever is the most relevant to your listeners, or the closest to home.
- **Concreteness.** If you need to discuss abstract ideas, explain them using concrete examples and specific statistics.
- **Variety.** A mix of illustrations, opinions, definitions, and statistics is much more interesting and convincing than the exclusive use of any one type of supporting material.
- **Humor.** Unless the topic is serious or somber, audiences usually appreciate a touch of humor in an example or opinion.
- **Suitability.** Your final decision about whether to use a certain piece of supporting material will depend on its suitability to you, your speech, the occasion, and your audience.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

10.1 Explain the importance of and best practices for using illustrations in a speech.

Brief, extended, personal, and hypothetical illustrations can catch listeners' interest and be effective supporting material for your main points.

10.2 Differentiate how descriptions and explanations are used in speeches.

Use vivid descriptions to help listeners visualize people, places, things, or events. Use specific, concrete explanations to show *how* something works or the reasons *why* something occurs or exists.

10.3 Summarize how to use definitions in a speech.

Use easily understandable dictionary and operational definitions to help audiences understand specialized, technical, or little-known terms.

10.4 Describe how to use analogies in a speech.

Use literal analogies to compare two similar things and imaginative figurative analogies to help grab your audience's attention.

10.5 Explain how to effectively present statistics in a speech.

Use statistics from reliable sources, interpret them accurately, and make them understandable to listeners by dramatizing, compacting, exploding, comparing, or showing visuals of them.

10.6 Describe the value of using opinions in a speech.

Expert testimony from a recognized authority can add weight to your arguments. The testimony of an ordinary (lay) person with firsthand or eyewitness experience can stir an audience's emotions. A quotation from a literary work can memorably make a point.

10.7 Select the best supporting material for a speech.

The best supporting materials are those with the most magnitude, relevance to the audience, concreteness, variety, and suitability to the audience. Some humor is usually welcome.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Describe how you can use each of the seven types of supporting material described in this chapter in your next speech.

2. **Ethics Assessment** You want to add an illustration to your speech that shares personal information about a friend. Should you ask your friend for permission first?
3. **Critical Assessment** Tony found just the statistics he needs on the internet. What information does he need to evaluate the statistics?

PART 4
Crafting a Speech



ORGANIZING YOUR SPEECH

OBJECTIVES

- **11.1** List and describe five patterns for organizing the main ideas of a speech.
- **11.2** Explain how to integrate supporting material into a speech.
- **11.3** Use verbal and nonverbal signposts to organize a speech for the ears of others.

Organize your main ideas and supporting materials in logical patterns to ensure that your audience can follow, understand, and remember what you say.

ORGANIZING YOUR MAIN IDEAS

11.1 List and describe five patterns for organizing the main ideas of a speech.

In Chapter 8, you learned how to generate a preliminary plan for your speech by determining whether your central idea had natural divisions, could be supported by several reasons, or could be explained by identifying specific steps.

Now you are ready to decide which of your main ideas to discuss first, second, and so on. The following five organizational patterns are most common:

1. topical
2. chronological
3. spatial
4. cause and effect
5. problem–solution

Organize Ideas Topically

If your central idea has natural divisions, you can often organize your speech topically. Speeches on such diverse topics as factors to consider when selecting a mountain bike, types of infertility treatments, and the various classes of ham-radio licenses all could reflect **topical organization**.

Natural divisions are often fairly equal in importance. It may not matter which point you discuss first, second, or third. You can simply arrange your main points as a matter of personal preference.

At other times, you may wish to organize your main points based on one of three principles: primacy, recency, or complexity.

- To use the principle of **primacy**, discuss your most important or convincing idea *first*. You should organize your main points according to primacy if your listeners are either unfamiliar with your topic or hostile toward your central idea.
- According to the principle of **recency**, the point discussed *last* is the one audiences will remember best.[1] If your audience is at least somewhat knowledgeable about and generally favorable toward your topic and central idea, you should probably organize your main points according to recency.
- If your main points range from simple to complicated, it makes sense to arrange them in order of **complexity**, progressing from the simple to the most complex.

Organize Ideas Chronologically

When your central idea can be explained best by a series of steps, chronological organization often makes sense. **Chronological organization** is organization by time or sequence; your steps are ordered according to when each occurred or should occur. Historical and how-to speeches are usually organized chronologically.

You can choose to organize your main points either from earliest to most recent (forward in time) or from recent events back into history (backward in time). The progression you choose depends on your personal preference and on whether you want to use the principles of primacy or recency to emphasize the beginning or the end of the sequence. However, how-to explanations are usually arranged forward in time, as a sequence or series of steps to follow from beginning to end.

Organize Ideas Spatially

A speaker who relies on **spatial organization** arranges ideas according to their physical locations or directions. Speeches on such diverse subjects as the National Museum of the American Indian, the travels of Robert Louis Stevenson, and the structure of an atom can all be organized spatially. It does not usually matter whether the speaker chooses to progress up or down, east or west, forward or back, as long as ideas are developed in a logical order.

Organize Ideas to Show Cause and Effect

A speech using a **cause-and-effect organization** might first identify a situation and then discuss the effects that result from it (cause→effect). For example, a speaker might describe a recent drought and then discuss its effects.

A speech could also present a situation and then seek its causes (effect→cause). Such a speaker might describe the recent drought and then talk about factors that created it.

As the recency principle would suggest, the cause–effect pattern emphasizes the effects; the effect–cause pattern emphasizes the causes.

Organize Ideas by Problem–Solution

If you want to emphasize how best to *solve* a problem, you will probably use a **problem–solution organization**.

Like causes and effects, problems and solutions can be discussed in either order:

- If listeners are already fairly aware of a problem but uncertain how to solve it, you will probably discuss the problem first and then the solution(s).
- If your audience knows about an action or program that has been implemented but does not know the reasons for its implementation, you might select a solution–problem pattern of organization.

Combine Multiple Patterns

You can combine several of these patterns. For example, you may use an overall cause–effect pattern, discussing a drought and then its effects. However, you may order your points about the effects topically—talking first about effects on crops, then on animals, and finally on people—or spatially, talking about effects in different geographical areas.

Acknowledge Cultural Differences in Organization

The five linear, direct organizational patterns discussed so far in this chapter descend from western European tradition and are not necessarily typical of all cultures.[2] Even within the United States, members of some cultures use other patterns of thought and organization for various occasions and audiences.[3] As an audience-centered speaker, you should investigate and perhaps acknowledge, or even consider adopting, the customary organizational strategy preferred by your listeners, even if it differs from your own. And as a listener who recognizes the existence of cultural differences, you can better appreciate and understand that a speaker from another culture may use organizational strategies different from those presented in this chapter.

ORGANIZING YOUR SUPPORTING MATERIAL

11.2 Explain how to integrate supporting material into a speech.

Suppose you have decided what supporting material to use and have identified the ideas in your speech that require support. Now you realize that in support of your second main idea you have an illustration, two statistics, and an opinion. In what order should you present these items?

You can sometimes use one of the five standard organizational patterns to arrange your supporting material. Illustrations, for instance, may be organized chronologically, as one speaker did when discussing technology:

> [M]iracle has followed upon miracle—from a television in every home in the 1950s, to the launching of the first communications satellite in the 1960s, to the introduction of cable TV in the 1970s, the rise of personal computers in the 1980s, the Internet in the 1990s, and social media in the 2000s.[4]

At other times, however, none of the five patterns may seem suited to the supporting materials you have. In those instances, you may need to turn to an organizational strategy more specifically adapted to your supporting materials. These strategies include (1) primacy or recency, (2) specificity, (3) complexity, and (4) "soft" to "hard" evidence.

Organize Supporting Material by Primacy or Recency

As we've discussed, the principles of primacy and recency can help you determine whether to put a main idea at the beginning or the end of your speech. You can use these principles to order your supporting material, too.

Suppose that you have several statistics to support a main point. All are relevant and significant, but one is especially gripping. You might opt to arrange the

statistics in your speech according to recency, saving the most dramatic one for last.

Organize Supporting Material by Specificity

Sometimes your supporting material will range from specific examples to more general overviews of a situation. You may either offer your specific information first and end with your general statement or make the general statement first and support it with specific evidence.

Organize Supporting Material by Complexity

You've seen that moving from the simple to the complex is one way you can organize your main ideas. The same method of organization may also be applied to supporting material. In many situations, it makes sense to start with the simplest ideas, which are easy to understand, and work up to more complex ones. For example, you might give a definition of an unfamiliar term before presenting a graph of statistics related to that term.

Organize Supporting Material from Soft to Hard Evidence

Supporting material can also be arranged from "soft" to "hard."

- **Soft evidence** rests on opinion or inference. Hypothetical illustrations, descriptions, explanations, definitions, analogies, and opinions are usually considered soft.
- **Hard evidence** includes factual examples and statistics.

To organize supporting materials in this order, you might tell a brief story about your own experience trying to use less water during a drought and then present expert opinions about the best ways to use less water, followed by statistics about which methods actually do use the least water. Soft to hard organization of supporting

material relies chiefly on the principle of recency—that the last statement is remembered best. In this example, your listeners would be likely to remember the most effective ways they can save water.

QUICK CHECK

Organizing Your Supporting Material

- Primacy: most important material first
- Recency: most important material last
- Specificity: from specific information to general overview or from general overview to specific information
- Complexity: from simple to more complex material
- Soft to hard evidence: from opinion or hypothetical illustration to fact or statistic

ORGANIZING YOUR PRESENTATION FOR THE EARS OF OTHERS: SIGNPOSTING

11.3 Use verbal and nonverbal signposts to organize a speech for the ears of others.

You have a logically ordered, fairly complete plan for your speech. But if you delivered your speech at this point, your audience might become frustrated or confused as they tried to figure out your organizational plan. So your next task is to develop **signposts**, which are organizational cues for your audience's ears. Signposts include previews, transitions, and summaries.

One significant difference between writing and public speaking is that public speaking is more repetitive. Audience-centered speakers need to remember that listeners, unlike readers, cannot go back to review a missed point. Using signposts like previews, summaries, and transitions not only helps your audience follow the organization of your speech but also builds repetition of key

points into your speech, so that audience members are less likely to miss them.

Develop Previews

As its name indicates, a **preview** is a statement of what is to come. Previews help to ensure that audience members will first anticipate and later remember the important points of a speech. Two types of previews are usually used in speeches: initial previews and internal previews.

Initial Previews An **initial preview** is a statement of what the main ideas of the speech will be. As discussed in Chapter 8, it is usually presented in conjunction with the central idea at or near the end of the introduction, as a *blueprint* for the speech. For example, your blueprint might be, "The recent drought is the cause of severe problems for all living things in our area. It has produced ill effects on crops, animals, and people."

Internal Previews In addition to near the beginning of a speech, speakers use previews at various points throughout a speech. These **internal previews** introduce and outline ideas that will be developed as the speech progresses. Sometimes speakers phrase internal previews in the form of questions they plan to answer. One student speaker offers the following internal preview in her problem–solution speech on how social media negatively impacts body image:

> Now that you know the scope of the problem, let's focus on the solution. So, you are probably wondering, what can we do?[5]

Just as anticipating an idea helps audience members remember it, mentally answering a question helps them plant the answer firmly in their minds.

Develop Transitions

A **transition** is a verbal or nonverbal signal that a speaker has finished discussing one idea and is moving to another.

Verbal Transitions A speaker can sometimes make a **verbal transition** simply by repeating a key word from a previous statement or by using a synonym or a pronoun that refers to a prior key word or idea. This type of transition is often used to make one sentence flow smoothly into the next. (The previous sentence itself is an example: "This type of transition" refers to the sentence that precedes it.)

Other verbal transitions are words or phrases that show relationships between ideas. Note the italicized transitional phrases in the following examples:

- *In addition to* transitions, previews and summaries are *also* considered to be signposts.
- *Not only* does plastic packaging use up our scarce resources, but it contaminates them *as well*.
- *In other words*, as women's roles have changed, they have *also* contributed to this effect.
- *In summary*, Fanny Brice is probably the best-known star of the Ziegfeld Follies.
- *Therefore*, I recommend that you sign the grievance petition.

Simple enumeration (*first, second, third*) can also point up relationships between ideas and provide transitions.



Transition to Your Conclusion

One type of verbal transition that can occasionally backfire and do more harm than good is one that signals the end of a speech. The words *finally* and *in conclusion* give the audience implicit permission to stop listening, and they often do. Better strategies for moving into your conclusion include the following:

- Repeat a key word or phrase.
- Use a synonym or pronoun that refers to a previous idea.
- Offer a final summary.
- Refer to the introduction of your speech.

Nonverbal Transitions A **nonverbal transition** can occur in several ways, sometimes alone and sometimes in combination with a verbal transition. A change in facial expression, a pause, an altered vocal pitch or speaking rate, and a movement all may indicate a transition. For example, a speaker talking about the value of cardiopulmonary resuscitation began his speech with a powerful anecdote about a man suffering a heart attack at a party. No one knew how to help, and the man died. The speaker then looked up from his notes and paused, while maintaining eye contact with his audience. His next words were, "The real tragedy of Bill Jorgen's death was that it should not have happened." His pause, as well as the words that followed, indicated a transition into the body of the speech.

Most good speakers use a combination of verbal and nonverbal transitions to move from one point to another through their speeches. You will learn more about nonverbal communication in Chapter 17.

Develop Summaries

Like a preview, a **summary**, or recap of what has been said, provides your listeners with additional exposure to your ideas and can help ensure that they will grasp and remember your message. Most speakers use two types of summaries: *the internal summary* and *the final summary*.

Internal Summary As the term suggests, an **internal summary** occurs within the body of a speech; it restates the ideas that have been developed up to that point. You can use an internal summary after discussing two or three points to keep those points fresh in the minds of the audience as the speech progresses.

Speakers often combine an internal summary and internal preview to form a transition. For example, you might say, "Now that I've detailed the devastating crop losses caused by the drought and the large losses in animal populations, I want to tell you what the drought has done to us humans."

Final Summary A **final summary** restates the main ideas of a speech and gives listeners their *last* exposure to those ideas. It occurs just before the end of a speech, acting as a transition between the body and the conclusion. Your final summary should leave listeners in no doubt as to the important points of your speech.

QUICK CHECK

Types of Signposts

- Initial previews
- Internal previews
- Verbal transitions
- Nonverbal transitions
- Internal summaries
- Final summaries



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

11.1 List and describe five patterns for organizing the main ideas of a speech.

Topical, chronological, spatial, cause and effect, and problem–solution are five common patterns of organization. Sometimes these patterns are combined. As an audience-centered speaker, keep in mind that these five patterns descend from western European tradition and are not necessarily typical of all cultures.

11.2 Explain how to integrate supporting material into a speech.

You can organize the supporting material for each main idea according to one of the five common

patterns: primacy, recency, specificity, complexity, or soft-to-hard evidence.

11.3 Use verbal and nonverbal signposts to organize a speech for the ears of others.

Signposts include verbal and nonverbal transitions, previews, and summaries. They are used to help you communicate your organization to your audience.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Take notes while listening to either a live or recorded speech. Try to determine the speaker's organizational strategy, the reasons for it, and its effectiveness. Note whether the speaker used signposts to help you follow the organization.
2. **Ethics Assessment** Is there an ethical distinction between primacy and recency? If a speaker has a statistic that offers overwhelming evidence of the severity of a given problem, for example, is it ethical for the speaker to save that statistic for last? Should the speaker reveal immediately to the audience how severe the problem really is?
3. **Critical Assessment** Which organizational pattern is most appropriate for the main points suggested in the following central ideas?
   - There are at least three distinct theories about what happened to the dinosaurs.
   - The new university multipurpose sports center will be divided into several zones to serve students' activity needs.

OUTLINING AND REVISING YOUR SPEECH



OBJECTIVES

12.1 Develop a preparation outline for a speech.

12.2 Prepare speaking notes for a speech.

DEVELOP A PREPARATION OUTLINE

12.1 Develop a preparation outline for a speech.

Although some speeches are written in paragraph form, most speakers develop a **preparation outline** that includes the following:

- central idea
- main ideas
- subpoints
- supporting material
- the speech's specific purpose
- introduction
- blueprint
- key signposts
- conclusion
- references (optional)

To begin your preparation outline, you might turn to the strategy of clustering, which is a visual mapping strategy. As you write down your main ideas, subpoints, and supporting material for the speech, use geometric shapes and arrows to indicate the logical relationships among them.

Whatever technique you choose to begin your outline, your ultimate goal is to produce a plan that lets you judge the unity and coherence of your speech, determine

how well the parts fit together, and see how smoothly the speech flows. The following suggestions will help you complete your preparation outline. However, keep in mind that different instructors may have different expectations for what an outline must include and how it is formatted. Be sure to understand and follow your own instructor's guidelines.

Use Complete Sentences

Unless you write your preparation outline in complete sentences, you will have trouble judging the coherence of the speech. Moreover, complete sentences will help during your early rehearsals. If you write cryptic phrases, you may not remember what they mean.

Use Standard Outline Formatting

Although you did not have to use standard outline formatting when you began to outline your ideas, you need to do so now. **Standard outline formatting** lets you see at a glance the exact relationships among the various main ideas and supporting material in your speech. It is an important tool for evaluating your speech. To produce a correct outline, follow the instructions in the How To box and the model in Figure 12.1.

Figure 12.1 Standard Outline Formatting. It is unlikely that you will subdivide beyond the level of lowercase letters (a, b, c) in most speech outlines, but next would come numbers in parentheses and then lowercase letters in parentheses.

I. First main idea
   A. First subpoint of I
   B. Second subpoint of I
      1. First subpoint of B
      2. Second subpoint of B
         a. First subpoint of 2
         b. Second subpoint of 2
II. Second main idea



Use Standard Outline Formatting

- Properly indent main ideas, subpoints, and supporting material, as shown in Figure 12.1.
- Use at least two subpoints, if any, for each main idea. Logic dictates that you cannot divide anything into one part.
- If you have only one piece of supporting material, incorporate it into the subpoint or main idea that it supports.
- If you have only one subpoint, incorporate it into the main idea that precedes it.
- If you have more than five subpoints, you may want to place some of them under another point. An audience will remember your ideas more easily if they are divided into blocks of no more than five.

Write and Label Your Specific Purpose at the Top of Your Preparation Outline

Do not work the specific purpose into the outline itself. Instead, label it and place it at the top of the outline. Your specific purpose can serve as a yardstick by which to measure the relevance of each main idea and piece of supporting material. Everything in the speech should contribute to your specific purpose.

Add the Blueprint, Key Signposts, Introduction, and Conclusion to Your Outline

Place the introduction after the statement of your specific purpose, the blueprint immediately following the introduction, and the conclusion after the outline of the body of the speech. Other key signposts can be placed (where needed) within the outline.

Analyze Your Preparation Outline

Once you have completed your preparation outline, you can use it to help analyze and possibly revise your

speech. The following questions can help you in this critical thinking task.

- **Does the speech as outlined fulfill the purpose you have specified?** If not, revise the specific purpose or change the direction and content of the speech itself.
- **Are the main ideas logical extensions (natural divisions, reasons, or steps) of the central idea?** If not, revise either the central idea or the main ideas.
- **Do the signposts enhance the flow of one idea into the next?** If not, change or add previews, summaries, or transitions.
- **Does each subpoint provide support for the point under which it falls?** If not, then either move or delete the subpoint.
- **Is your outline form correct?** For a quick reference, refer to the How To box and Figure 12.1.

Having considered these questions, you are ready to rehearse your speech using the preparation outline as your first set of notes.

PREPARING YOUR SPEAKING NOTES

12.2 Prepare speaking notes for a speech.

As you rehearse your speech, you will find that you need your preparation outline less and less. Both the structure and the content of your speech will become set in your mind. At this point, you are ready to prepare a shorter outline to serve as your **speaking notes**.

This shorter outline should provide enough clearly formatted details to ensure that you can present your speech the way you intended in your preparation outline. However, your speaking notes should not be so detailed that you will be tempted to read them word for word to your audience.[1] Use the following suggestions for developing speaking notes.

Choose Your Technology

You may decide to display your outline on a smartphone or electronic tablet—perhaps using one of several apps available for speaking notes—or you may opt to use old-fashioned note cards. Regardless of which technology you select, make sure your letters and words are large enough to be read easily.

Even if you plan to use an electronic option, you may want to have a backup outline on note cards in case of technical difficulty. Note cards don't rustle like paper does, and they are small enough to hold in one hand. Write on one side only and number your note cards in case they get out of order just before or during your speech.

Use Standard Outline Formatting

If you use standard outline formatting, you'll have an easier time finding your place when you glance down at your speaking notes. You will know, for example, that your second main idea is indicated by "II." In addition, lay out your outline so your introduction, each main idea, and your conclusion are distinct.

Include Your Introduction and Conclusion in Abbreviated Form

Even if your instructor does not require you to include your introduction and conclusion on your preparation outline, include abbreviated versions of them in your speaking notes. You might feel more comfortable delivering the presentation if you have your first and last sentences written out in front of you.

Include Your Central Idea and Not Your Specific-Purpose Statement

Be sure to include your central idea. But as you will not actually state your specific-purpose statement during your presentation, do not put it in your speaking notes.

Include Supporting Material and Signposts

Write out in full any statistics and direct quotations and their sources. Also write out your key signposts—your initial preview, for example—to help you transition smoothly from one idea to the next.

Include Delivery Cues

Write in your speaking notes such cues as "Louder," "Pause," or "Walk two steps left." However, be sure to write or format your delivery cues in a different color or font so you don't confuse them with your verbal content.

QUICK CHECK

Preparation Outline and Speaking Notes

Preparation	Delivery
Use complete sentences.	Use single words and phrases.
Write out full introduction and conclusion.	Abbreviate your introduction and conclusion.
Add blueprint and all signposts.	Keep only statistics, direct quotations, and key signposts.
Place specific-purpose statement at the top.	Omit specific-purpose statement.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

12.1 Develop a preparation outline for a speech.

A preparation outline includes your central idea, main ideas, subpoints, and supporting material; it may also include your specific purpose, introduction, blueprint,

key signposts, conclusion, and references. Write each of these elements in complete sentences and use standard outline formatting. Use the preparation outline to begin rehearsing your speech and to help you revise it, if necessary.

12.2 Prepare speaking notes for a speech.

Speaking notes are less detailed than a preparation outline and usually include your central idea, supporting material, signposts, and delivery cues. Your notes may also include abbreviated versions of your introduction and conclusion.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Different instructors have different expectations for outline content and format. Obtain your own instructor's guidelines and compare them to the advice in this chapter.
2. **Ethics Assessment** Can a speaker legitimately claim that a speech is extemporaneous if they have constructed a detailed preparation outline?
3. **Critical Assessment** Myorka thinks it is silly to worry about using standard outline formatting for either her preparation outline or her speaking notes. Do you agree with her? Why or why not?



DEVELOPING AN INTRODUCTION

OBJECTIVES

13.1 Explain the functions of a speech introduction.

13.2 List and discuss methods for introducing a speech.

PURPOSES OF INTRODUCTIONS

13.1 Explain the functions of a speech introduction.

Many speakers think that drafting an introduction is the first task in preparing a speech, but it is actually more often the last. A key purpose of your introduction is to provide an overview of your message. How can you do that until you know what the message is going to be? Nonetheless, the introduction is too important to the overall success of your speech to be left to chance or last-minute preparation.

The introduction provides your audience with important first impressions of you and your speech, and its main job is to convince your audience to listen to you. Specifically, a good introduction must perform five important functions:

1. Get the audience's attention.
2. Introduce the subject.
3. Give the audience a reason to listen.
4. Establish your credibility.
5. Preview your main ideas.

Get the Audience's Attention

A key purpose of the introduction is to gain favorable attention for your speech. Because listeners form their first impressions of a speech quickly, the introduction must capture their attention and cast the speech in a favorable light or the rest of the speech may be wasted on them.

We emphasize *favorable* attention for a good reason. By all means, be creative with your speech introductions. But also use common sense in deciding how best to gain the favorable attention of your listeners. Alienating them is even worse than boring them.

Introduce the Subject

The most obvious purpose of an introduction is to introduce the subject of a speech. Within a few seconds after you begin your speech, the audience should have a pretty good idea of what you are going to talk about. The best way to ensure that your introduction does indeed introduce your topic is to state your central idea in the introduction.

Give the Audience a Reason to Listen

After you have captured the attention of your audience and introduced the topic, you have to give the audience some reason to want to listen to the rest of your speech. An unmotivated listener quickly tunes out.

You can help establish listening motivation by showing the members of your audience how the topic affects them. One criterion for determining the effectiveness of your supporting material is *relevance*, the degree to which the information affects your listeners directly. Just as relevance is important to supporting materials, it is also important to speech introductions. "This concerns me" is a powerful reason to listen.

It does not matter so much *how* or *when* you demonstrate relevance. But it is essential that you do at some

point establish that your topic is of vital personal interest or concern to your listeners.

Establish Your Credibility

Credibility is a speaker's believability. A credible speaker is one whom listeners judge to be a believable authority and a competent speaker. A credible speaker is also someone listeners believe they can trust. If you can establish your credibility early in a speech, it will help motivate your audience to listen.

Preview Your Main Ideas

A final purpose of the introduction is to preview the main ideas of your speech. An initial preview statement usually comes near the end of the introduction, included in or immediately following a statement of the central idea. This initial preview allows your listeners to anticipate the main ideas of your speech, which in turn helps ensure that they will remember those ideas after the speech.

As we discussed in Chapter 11, an initial preview statement is an organizational strategy called a *signpost*. Just as signs posted along a highway tell you what is coming up, a signpost in your speech tells the listeners



Establish Credibility during Your Introduction

1. **Be well prepared.** Thorough research and good organization help give the audience confidence that you know what you are talking about.
2. **Appear confident.** Speaking fluently while maintaining eye contact does much to convey a sense of confidence. If you seem to have confidence in yourself, your audience will have confidence in you.
3. **Tell the audience about your personal experience with your topic.** Instead of considering you boastful, most audience members will listen to you with respect.

what to expect by enumerating the ideas or points that you plan to present. Identifying your main ideas helps organize the message and enhances listeners' learning.

QUICK CHECK

Purposes of Introductions

Purpose	Method
Get the audience's attention.	Avoid alienating your listeners.
Introduce the subject.	Present your central idea to your audience.
Give the audience a reason.	Tell your listeners how the topic affects them directly.
Establish your credibility.	Prepare, look confident, and offer your credentials.
Preview your main ideas.	Tell your audience what you are going to tell them.

EFFECTIVE INTRODUCTIONS

13.2 List and discuss methods for introducing a speech.

There are several effective methods for developing speech introductions. Not every method is appropriate for every speech, but chances are that you can discover among these alternatives at least one type of introduction to fit the topic and purpose of your speech, whatever they might be.

Use Illustrations or Anecdotes

An illustration or **anecdote** can provide the basis for an effective speech introduction. In fact, if you have an especially compelling illustration that you had planned to use in the body of the speech, you might do well to use it in your introduction instead. A relevant and interesting anecdote will introduce your subject and almost invariably gain an audience's attention.

Present Startling Facts or Statistics

A second method of introducing a speech is to use a startling fact or statistic. Grabbing an audience's attention with amazing or shocking information invariably motivates them to listen further and helps them remember afterward what you had to say.

Use Quotations

Using an appropriate quotation to introduce a speech is a common practice. Often another writer or speaker has expressed an opinion on your topic that is more authoritative, comprehensive, or memorable than what you can say. However, use quotations only if they are extremely interesting, compelling, or very much to the point. Using a quotation to open every speech can become a lazy habit.

Incorporate Appropriate Humor

Humor, handled well, can be a wonderful attention-getter. It can help relax your audience and win their goodwill for the rest of the speech.

If your audience is linguistically diverse, you may want to choose an introduction strategy other than humor. Much humor is created by verbal plays on words and may not translate well with people who do not speak the same language.

Certain subjects are also inappropriate for humor. It would hardly be appropriate to open a speech on world hunger with a funny story. Used with discretion, however, humor can provide a lively, interesting, and appropriate introduction for many speeches.

Ask Questions

Questions are commonly combined with another method of introduction. Either by themselves or in tandem with another method of introduction, questions can provide effective openings for speeches. For example, you may ask, "Do you know how many of today's college

graduates hold more than $100,000 in student debt?" and then present a startling statistic that answers your question.

When using a question to open a speech, you will generally use a **rhetorical question**, the kind to which you don't expect an answer. A rhetorical question can prompt your listeners' mental participation in your introduction by getting their attention and giving them a reason to listen.

Refer to Historical Events

Another way to begin a speech is by drawing a relationship between a historic event that happened on that day and your speech objective. An internet search for "this date in history" will reveal many possible events. Be sure the historical reference you choose is clearly linked to the specific purpose of your speech.

Refer to Recent Events

If your topic is timely, a reference to a recent event can be a good way to open your speech. An opening taken from a recent news story can take the form of an illustration, a startling statistic, or even a quotation. Referring to a recent event increases your credibility by showing that you are knowledgeable about current affairs.

"Recent" does not necessarily mean a story that broke just last week or even last month. An event that occurred within the past year or so can be considered recent. Even a particularly significant event that is slightly older can qualify.

Reveal Something about Yourself

A reference to yourself can take several forms. You might reveal your reason for interest in the topic. You might express appreciation at having been asked to speak. Or you might share a personal experience. Whatever form of personal reference you use, the purpose is to establish a bond between you and your audience.

Make Note of the Occasion

References to the occasion are often made at weddings, birthday parties, dedication ceremonies, and other such events. A reference to the occasion can also be combined with other methods of introduction, such as an illustration or a rhetorical question.

Acknowledge Preceding Speeches

If your speech is one of several being presented on the same occasion, you will usually not know until shortly before your own speech what other speakers will say. Few experiences will make your stomach sink faster than hearing a speaker just ahead of you speak on your topic. Worse still, that speaker may even use some of the same supporting materials you had planned to use. When this situation occurs, it may be wise to refer to a preceding speech. If the other speaker has spoken on a topic closely related to your own, you can draw an analogy. In a sense, your introduction becomes a transition from that earlier speech to yours.

QUICK CHECK

Effective Introduction Techniques

- Use an illustration or anecdote.
- Present startling facts or statistics.
- Share a quotation.
- Employ appropriate humor.
- Ask a question.
- Refer to historical or recent events.
- Reveal something about yourself.
- Make note of the occasion.
- Acknowledge the speeches before yours.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

13.1 Explain the functions of a speech introduction.
A good introduction captures the audience's attention, introduces your subject, gives the audience a reason to listen, establishes your credibility, and previews your main ideas.

13.2 List and discuss methods for introducing a speech.
Effective introduction methods include illustrations or anecdotes, startling facts or statistics, quotations, humor, questions, references to historical or recent events, personal references, references to the occasion, or references to preceding speeches, used alone or in combination.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** How could you motivate your classroom audience to listen to you on each of these topics: cholesterol, Elvis Presley, the history of tattoos, deforestation, distracted driving?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Mardi tells her public speaking classmate Shanna about an illustration she thinks will make an effective introduction. Shanna thinks it would make a great introduction for her own speech, which is on a different topic. Shanna learns that she is scheduled to speak before Mardi. She badly wants to use the illustration that Mardi discovered. Can she ethically do so?
3. **Critical Assessment** Nikai is planning an informational speech in which he will demonstrate Native American musical instruments. What is a good way for Nikai to introduce his speech?



DEVELOPING A CONCLUSION

OBJECTIVES

14.1 Explain the functions of a speech conclusion.

14.2 List and discuss methods for concluding a speech.

PURPOSES OF CONCLUSIONS

14.1 Explain the functions of a speech conclusion.

Just as most fireworks displays end with a grand finale, your speech should end, not necessarily with fireworks, but with a conclusion worthy of your well-crafted message. Long after you finish speaking, your audience is likely to remember the effect, if not the content, of your closing remarks. An effective conclusion will serve two purposes: It will summarize the speech, and it will provide closure.

Summarize the Speech

The end of your speech is your last chance to impress the central idea on your audience, and it provides you the opportunity to do it in such a way that they cannot help but remember. The conclusion is also your last chance to repeat your main ideas for the audience.

Reemphasize the Central Idea in a Memorable Way

Many of the most memorable quotations from famous speakers were the conclusions of their speeches. When on July 4, 1939, New York Yankees legend Lou Gehrig addressed his fans in an emotional farewell to a baseball career cut short by a diagnosis of amyotrophic lateral

sclerosis (ALS), he concluded with the memorable line, "I may have had a tough break, but I have an awful lot to live for."[1] With practice, most people can prepare similarly effective conclusions. Begin by using the ideas in Chapter 15 for using language to make your statements more memorable. The end of your speech is your last chance to impress the central idea on your audience. Do it in such a way that they cannot help but remember it.

Restate the Main Ideas Most speakers summarize their main ideas in the first part of the conclusion or as part of the transition between the body of the speech and its conclusion.

Provide Closure

Probably the most obvious purpose of a conclusion is to provide **closure**—to let the audience know that the speech has ended. Use verbal and nonverbal signals, such as those described in the How To box, to let your audience know you are closing your speech.



Signal the End of Your Speech

Verbal Signals

- Use such transition words and phrases as *finally, for my last point, in conclusion*, and so on.
- A concluding transition should be followed quickly by your final statement so listeners do not "tune out" too soon.

Nonverbal Signals

- Pause between the body of your speech and its conclusion.
- Slow your speaking rate.
- Move out from behind the podium to make a final impassioned plea.
- Use a falling vocal inflection for your final statement.

Motivate the Audience to Respond At the beginning of your speech, your goal was to motivate your audience to listen to you. At the end, you want to motivate listeners to respond to your message. If your speech is informative, you may want the audience to think about the topic or to research it further. If your speech is persuasive, you may want your audience to take some sort of appropriate action—write a letter, buy a product, make a telephone call, or get involved in a cause. In fact, an *action* step is essential to the persuasive organizational strategy called the *motivated sequence*, discussed in Chapter 24. When audience members feel they are or could be personally involved or affected, they are more likely to respond to your message.[2]

QUICK CHECK

Purposes of Conclusions

Summarize the Speech

- Reemphasize the central idea in a memorable way.
- Restate your main ideas.

Provide Closure

- Use verbal or nonverbal cues to signal the end of the speech.
- Motivate the audience to respond.

EFFECTIVE CONCLUSIONS

14.2 List and discuss methods for concluding a speech.

Effective conclusions may employ illustrations, quotations, personal references, or any of the other methods used for introductions we have discussed. In addition, there are at least two other distinct ways of concluding a speech: with a reference to the introduction and with an inspirational appeal or challenge.

Refer to the Introduction

The following are excellent ways to provide closure in the conclusion:

- Finish a story from your introduction.
- Answer your opening rhetorical question.
- Remind the audience of the startling fact or statistic you presented in the introduction.

Like bookends, a related introduction and conclusion provide unified support for the ideas in between.

Make an Inspirational Appeal or Challenge

Another way to end your speech is to issue an inspirational appeal or challenge to your listeners, rousing them to a high emotional pitch. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. stirred his audience with the famous inspirational closing to his "I Have a Dream" speech. When you use this method, the conclusion becomes the climax toward which your entire speech builds.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

14.1 Explain the functions of a speech conclusion.
The two main purposes of the conclusion are to summarize your speech in a memorable way and to provide closure.

14.2 List and discuss methods for concluding a speech.
Effective conclusions may employ any one of the same methods used for introductions. In addition, you can refer to the introduction or make inspirational appeals or challenges in your conclusion.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Knowing that you have recently visited the Vietnam Veterans Memorial in Washington, DC, your American history professor asks you to make a brief presentation to the class about the Wall: its history; its symbolic meaning; and its impact on the families, comrades, and friends of those memorialized there. Write both an introduction and a conclusion for this speech.
2. **Ethics Assessment** You believe the closing words used by a famous speaker would provide the most effective conclusion for your own speech. How could you ethically use the famous speaker's inspirational words?
3. **Critical Assessment** Many public speaking instructors advise against saying, "in conclusion."[3] Why might you want to avoid this transitional phrase?



USING WORDS WELL

OBJECTIVES

15.1 Describe three differences between oral and written language styles.

15.2 List and explain three ways to use words effectively.

15.3 Discuss how to adapt your language style to diverse listeners.

15.4 List and explain three types of memorable word structures.

ORAL VERSUS WRITTEN LANGUAGE STYLE

15.1 Describe three differences between oral and written language styles.

Your instructor has probably told you not to write your speech out word-for-word. This admonition stems from at least three major differences between oral and written language styles.

- **Oral style is more personal.** When speaking, you can look your listeners in the eye and talk to them directly. That personal contact affects your speech and your verbal style. As a speaker, you are likely to use more pronouns (*I, you*) than you would in writing. You are also more likely to address specific audience members by name.
- **Oral style is less formal.** Memorized speeches usually sound as if they were written because the words and phrases are longer, more complex, and more formal than those used by most speakers. Oral style,

on the other hand, is characterized by "looser construction, repetition, rephrasing, and comment clauses ('you know')."[1]

- **Oral style is more repetitious.** When you're listening to a speech, you don't have opportunities to stop and reread, look up unfamiliar words, or ask for help if you don't understand something. For this reason, an oral style is and should be more repetitious. Speakers build in repetition in previews, transitions, and summaries to make sure that listeners will grasp their messages.

USE WORDS EFFECTIVELY

15.2 List and explain three ways to use words effectively.

Although your speech will be more personal, less formal, and more repetitive than a term paper written on the same topic, you will still want to ensure that your message is clear, accurate, and memorable. Your spoken words should be specific, concrete, simple, correct, and concise.

Use Specific, Concrete Words

Specific words are often concrete words, which appeal to one of our five senses, whereas general words are often abstract words, which refer to ideas or qualities. A linguistic theory known as *general semantics* holds that the more concrete your words are, the clearer your communication will be.[2]

Specific, concrete nouns create memorable images; likewise, specific, concrete verbs can be especially effective. It is more memorable, for example, to say, "The leaves of plants in the fields are shredded to tatters," than to say, "The hailstorm severely damaged crops."

Use Simple Words

The best language is often the simplest. Your words should be immediately understandable to your listeners. Don't try to impress them with jargon and pompous wording.

Use Words Correctly

Your effectiveness with your audience depends in part on your ability to use the English language correctly. If you are unsure of a grammatical rule, refer to a good English usage handbook. If you are unsure of a word's pronunciation, use a dictionary. Major online dictionaries provide recordings of the correct pronunciation of words. Consult dictionaries to confirm word meanings, too, but remember that language operates on two levels.

1. The **denotation** of a word is its literal meaning, the definition you find in a dictionary. For example, the denotation of the word *table* is a piece of furniture consisting of a smooth, flat slab with affixed legs.
2. The **connotation** of a word is the unique meaning we associate with the word, based on our past experiences. The word *table* may evoke for one listener an image of their family's old oak table where they once played checkers with their grandmother. As a public speaker, you should be aware that audience members' personal connotations contribute to the meaning of your words. This awareness is particularly important when you are discussing highly emotional or controversial topics.

Use Words Concisely

Your goal should be to use only as many words as are necessary to convey your message. The How To box offers suggestions for using language concisely.



Use Language Concisely

- Eliminate phrases that add no meaning to your message, such as "In my opinion" (just state the opinion) or "Before I begin, I'd like to say" (you've already begun—just say it).
- Avoid narrating your speaking technique. There is no need to say, "Here's an interesting story that I think you will like." Just tell the story.
- Avoid using a long phrase when a short one will do. Here are some examples:

Instead of saying . . .	*Say . . .*
So, for that reason	So
Due to the fact	Because
But at the same time	But
In the final analysis	Finally

ADAPTING YOUR LANGUAGE STYLE TO DIVERSE LISTENERS

15.3 Discuss how to adapt your language style to diverse listeners.

To communicate successfully with the diverse group of listeners who comprise your audience, make sure your language is understandable, respectful, and inclusive.

Use Language Your Audience Can Understand

Even if you and all your public speaking classmates speak English, you probably speak many varieties of the language, including the following:

- **Ethnic vernacular**, such as "Spanglish," African American Vernacular English (AAVE), or Cajun
- **Regionalisms**, words or phrases specific to one part of the country but rarely used in quite the same way in other places
- **Jargon**, the specialized language of a particular profession or interest group

If you're giving a speech to others who share your ethnic, regional, or professional background, you can communicate successfully with them using these specialized varieties of English. However, if you're presenting to a more diverse audience, use **Standard American English (SAE)**. SAE is the language taught by schools and used in the media, business, and the government in the United States. *Standard* does not imply that SAE is inherently right and all other forms are wrong, but only that it conforms to a standard most speakers of American English can readily understand.

Use Respectful Language

Be mindful of any language that could be offensive to people of particular ethnic, racial, cultural, and religious backgrounds; social classes; sexual orientations; gender identities; or to people with disabilities. A speaker whose language offends or defames any group is not only speaking unethically but also running a great risk of antagonizing audience members.

Use Unbiased Language

Not many years ago, a singular masculine pronoun (*he, him, his*) was the accepted way to refer in speaking or writing to a person of unspecified gender. This usage is now recognized to be sexist and exclusionary. Once used only as plural pronouns, the more inclusive *they, them*, and *their* are considered correct singular gender-neutral forms today by academic and journalistic style guides, including those of the APA, MLA, and *New York Times* ("Everyone should bring *their* book to class tomorrow"). Another option is to reword the sentence so that it is plural and, thus, gender neutral ("All students should bring *their* books to class tomorrow").

The use of a masculine noun to refer generically to all people is also considered sexist. Instead of masculine nouns such as *waiter, fireman*, and *congressman*, choose gender-neutral alternatives such as *server, firefighter*, and *member of Congress*.

In addition, you should avoid sexist language that patronizes or stereotypes people. Even with good intentions and deliberate forethought, you can find yourself at times caught in a bind. For example, suppose that Dr. Pierce is a young, African American, female MD. If you avoid mentioning her age, race, and gender when referring to her, you may reinforce your listeners' stereotypical image of a physician as middle-aged, white, and male. But if you *do* mention these facts about Dr. Pierce, you may be suspected of implying that her achievement is unusual. There is no easy answer to this dilemma or others like it. You will have to consider your audience, your purpose, and the occasion when deciding how best to identify Dr. Pierce.

QUICK CHECK

Use Words Effectively

- Are your words specific and concrete?
- Is your language immediately understandable to your listeners?
- Do you use the English language correctly?
- Are your words concise?
- Is your language respectful to your audience?
- Is your language unbiased?

CRAFT MEMORABLE WORD STRUCTURES

15.4 List and explain three types of memorable word structures.

Memorable speeches are stylistically distinctive. They create arresting images. And they have what a marketing communication specialist has termed "ear appeal."[3]

Create Figurative Images

Figurative language deviates from the ordinary, expected meanings of words to make a description or comparison unique, vivid, and memorable. Common

figurative language includes metaphors, similes, and personification.

Use Metaphors and Similes A **metaphor** is an implied comparison. For example, "He is a snake." A **simile** is a less direct comparison that includes the word *like* or *as*. For example, "His lies make him as slippery as a snake."

Use Personification **Personification** is the attribution of human qualities to inanimate things or ideas. If, for example, you say that the sun smiles upon your city, you are personifying the sun.

Speakers often turn to figurative language in times that are especially momentous or overwhelming, times when literal language seems insufficient. During the first weeks of the COVID-19 pandemic, people used a variety of metaphors to refer to the novel coronavirus, including the "masked enemy," "Black Death," and "an invisible bomb."[4] Such language is sometimes referred to as **crisis rhetoric**.

Create Drama

Another way you can make phrases and sentences memorable is to use them to create drama in your speech—to keep the audience in suspense or to catch them slightly off guard by phrasing something in a way that differs from the way they expect you to say it.

Sentence Length Use a short sentence to emphasize an important idea by stating it in a few well-chosen words. Short, simple sentences can have much the same power as short, simple words.

Omission Use **omission**. Leave out a word or phrase that the audience expects to hear. For example, a speaker might omit the words *mountain climbers* to add drama, saying, "Only 5 of the 16 who set out to scale the peak would ever return." When you use omission, be sure listeners will understand the words you leave out.

Inversion Use **inversion**. Reverse the expected word order of a phrase or sentence. John F. Kennedy used inversion by changing the usual subject-verb-object sentence pattern to object-subject-verb in this brief declaration from his inaugural speech: "This much we pledge."[5]

Suspension When you read a mystery novel, you are held in suspense until you reach the end and learn "who did it." The stylistic technique of verbal suspension does something similar by placing a key word or phrase at the end of a phrase or sentence, rather than at the beginning. The Coca-Cola Company used **suspension** as the cornerstone of one of its worldwide advertising campaigns by making *Coke* the last word in the slogan, "Things go better with Coke," rather than the expected order, "Coke goes better with everything."

Create Cadence

Cadence is the rhythm of language. You can create cadence, not by speaking in singsong patterns, but by using such stylistic devices as repetition, parallelism, antithesis, alliteration, and onomatopoeia.

Repetition Using a key word or phrase more than once gives rhythm and power to your message and makes it memorable. Perhaps the best-known modern example of **repetition** in a speech is the declaration that became the title of Martin Luther King Jr.'s most famous civil rights speech.

Parallelism **Parallelism** occurs when two or more clauses or sentences have the same grammatical pattern. In a 2013 speech to Israeli students in Jerusalem, President Barack Obama used parallelism by starting sentences with the words *we are*:

> We are enriched by faith. We are governed not simply by men and women, but by laws. We are fueled by entrepreneurship and innovation. And we are defined by a democratic discourse.[6]

Antithesis The word *antithesis* means "opposition." In language style, a sentence that uses **antithesis** has two parts with parallel structures but contrasting meanings. Speakers have long realized the dramatic potential of antithesis. For example, Journalist David Brooks once wrote, "Don't think about what you want from life, think about what life wants from you."[7] An antithetical statement is a good way to end a speech. The cadence will make the statement memorable.

Alliteration **Alliteration** is the repetition of a consonant sound (usually an initial consonant) several times in a phrase, clause, or sentence (for example, *discipline and direction; confidence and courage*).

Onomatopoeia **Onomatopoeia** is when a word is pronounced like its meaning (for example, *buzz* or *murmur*).



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

15.1 Describe three differences between oral and written language styles.

Oral language is more personal and less formal than written language. Speakers must also provide their audiences with more repetition than writers need to use.

15.2 List and explain three ways to use words effectively.

Effective speakers use specific, concrete words to evoke clear mental images in their listeners. They also choose simple, respectful, unbiased words. As a speaker, be sure to use words correctly and to keep in mind the connotations of words, as well as their dictionary definitions. And, finally, eliminate unnecessary words and phrases.

15.3 Discuss how to adapt your language style to diverse listeners.

Use language your audience can understand. Use respectful language to avoid offending your audience. Use unbiased language to communicate in a sensitive way.

15.4 List and explain three types of memorable word structures.

Create arresting images through such figures of speech as metaphors, similes, and personification. Create drama by using short sentences for important ideas, strategically omitting words, and structuring sentences with key words at the end to create suspense. Use repetition, alliteration, parallelism, antithesis, and onomatopoeia to create memorable rhythm or cadence.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** A friend asks for advice on making the word choices in their speech as effective as possible. Offer them at least three suggestions, based on this chapter, for using words effectively.
2. **Ethics Assessment** Is it ethical to change the way you typically speak in order to adapt to your listeners' expectations? Why or why not?
3. **Critical Assessment** How would a 750-word paper and a three- to five-minute speech that both have the same topic, central idea, main idea, and supporting material differ?

PART 5
Delivering
a Speech



METHODS OF DELIVERY

OBJECTIVES

- **16.1** Explain how to effectively deliver a manuscript speech.
- **16.2** Summarize the advantages and disadvantages of memorizing a speech.
- **16.3** Describe how to deliver an effective impromptu speech.
- **16.4** Explain the benefits of delivering a speech extemporaneously.

Whether you are presenting your message in person, via prerecorded video, or live online, you can choose from four basic methods of delivery: manuscript speaking, memorized speaking, impromptu speaking, and extemporaneous speaking. Table 16.1, which can be found at the end of this chapter, offers an overview of the advantages and disadvantages of each method.

MANUSCRIPT SPEAKING

16.1 Explain how to effectively deliver a manuscript speech.

Reading from a manuscript word-for-word is usually a poor way to deliver a speech. Although it may provide some insurance against forgetting part of the speech, **manuscript speaking** is rarely done well enough to be interesting.

However, in a few situations some speeches should be read. For example, during times of crisis, statements



Deliver a Manuscript Speech

- Mark your manuscript with a slash mark (/) or some other symbol to remind yourself where to pause or to emphasize certain words.
- Type your speech in short, easy-to-scan phrases so you can maintain as much eye contact with the audience as possible. Look directly at them and not over their heads. If you're presenting online, you may want to use a virtual teleprompter app.
- Unobtrusively use your index finger to keep your place in the manuscript when you look up.
- Do not read your speech too quickly; use your normal, natural speed of delivery.
- Vary the rhythm and inflection of your voice to sound natural.
- Use appropriate and natural gestures and movement. However, if you are presenting virtually, you may want to tone down your gestures and facial expressions since their intensity will be amplified on screen.

to the press should be carefully crafted rather than tossed off casually. When communicating sensitive information, government officials, for example, often read remarks from a carefully scripted manuscript.

The key to giving an effective manuscript speech is to sound as though you are not giving a manuscript speech. Use the tips in the How To box to help you.[1]

MEMORIZED SPEAKING

16.2 Summarize the advantages and disadvantages of memorizing a speech.

Memorized speaking sounds stiff, stilted, and over-rehearsed. You also run the risk of forgetting parts of your speech and awkwardly searching for words in front of your audience. And you won't be able to make on-the-spot adaptations to your listeners if your speech

is memorized. Memorized speaking does, however, have the advantage of allowing you to maintain maximum eye contact with the audience.

If you are accepting an award, introducing a speaker, making announcements, or delivering other brief remarks, a memorized delivery style is sometimes acceptable. But, as with manuscript speaking, you must take care to make your presentation sound lively and interesting.

IMPROMPTU SPEAKING

16.3 Describe how to deliver an effective impromptu speech.

You have undoubtedly already delivered many impromptu presentations. Your response to a question posed by a teacher in class and your unrehearsed rebuttal to a comment made by a colleague during a meeting are examples of impromptu presentations. The impromptu method is often described as "thinking on your feet" or "speaking off the cuff." The advantage of **impromptu speaking** is that you can speak informally and maintain direct eye contact with the audience. But unless you are extremely talented or have learned and practiced the techniques of impromptu speaking, an impromptu speech usually lacks logical organization and thorough research. When you are called on to deliver an improvised or impromptu speech, the guidelines in the How To box can help ease you through it.

Because there is no opportunity to conduct any kind of research before delivering an impromptu speech, you will have to speak from your own experience and knowledge. Remember, audiences almost always respond favorably to personal illustrations, so use any appropriate and relevant ones that come to mind. Do not make up information or provide facts or figures about which you're not certain. An honest "I don't know" or a brief statement is more appropriate. No matter how much knowledge you have, if your subject is at all sensitive or your information is classified, be careful when discussing it during your impromptu



Make an Impromptu Speech

- **Consider your audience.** Who are the members of your audience? What do they expect you to say? What is the occasion of your speech?
- **Be brief.** One to three minutes is a realistic time frame for most impromptu situations. Some spur-of-the-moment remarks, such as press statements, may be even shorter. Audience expectations and the specific occasion will influence the expected length of your impromptu remarks.
- **Organize!** Effective impromptu speakers organize their ideas into an introduction, body, and conclusion. Consider using a simple organizational strategy such as chronological order or a topical pattern. A variation on the chronological pattern is discussing (1) what has happened in the past, (2) what is happening now, and (3) what may happen in the future.

speech. If asked about a controversial topic, give an honest but noncommittal answer. You can always elaborate later, but you can never take back something rash you have already said. It is better to be careful than sorry!

EXTEMPORANEOUS SPEAKING

16.4 Explain the benefits of delivering a speech extemporaneously.

In **extemporaneous speaking**, you speak from a written or memorized general outline, but you do not have the exact wording in front of you or in your memory. You have rehearsed the speech so you know the key ideas and their organization but not to the degree that the speech sounds memorized. An extemporaneous style is conversational; it gives your audience the impression that the speech is being created as they listen to it, and to some extent it is.

As we discussed in Chapter 12, you develop an extemporaneous style by first rehearsing your speech, using your preparation outline. However, each time you rehearse, try to rely less and less on your outline. If you find yourself using exactly the same words each time you rehearse, you're memorizing your speech; either stop rehearsing or consider other ways of expressing your ideas. After several rehearsals with your preparation outline, you'll want to develop your speaking notes and use them to rehearse until you feel comfortable delivering your presentation.

Table 16.1 Advantages and Disadvantages of Methods of Delivery

	Advantages	Disadvantages
Manuscript: reading a speech from a prepared text	You can craft the message carefully when dealing with sensitive or critical issues; you can be precise.	It takes considerable skill and practice to make the message sound interesting.
Memorized: giving a speech from memory without using notes	This method enables you to maintain direct eye contact with the audience. You can also move around freely.	May sound mechanical and over-rehearsed; you may forget parts of your speech; you cannot make on-the-spot adaptations.
Impromptu: delivering a speech without preparing in advance	You can speak informally and maintain direct eye contact with the audience. You can also easily adapt the speech to your audience.	May lack logical organization and thorough research; may be unimpressive.
Extemporaneous: knowing the major ideas, which have been outlined, but not memorizing the exact wording	Your speech is well organized and researched. It sounds spontaneous, yet appropriately polished.	It takes time to prepare and skill to deliver the speech well.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

16.1 Explain how to effectively deliver a manuscript speech.

When precise wording is important, you may need to read a speech from a prepared text. Make your voice and gestures as natural as possible, and maintain as much eye contact with the audience as possible.

16.2 Summarize the advantages and disadvantages of memorizing a speech.

Giving a speech from memory allows maximum eye contact with the audience, but you risk sounding stiff, forgetting part of the speech, and being unable to adapt the speech to the audience.

16.3 Describe how to deliver an effective impromptu speech.

An unrehearsed speech allows for informality and eye contact. Consider the audience, and organize your remarks accordingly. Keep your talk brief, use your own knowledge, and share information cautiously.

16.4 Explain the benefits of delivering a speech extemporaneously.

Because it seems spontaneous and is customized to the audience, the extemporaneous method is the most desirable in most situations. Develop a preparation outline and use it to rehearse until you feel comfortable delivering your presentation.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Imagine you are an executive for a corporation. What business situations would call for you to deliver each of the four types of speeches described in this chapter?

2. **Ethics Assessment** Is it ethical to present a manuscript or memorized speech when you have been asked to present an extemporaneous speech?
3. **Critical Assessment** Roger was so nervous about his first speech that he practiced it until he could have given it in his sleep. He had some great examples, and his instructor had praised his outline. But as he gave his speech, he saw his classmates tuning out. What might he have done wrong, and how could he have rescued his speech?

NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION



OBJECTIVES

- **17.1** Make effective eye contact during a speech.
- **17.2** Use gestures effectively while speaking.
- **17.3** Move purposefully in ways that enhance your message while speaking.
- **17.4** Display an appropriate posture while delivering a speech.
- **17.5** Use facial expressions to enhance verbal messages.
- **17.6** Choose appropriate attire for making a speech.

EYE CONTACT

17.1 Make effective eye contact during a speech.

Of all the aspects of speech delivery discussed in this chapter, the most important one in a public speaking situation for most North Americans is eye contact.[1] Eye contact with your audience opens communication, keeps your audience interested, and makes you more credible. Each of these functions contributes to the success of your delivery. Eye contact also provides you with feedback about how your speech is coming across, so you can adapt it if needed. The How To box offers advice for effective eye contact.

GESTURES

17.2 Use gestures effectively while speaking.

Important points are emphasized with gestures. You also gesture to indicate places, enumerate items, and describe objects. Sometimes a gesture takes the place of a word.



Make Eye Contact with Your Audience

- When it's time to speak, calmly walk to the lectern or to the front of the audience, pause briefly, and look at your audience before you say anything.
- Have your opening sentence well enough in mind that you can deliver it without looking at your notes or away from your listeners.
- Establish eye contact with the entire audience, not just with those in the front row or only one or two people.
- Look to the back as well as the front and from one side of your audience to the other, but avoid following a predictable pattern.
- Look at individuals, establishing person-to-person contact with them—not so long that it will make a listener feel uncomfortable but long enough to establish the feeling that you are talking directly to that individual.
- Don't look over your listeners' heads; establish eye-to-eye contact.
- If you are speaking via video or conferencing software, try to avoid looking at yourself or at audience members on your screen. Instead, establish eye contact by looking into your camera lens.

Using Gestures Effectively

Here are some guidelines to consider when working on your delivery.

- **Stay natural.** Gestures should be *relaxed,* not tense or rigid. Your gestures should flow with your message. Avoid sawing or slashing through the air with your hands unless you are trying to emphasize a particularly dramatic point.
- **Be definite.** Gestures should appear *definite* rather than as accidental brief jerks of your hands or arms. If you want to gesture, go ahead and gesture. Avoid minor hand movements that will be

masked by the lectern. If you are giving a virtual speech, be sure to stay within the camera frame when gesturing.

- **Use gestures that are consistent with your message.** If you are excited, for example, gesture more vigorously.
- **Vary your gestures but don't overdo it.** Strive for *variety* and versatility in your use of gestures. Try not to use just one hand or one all-purpose gesture; use gestures for a variety of purposes.
- **Make your gestures appropriate to your audience and situation.** Gestures must be adapted to the audience. In more formal speaking situations, particularly with a large audience, bolder, more sweeping, and more dramatic gestures are appropriate. A small audience in a less formal setting calls for less formal gestures. When delivering a speech to an online audience, it's especially important not to use overly dramatic gestures. The camera lens is generally only a few feet away from you, which tends to amplify the intensity of your gestures and movements.
- **Adapt your gestures to audience cultural expectations.** Consider toning down your gestures for predominantly high-context listeners who value nonverbal cues, tone of voice, posture, and facial expressions more than the words. Some Asian cultures, for example, place considerable emphasis on the context of communication.

Keep one important principle in mind: Use gestures that work best for you. Your gestures should fit your own personality. It may be better to use no gestures—to just put your hands comfortably at your side—than to use awkward, distracting gestures or to try to counterfeit someone else's gestures. Your nonverbal delivery should flow from *your* message.

QUICK CHECK

Gestures

The most effective gestures are

- natural and relaxed
- definite and varied
- consistent with your message
- unobtrusive
- coordinated with what you say
- appropriate to your audience and situation

MOVEMENT

17.3 Move purposefully in ways that enhance your message while speaking.

Should you walk around during your speech, or should you stay in one place? If there is a lectern, should you stand behind it, or would it be acceptable to stand in front or to the side of it? Is it all right to sit down while you speak? Can you move among the audience? The following discussion may help you answer these questions.

Move Purposefully

Your movement should be consistent with the verbal content of your message. It should make sense rather than appear as aimless wandering. Your movement should not detract from your message. If the audience focuses on your movement rather than on what you are saying, it is better to stand still.

Reduce Physical Barriers

Eliminate physical barriers between you and the audience. For more formal occasions, you will be expected to remain standing behind a lectern to deliver your message. But even on those occasions, it can be appropriate to move from behind the lectern to make a point, signal a change in mood, or turn to another idea.

Establish Immediacy

Movements such as standing, moving closer to listeners, or coming out from behind a lectern can help to create a perception of closeness or **immediacy** between you and your audience, which may enhance your credibility and help you effectively communicate your message.[2] Pay close attention to your listeners to determine the appropriate amount of immediacy so that you do not violate cultural expectations or make listeners uncomfortable.

How to Move Effectively

Your use of movement during your speech should make sense to your listeners. Avoid random pacing and overly dramatic gestures.

POSTURE

17.4 Display an appropriate posture while delivering a speech.

Although there have been few formal studies of posture in relation to public speaking, there is evidence that the way you carry your body communicates significant information.[3] Whereas your face and voice play a major role in communicating a specific emotion, your posture communicates the *intensity* of that emotion.

In general, avoid slouching your shoulders, shifting from foot to foot, or drooping your head. Your posture should not call attention to itself. Instead, it should reflect your interest in the speaking event and your attention to the task at hand.

FACIAL EXPRESSION

17.5 Use facial expressions to enhance verbal messages.

Your face plays a key role in expressing your thoughts and especially your emotions and attitudes.[4] Your audience sees your face before they hear what you are going

to say. Thus, you have an opportunity to set the emotional tone for your message before you start speaking.

When you present your speech, your facial expression should naturally vary to be consistent with your message. Present somber news with a serious expression. Communicate interest by keeping your expression alert and friendly.

According to cross-cultural studies by social psychologist Paul Ekman, nearly all people around the world agree on the general meanings of facial expressions for six primary emotions: happiness, anger, surprise, sadness, disgust, and fear.[5] Humans are physically capable of producing thousands of different facial expressions, but our faces most often express one of these six primary emotions or a blend of expressions. Even a culturally diverse audience will usually be able to read your emotional expressions clearly.

Consider these tips for monitoring your facial expression:

- As you rehearse, be mindful of the emotion that you wish your audience members to feel. Monitor your expression so that it communicates the emotion you intend.
- Unless you are presenting sad or bad news, have a naturally pleasant, positive facial expression to signal your interest in communicating with your listeners.
- When presenting a speech online, take care not to overly exaggerate your facial expression. Close-ups can amplify the intensity of your emotional expressions.
- Remember that some listeners from high-context cultures, such as people from Asia, often prefer less dramatic and subtler facial expressions.

PERSONAL APPEARANCE

17.6 Choose appropriate attire for making a speech.

There is considerable evidence that your personal appearance affects how your audience will respond to you and your message, particularly during the opening moments

of your presentation. If you violate their expectations about appearance, you will be less successful in achieving your purpose. As a general guideline, consider dressing slightly better than your audience. Also avoid wearing distracting T-shirts or clothing with words, images, or advertising unrelated to your message. Appropriate wardrobe varies depending on climate, custom, culture, and audience expectations. Use your audience analysis to identify and avoid violating your audience's expectations.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

17.1 Make effective eye contact during a speech.

To communicate effectively with North American audiences, make eye contact with the entire audience before and during your speech.

17.2 Use gestures effectively while speaking.

Use natural, definite, and varied gestures that fit your personality and help you communicate your message to your particular audience.

17.3 Move purposefully in ways that enhance your message while speaking.

Use movement to emphasize your verbal messages and to make your audience feel closer to you. Avoid movement that could detract from your message.

17.4 Display an appropriate posture while delivering a speech.

Posture communicates the intensity of your emotions and your interest in your audience and speech. Avoid slouching and drooping.

17.5 Use facial expressions to enhance verbal messages. Rehearse using universally recognized facial expressions that match the emotions of your verbal messages.

17.6 Choose appropriate attire for making a speech. Analyze your audience and speaking situation to determine what to wear when you deliver your speech.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Record and analyze a video of yourself rehearsing your next speech. Did you follow the advice given in this chapter? How can you improve your eye contact, gestures, posture, and use of movement and facial expressions?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Many politicians hire image consultants to coach them in nonverbal skills. Is it ethical for a speaker to use such consultants to attempt to gain more credibility with voters?
3. **Critical Assessment** Monique is self-conscious about her hand gestures, and she often just puts her hands behind her back. What advice would you give Monique to help her use gestures more effectively?

VERBAL COMMUNICATION



OBJECTIVES

- **18.1** Use effective vocal delivery when giving a speech.
- **18.2** Explain how to use a microphone when speaking in public.
- **18.3** Describe the steps to follow when rehearsing your speech.

VOCAL DELIVERY

18.1 Use effective vocal delivery when giving a speech.

As a public speaker, you use your voice to convey your ideas as well as emotions to your audience. Your credibility as a speaker and your ability to communicate your ideas clearly will in large part depend on your vocal delivery.

Vocal delivery includes pitch, speaking rate, volume, pronunciation, articulation, pauses, and general variation of the voice. A speaker has at least two key vocal obligations to an audience: Speak to be understood, and speak with vocal variety to maintain interest.

Speak to Be Understood

To be understood, consider four aspects of vocal delivery: volume, articulation, dialect, and pronunciation.

Volume The fundamental purpose of your vocal delivery is to speak loudly enough so that your audience can hear you. The **volume** of your speech is determined by the amount of air you project through your larynx, or voice box. More air equals more volume of sound.

Your diaphragm, a muscle that lies between your lungs and your abdomen, helps control sound volume by increasing airflow from your lungs through your

voice box. Breathing from your diaphragm—consciously expanding and contracting your abdomen as you breathe in and out—can increase the volume of sound and enhance the quality of your voice.

Articulation The process of producing speech sounds clearly and distinctly is **articulation**. Without distinct enunciation or articulation of the sounds that make up words, your listeners may not understand you or may fault you for simply not knowing how to speak clearly and fluently. Here are some commonly misarticulated words:[1]

Dint	instead of	*didn't*
Lemme	instead of	*let me*
Mornin	instead of	*morning*
Soun	instead of	*sound*
Wanna	instead of	*want to*
Whadayado	instead of	*what do you do*

Although we have identified some commonly misarticulated words, there may be times when you want to intentionally use more informal articulation, or when your audience may expect a more informal use of language.

Dialect A **dialect** is a consistent style of pronouncing words that is common to an ethnic group or a geographic region such as the South, New England, or the upper Midwest. Most newscasters in the United States use what is called standard American pronunciation and do not typically have a strong dialect.

Although a speaker's dialect may pigeonhole that person as being from a certain part of the country, it won't necessarily affect the audience's comprehension of the information unless the dialect is so pronounced that the listeners can't understand the speaker's words. We don't recommend that you eliminate your own mild dialect; some listeners find that a slight dialect makes the speaker more interesting.

Pronunciation Whereas articulation relates to the clarity of sounds, **pronunciation** concerns the degree to which the sounds conform to those assigned to words in standard English. Mispronouncing words can detract from a speaker's credibility if the listener expects standard pronunciation.[2] If you are uncertain about how to pronounce a word, look it up in an online dictionary.

Our suggestions about standard pronunciation reflect the expectations of many, but not all listeners. Rather than prescribing how *all* speakers should sound, we again advise you to be mindful of your audience. There are considerable cultural and ethnic variations in the expected pronunciation of words. *Different* does not mean *wrong*. We caution against making negative judgments of others based on how a speaker learned to pronounce words based on their culture, race, ethnicity, region of origin, and a host of other factors.

Speak with Variety

Variety of pitch, rate of speech, and pauses can help maintain your listeners' interest. In addition, it is primarily through the quality of our voices, as well as our facial expressions, that we communicate emotions, whether we are happy, sad, bored, or excited.

Pitch Vocal **pitch** is how high or low your voice sounds. Everyone has a habitual pitch. This is the range of your voice during normal conversation. Some people have a habitually high pitch, whereas others have a low pitch.

Your voice has **inflection** when you raise or lower the pitch as you pronounce words or sounds. The best public speakers appropriately vary their inflection. We're not suggesting that you need to imitate a top-forty radio disk jockey when you speak. But variation in your vocal inflection and overall pitch helps you communicate the subtlety of your ideas.

Record your speech as you rehearse and evaluate your use of pitch and inflection. If you are not satisfied with your inflection, consider practicing your speech

with exaggerated variations in vocal pitch. Although you would not deliver your speech this way, it may help you explore the expressive options available to you.

Rate How fast do you talk? Most speakers average between 120 and 180 words per minute. There is no one "best" speaking rate. The best rate depends on two factors: your speaking style and the content of your message.

One symptom of speech anxiety is the tendency to rush through a speech to get it over with.[3] Fewer speakers have the problem of speaking too slowly, but a turtle-paced speech will almost certainly make it more difficult for your audience to maintain interest. Remember, your listeners can grasp information much faster than you can speak it.

Pauses An appropriate pause can often do more to accent your message than any other vocal characteristic. President Kennedy's famous line, "Ask not what your country can do for you; ask what you can do for your country," was effective not only because of its language but also because it was delivered with a pause dividing the two thoughts. Try delivering that line without the pause; without it, the statement just doesn't have the same power.

Effective use of pauses, also known as *effective timing*, can greatly enhance the impact of your message. Whether you are trying to tell a joke, a serious tale, or a dramatic story, your use of a pause can determine the effectiveness of your anecdote. A well-timed pause, coupled with eye contact, can also powerfully accent a particular word or sentence. Silence is a way of saying to your audience, "Think about this for a moment."

Beware, however, of the vocalized pause. Many beginning public speakers are uncomfortable with silence, and so, rather than pausing where it seems natural and normal, they vocalize sounds such as "umm," "er," "you know," and "ah." However, such vocalized pauses will annoy your audience and detract from your credibility.

QUICK CHECK

Good Vocal Delivery

- Use adequate volume.
- Articulate speech sounds clearly and distinctly.
- Use an online dictionary if you are uncertain about how to pronounce a word.
- Vary your pitch and speaking rate.
- Pause to emphasize ideas.

USING A MICROPHONE

18.2 Explain how to use a microphone when speaking in public.

No matter how polished your gestures or well-intoned your vocal cues are, if you are inaudible or use a microphone awkwardly, your speech will not have the desired effect.

There are four kinds of microphones. The most common microphone is the **built-in microphone**. Most electronic devices, including computers, tablets, and phones, have built-in microphones. If you work remotely and spend considerable time speaking using a built-in microphone, you may want to invest in an auxiliary mike, especially if your listeners express issues about the quality or audibility of your presentations.

The **lavaliere microphone** is a clip-on type of microphone often used by newspeople and interviewees. Worn on the front of a shirt, jacket, or dress, it requires no particular care other than not to thump it or to accidentally knock it off.

The **boom microphone**, used by makers of movies and TV shows, hangs over the heads of the speakers and is remote-controlled.

The **stationary microphone** is most often attached to a lectern. It can also sit on a desk or stand on the floor. Generally, the stationary microphones used today are

multidirectional. You do not have to remain frozen in front of a stationary mike while delivering your speech. When using a stationary microphone, consider these suggestions:

- First, check to make sure the microphone is indeed multidirectional and can pick up your voice even if you aren't speaking directly into it.
- Second, speak clearly and crisply. You may need to pronounce *B*, *P*, and *S* sounds with less intensity than usual.
- Third, if you must test a microphone, count or ask the audience whether they can hear you. Blowing on a microphone produces an irritating noise! Do not tap, pound, or shuffle anything near the microphone.
- Fourth, continue to speak at your normal volume. Some people speak more quietly when they have a microphone in front of them, becoming inaudible.
- Finally, make sure your microphone is turned off before having personal conversations with others.

If you have the chance to rehearse with the microphone you will use, figure out where to position yourself for the best sound quality and how sensitive the microphone is to extraneous noise. Practice will accustom you to any voice distortion or echo that might occur so that these sound qualities do not surprise you during your speech.

REHEARSING YOUR SPEECH: SOME FINAL TIPS

18.3 Describe the steps to follow when rehearsing your speech.

Rehearsal is the key to effective verbal and nonverbal delivery of your speech. The following suggestions can help you make the most of your rehearsal time:

- Finish drafting your speech outline at least two days before your speech performance.

- Before you prepare the speaking notes you will use in front of your audience, rehearse your speech aloud to help determine where you will need notes to prompt yourself.
- Revise your speech as necessary to keep it within the time limits set by your instructor or whoever invited you to speak.
- Prepare your speaking notes. Use whatever system works best for you to maintain an extemporaneous delivery style. Some speakers use pictorial symbols to remind themselves of a story or an idea. Others use complete sentences or just words or phrases in an outline pattern to prompt them. Many instructors advocate using note cards for speaking notes. Some speakers use a smartphone, tablet, or other electronic display. If you do use electronic notes, it is wise to have a hard-copy backup.
- Rehearse your speech just as you will deliver it. A realistic rehearsal will increase your confidence and result in a better performance. If you will be standing up in front of a live audience, then practice your speech standing up. If you will be seated in front of a computer, then practice looking into the camera. Do not try to memorize your speech or plan specific gestures. As you rehearse, you may want to modify your speaking notes to reflect appropriate changes.
- When it is not possible or practical to rehearse your speech out loud, research has found that mentally rehearsing your speech has some benefits. Imagining that you are standing in front of an audience delivering your speech can help enhance your overall fluency and reduce your nervousness.[4]
- If you can, present your speech to someone else so that you can practice establishing eye contact. Seek feedback from your captive audience about both your delivery and your speech content.

- If possible, make an audio or video recording of your speech during the rehearsal stage. When listening to or viewing the recording, observe your vocal and physical mannerisms and make necessary changes. Many speakers still find it useful to practice before a mirror so they can observe their body language; it's low-tech, but it still works.
- Rehearse using all your presentation aids. Don't wait until the last minute to plan, prepare, and rehearse with flipcharts, slides, computer graphics, handouts, or other aids you will need to manipulate as you speak.
- Rehearse with virtual reality (VR) technology. If you have access to a VR headset, consider using one to help you recreate the speaking situation.[5] Several studies suggest that using VR technology can help improve your performance and also diminish your nervousness.[6]
- Practice good delivery skills while rehearsing. Remember this maxim: Practice *makes* perfect if practice *is* perfect.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

18.1 Use effective vocal delivery when giving a speech.

To be effective, speak to be understood, with enough volume and clear articulation. If you are uncertain about how to pronounce a word, look it up in an online dictionary. Maintain your listeners' interest by speaking with varied pitch, rate of speech, and pauses.

18.2 Explain how to use a microphone when speaking in public.

Rehearse with your microphone before your speech to figure out where to position yourself for the best sound quality. Do not tap, pound, or shuffle anything near a microphone.

18.3 Describe the steps to follow when rehearsing your speech.

Allow at least two days after finishing your speech outline to practice your speech delivery and to develop your speaking notes. As much as possible, recreate the speech environment when you rehearse. Record your rehearsal or recruit a listener to provide feedback on your performance.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Review the tips for rehearsing your speech presented in this chapter. Rate yourself on a scale of 1 to 5 (1 = poor; 5 = excellent) on each of the suggestions. Use your self-ratings to develop a plan to improve your rehearsals.
2. **Ethics Assessment** Is it ethical to cultivate a highly emotional vocal delivery style to use when attempting to persuade listeners?
3. **Critical Assessment** Professor Murray speaks slowly and in a monotone; consequently, many of her students do not enjoy her music history lectures. What can she do to give her voice some variety?

DELIVERING YOUR SPEECH



OBJECTIVES

19.1 Take steps to prepare for a successful speech delivery.

19.2 Prepare to answer questions after delivering a speech.

SUCCESSFULLY DELIVER YOUR SPEECH

19.1 Take steps to prepare for a successful speech delivery.

When you are ready to deliver your speech, your task is to calmly and confidently communicate with your audience. Consider the following suggestions to help you prepare for a successful performance.

- **Be well rested.** Get plenty of sleep before your speech. Last-minute, late-night final preparations can take the edge off your performance.
- **Review the suggestions in Chapter 2 for becoming a confident speaker.** Recreate the speech environment when you rehearse. Use deep-breathing techniques to help you relax. Make sure you are especially familiar with your introduction and conclusion. Act calm so that you will feel calm.
- **Arrive early for your speaking engagement.** If the room is in an unfamiliar location, give yourself plenty of time to find it. You may also want to rearrange the furniture or make other changes to the speaking environment.
- **Check your equipment.** If you are using audiovisual equipment or a microphone, make sure they are working properly. Project a PowerPoint slide or two to make sure the image is clear.

- **Visualize success.** Picture yourself delivering your speech in an effective way. Also, remind yourself of the effort you have spent preparing for your speech. A final mental rehearsal can boost your confidence and help ensure success.[1]

Keep in mind that speech delivery is an art rather than a science. Adapt these tips and your delivery to reflect your personality and individual style.

RESPONDING TO QUESTIONS

19.2 Prepare to answer questions after delivering a speech.

A question-and-answer (Q&A) session may be scheduled after your speech. During this Q&A period, your delivery method changes from extemporaneous to impromptu speaking. Here are some tips to make the Q&A period less challenging. Chapter 26 offers additional suggestions for answering questions after group presentations.

- **Prepare.** Analyze your audience. Think of possible questions those particular listeners might ask you, and then rehearse your answers.
- **Repeat or rephrase the questions.** Repeating a question makes sure that everyone can hear the question. It also ensures that you understand the question. It lets you succinctly summarize a rambling question. And repeating the question gives you just a bit of time to think about your answer.
- **Stay on message.** Keep bringing the audience back to your central idea. If a listener asks a question unrelated to your talk, gently guide your questioner back to the message you have prepared.
- **Give a "double-barreled" talk.** Some seasoned speakers suggest that you save a bit of your speech to deliver during the Q&A session.[2] You present your speech, and then when an appropriate question is asked, you give your second, much briefer speech as your answer.

- **Respond to the entire audience and not just the person who asked the question.** Although you can start your response by maintaining eye contact with the person who asked you a question, make sure you stay audience-centered. Look at all audience members and keep in mind that your response should be relevant to them.
- **Ask the first question yourself.** As you transition between the end of your speech and the Q&A, prime the audience by asking and answering an initial challenging question.
- **Listen nonjudgmentally.** Give your full attention to the questioner. Listen politely and respond courteously.
- **Neutralize hostile questions.** Restate the question and acknowledge the questioner's emotions. Don't attack the person who asked the question. Keep the conversation focused on the heart of the issue.
- **When you don't know the answer, admit it.** You can promise to find out more information and then get back to the person later. When you make a promise, follow through on it.
- **Be brief.** Even if you've planned a "double-barreled" talk, make your answers short and to the point.
- **Use organized signposts.** Use verbal signposts to help listeners understand your answer. For example, you can say, "I have two responses to that question. First,…." Then, when you get to your second point, say, "My second point is…."
- **Indicate when the Q&A period is ending.** For example, warn your audience, "I only have time for two more questions."



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

19.1 Take steps to prepare for a successful speech delivery.

Rest well before a speech. Take steps to boost your confidence. Arrive early, and visualize your successful speech.

19.2 Prepare to answer questions after delivering a speech.

Consider your audience and plan for questions they might ask. Listen politely to questions and repeat or rephrase them, especially hostile questions. Keep answers brief, organized, and to the point.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Review the tips for getting ready to deliver your speech. Rank the suggestions in order of how much they can help you before your next speech.
2. **Ethics Assessment** Many politicians deliver their message using a teleprompter. Is it ethical to disguise the fact that you are using extensive notes when delivering a speech?
3. **Critical Assessment** Muriel, who has been a church organist for 35 years, is planning on speaking to her music club about her experiences playing the pipe organ. How would you advise Muriel to prepare for questions after her speech?

SELECTING PRESENTATION AIDS



OBJECTIVES

- **20.1** Discuss five ways in which presentation aids help communicate ideas to an audience.
- **20.2** Describe seven types of presentation aids and how to use them effectively.
- **20.3** Describe how computers may be used to generate high-quality presentation aids.
- **20.4** Use criteria to choose presentation aids to include in a speech.

THE VALUE OF PRESENTATION AIDS

20.1 Discuss five ways in which presentation aids help communicate ideas to an audience.

A **presentation aid** is any image, object, or sound that reinforces your point visually or aurally so that your audience can better understand it. Presentation aids can help your listeners do all of the following:[1]

- **Focus**—Presentation aids gain and maintain the attention of your listeners and keep their interest when words alone might not.
- **Understand**—Presentation aids can enhance understanding.
- **Remember**—It is well known that you remember most what you understand best.
- **Organize**—Listing your major ideas on a computer-generated slide, chart, or poster can help your audience grasp your main ideas and follow your transitions.
- **Illustrate**—Of your five senses, you learn more from sight than from all the others combined.[2]

Demonstrating or showing procedures or events step-by-step is an especially effective way to enhance understanding.[3]

TYPES OF PRESENTATION AIDS

20.2 Describe seven types of presentation aids and how to use them effectively.

There are seven types of presentation aids: images, text, video, audio, objects, models, and people.

Images

The most common presentation aids are two-dimensional images such as drawings, photographs, maps, graphs, and charts.

Drawings Drawings are easy and inexpensive to make, and they can be tailored to your specific needs. As a rule, large and simple line drawings are more effective for stage presentations than detailed images. One way to view drawings at large sizes is to incorporate them into computer-generated presentation aids.

Photographs Photographs can show objects or places that cannot be illustrated with drawings or that an audience cannot view directly. Photos can easily be incorporated into computer-generated slides. If you must use a printed photograph, enlarge it or scan and project it.

Maps Most maps are designed to be read from a distance of no more than two feet. To make a map large enough for your audience to see, you can enlarge it using a color copier, draw a simplified large-scale version, or embed it in a computer-generated slide.

Graphs A **graph** is a pictorial representation of statistical data in an easy-to-understand format. Most listeners find that graphs help make data more concrete. Graphs are particularly effective in showing overall trends and relationships among data. The four most common types

of graphs are bar graphs, pie graphs, line graphs, and picture graphs.

- A **bar graph** consists of flat areas—bars—whose various lengths represent information.
- A **pie graph** shows the individual shares of a whole. Pie graphs are especially useful in helping your listeners to see quickly how data are distributed in a given category or area.
- **Line graphs** show relationships between two or more variables. Like bar graphs, line graphs organize statistical data to show overall trends. A line graph can cover a greater span of time or numbers than a bar graph without looking cluttered or confusing. A simple line graph communicates better than a cluttered one.
- **Picture graphs** look somewhat less formal and less intimidating than other kinds of graphs. One of the advantages of picture graphs is that they need few words or labels, which makes them easier for your audience to read.

Charts **Charts**, or tables, summarize and present a great deal of information in a small amount of space. They are easy to use, reuse, and enlarge. They can also be displayed in a variety of ways. You can use a flipchart, a poster, or a computer-generated slide, which can project a giant image of your chart on a screen. Charts must be simple and easy to read. Do not try to put too much information on one chart.

Flowcharts Consider using a **flowchart** when you want to graphically illustrate a step-by-step process or sequence of events. As with other visual aids, flowcharts should be simple and easy to read.

Text

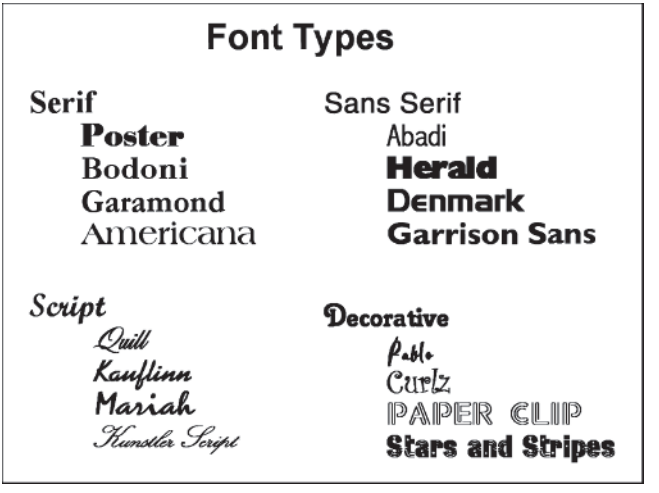
In addition to images, many speakers use text, which could be just a word or two, or a brief outline of the key

points. The key to using text as a presentation aid is to not overdo it. To use text effectively, consider these principles:

- Use no more than seven lines of text on any single visual, especially on a computer-generated visual.
- Use *brief* bullet points to designate individual items or thoughts.
- Use parallel structure in bulleted lists (for example, begin each bulleted phrase with the same word, as we do in this list).
- Use the heading of each slide to summarize the essential point of the visual so listeners can follow the key point you are making.[4]

If you're using a computer, you'll be able to choose from dozens of typefaces and **fonts**. But make an informed choice rather than selecting a typeface just because it strikes your fancy. Graphic designers divide typefaces into four types: serif, sans serif, script, and decorative (see Figure 20.1). Serif fonts are easier to read for longer passages. Although interesting and dramatic, script fonts should be used sparingly because they are

Figure 20.1 Typefaces grouped by font type.



hard to read. Use decorative fonts only when you want to communicate a special tone or mood. Regardless of which font style you use, don't use more than one or two on a single visual.

Video

It's now easy to record video to support speech ideas. Digital video cameras are widely available and a standard feature of smartphones. If you want to use a video clip from a movie or TV show to support your talk, you'll likely find the footage you need on YouTube, other internet sources, or on commercially prerecorded digital video discs (DVDs).

Before you decide to use a video clip, think about whether or not it will really enhance your speech. Short, well-selected clips are most likely to be effective.

You can use a variety of technologies to store your videos and play them back during your speech:

- **Computers and other electronic devices.** You can store video clips on a computer, tablet, or smartphone. Embedding video files into computer-generated slides can give you more control over precisely what clips you are showing, as well as the visual context and timing when you play them. Unless the audience is very small, all of these options require you to connect a device to a monitor or a projection system. Make sure a monitor or projection system is available and compatible with the device you plan to use.
- **The internet.** If the room where you are delivering your speech has internet access, you can skip storing or embedding your video and instead stream it directly from YouTube or another internet source. You can also retrieve your video or audio material from the "cloud," computer storage that is in a remote location. Playing video directly from the internet or from cloud storage does, however, carry the risk of losing an internet connection before or during your speech.

- **DVD player.** Although DVDs are diminishing in use, some films and TV shows are not available on video streaming services. Therefore, you will need to use a DVD player, but make sure you'll have access to one that can be connected to a large screen or monitor before the day of your speech.

When using any of these technologies, always complete a technical run-through, ensuring that your video will be ready when you want it.

Audio

Audio can be used to complement visual displays. As with video, you can either create your own audio content or use prerecorded sources. You also have a number of options for storage and playback. As with video, be sure to rehearse with and master any technology involved with audio aids, and don't let your soundtrack overwhelm or distract from your own speech.

Objects

Listeners like looking at real, tangible items that can be touched, smelled, heard, and even tasted, as well as seen. If you use an object to illustrate an idea, make sure you can handle the object with ease. If an object is too large, it can be unwieldy and difficult to show to your audience. Tiny objects can be seen only close up. Avoid objects that are dangerous to handle.

Models

If it is not possible or practical to bring the object you would like to show your audience, consider showing them a **model**. Make sure, however, that any model you use is large enough to be seen by all members of your audience. Like using an object, using a model can enhance audience interest.

People

Using people to illustrate your message can be tricky. Before your presentation, choose someone you trust so that you can fully inform them about what needs to be done. Rehearse your speech using your live presentation aid. If you don't need the person to demonstrate something during your opening remarks, wait and introduce them to your audience when needed. Remember, your presentation aids are always subordinate to your speech. You must remain in control.

USING COMPUTER-GENERATED PRESENTATION AIDS

20.3 Describe how computers may be used to generate high-quality presentation aids.

When used properly, computer-generated presentation aids can add a professional polish to your presentation. Yet, as with any presentation aid, the images and clips you use must help develop your central idea; otherwise, they will distract your audience from it.

Basic Principles of Using Computer-Generated Presentation Aids

Most audiences, especially those in the corporate world, expect a speaker to use computer-generated presentation aids.[5] PowerPoint, which is the most popular presentation software, helps you create and present images, photos, words, charts, and graphs. PowerPoint can also incorporate video and sound. Prezi is another increasingly popular presentation software program that is cloud-based—information is accessed on demand via the internet rather than on a computer. Prezi also allows users to zoom in and out of slides. Keynote, which was developed for Apple computers and devices, is another type of presentation software. Like other programs, it permits users to easily maintain consistency in fonts and colors. Some people prefer its sleek, contemporary appearance.

Tips for Using Computer-Generated Presentation Aids

Although computer-generated graphics can be overused and, like any presentation aid, can distract from your message if used improperly, they nonetheless open up professional-looking possibilities for illustrating your speech.

Be sure to consider your audience when you use computer-generated presentation aids.[6] As with any presentation aid, the images or clips you choose to display must help develop your central idea; otherwise, they will distract your audience from it. The following tips can help.[7]

Plan Your Visual Message Insert notes or comments into your speech outline to indicate where visual images could be used to support your ideas.[8] You can also plot your message visually by using a storyboard strategy. A **storyboard** is simply a visual or graphic representation of your ideas.

Keep Sights and Sounds Simple Many users attempt to shovel too much information into their slides, which can overwhelm listeners. Keep in mind that presentation aids *support* your message; they are not your message.

- Limit the number of words on each slide.
- Use slides to present images rather than merely repeat your words.
- Resist the urge to add sound effects. *You* should be the soundtrack, not the computer.

Selectively Use No Image There may be times when you want to speak to your audience and not refer to a slide or image. During these times, use a blank slide or use the projector's remote control to temporarily project no image.[9]

Present Information in Briefer Chunks To help listeners remember and retain your message, reveal information line by line as you talk rather than presenting a large block of information all at once.[10] Only present words and images that directly reinforce what you are saying.[11] Talk about what you display rather than just show it.[12]

Repeat Visual Elements to Unify Your Presentation Use a common visual element, such as a bullet or other symbol, at the beginning of each word or phrase in a list. Use common color schemes and spacing to give your visuals coherence. Use fonts consistently rather than mix them. Use a similar visual style for each of your images to achieve a professional, polished look. Use repetition of key words (such as *use* at the beginning of each sentence in this paragraph).

The most significant advantage of computer graphics is the ease with which they allow you to display attractive visual images. **Clip art** can give your slides a professional touch. Copyright-free clip art and photos are available at no cost from many internet sources. Presentation software allows you to easily incorporate these images into your visual aids.

Make Informed Decisions about Using Color Color communicates. Choose colors that will support and reinforce the topic and purpose of your speech. To unify your presentation, use the same background color on all visuals and no more than two colors for words. Using a dark background with lighter-colored words can have a pleasing effect and make the words easy to see.

QUICK CHECK

Design Effective Computer-Generated Presentation Aids

- Plan your visual message.
- Keep sights and sounds simple.
- Present information in briefer chunks.
- Repeat visual elements to unify your presentation.
- Avoid mixing many different fonts.
- Use clip art to give your visuals a professional touch.
- Make informed decisions about using color.
- Finish preparing your presentation aids early.

Allow Plenty of Time to Prepare Your Presentation Aids Prepare your presentation aids well in advance of your speaking date so that you can make them as attractive and polished looking as possible.

SELECT THE RIGHT PRESENTATION AIDS

20.4 Use criteria to choose presentation aids to include in a speech.

Because there are so many choices, you may wonder, "How do I decide which presentation aid to use?" Use the suggestions in the How To box to help you.



Choose Presentation Aids

- **Consider your audience.** The age, interests, and attitudes of your audience should affect your selection of audiovisual support.
- **Estimate the size of the audience.** Choose presentation aids that everyone will be able to see clearly.
- **Think of your speech objective.** Don't select a presentation aid until you have decided on the purpose of your speech.
- **Evaluate your own skill and experience.** Use only equipment with which you are comfortable or have had practical experience.
- **Know the room in which you will speak.** If the room has large windows with no shades and no other way to dim the light, do not consider using visuals that require a darkened room.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

20.1 Discuss five ways in which presentation aids help communicate ideas to an audience.

Presentation aids help you gain and maintain the audience's attention and communicate the organization of your ideas. They can improve listeners' understanding and recollection of those ideas.

20.2 Describe seven types of presentation aids and how to use them effectively.

There are seven types of presentation aids: images, text, video, audio, objects, models, and people. The most common presentation aids are two-dimensional images such as drawings, photographs, maps, graphs, and charts. Many speakers also use text, which could be just a word or two, or a brief outline of the key points. Video and audio can also be used to help communicate ideas to listeners. Using objects and models as well as people can also enhance audience interest.

20.3 Describe how computers may be used to generate high-quality presentation aids.

When using computer-generated presentation aids, keep sights and sounds simple, present information in briefer chunks, repeat visual elements to unify your presentation, use clip art to give your visuals a professional touch, avoid mixing too many different fonts, and make informed decisions about using color.

20.4 Use criteria to choose presentation aids to include in a speech.

Consider the audience, your topic and purpose, your own skills, and the location of your speech when choosing presentation aids.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Identify several public speaking situations that would lend themselves well to using presentation aids. What are some situations in which using presentation aids would *not* be beneficial?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Tom is preparing a speech on driver safety. He plans to begin his speech with a series of graphic pictures showing traffic accident victims. Is it ethical to show graphic images that arouse audience fears?
3. **Critical Assessment** Professor Chou uses only the chalkboard to illustrate her anthropology lectures and then only occasionally writes a word or two. What other types of visual or auditory aids could Professor Chou use when teaching?

DEVELOPING AND USING PRESENTATION AIDS



OBJECTIVES

21.1 Follow three guidelines for developing effective presentation aids.

21.2 Identify guidelines for effectively using presentation aids.

GUIDELINES FOR DEVELOPING PRESENTATION AIDS

21.1 Follow three guidelines for developing effective presentation aids.

A speech should be more than just what a speaker says, with a few PowerPoint slides or other visual aids added as an afterthought. Spend time carefully developing your **visual rhetoric** as well as your words. The following commonsense and research-based strategies can help you prepare effective presentation aids for your speeches.

Make Them Easy to See

To communicate your ideas clearly, everyone in the audience must be able see your presentation aids clearly. Our most important advice is this: *Make it big!*

Keep Them Simple

Simple presentation aids usually communicate best. Some students think the visuals accompanying a speech must be as complicated as a Broadway production, complete with lights and costumes. Resist making them complicated. Text should be limited to key words or phrases. Simple images are better than overly detailed graphics.

Don't cram too much information on one chart or computer slide. If you have a lot of information, it is better to use two or three simple charts or slides than to attempt to put all your words on one.

Keep Them Safe!

While demonstrating how to string a bow during a speech on archery, one student accidentally launched the bow over the heads of his startled audience. Not only did he lose credibility because he was not able to string the bow successfully, but he also endangered his audience.

We cannot emphasize this point enough: Do not use dangerous or illegal presentation aids! They are never worth the risk of a ruined speech or an injured audience member. Substitute a picture, chart, or other representational device.

USING PRESENTATION AIDS

21.2 Identify guidelines for effectively using presentation aids.

Here are some tips to help you use presentation aids for maximum audience impact.

Rehearse with Your Presentation Aids

Your appearance before an audience should not be the first time you deliver your speech while holding up an object, operating a remote control to show your slides, clicking on a YouTube video, or using a flipchart. Practice with your presentation aids until you feel at ease with them.

Make Eye Contact with Your Audience and Not with Your Presentation Aids

Of course, you will need to glance at your visual aid to make sure that it isn't upside down or that it is the proper one. But do not face the image or object while giving your

talk. Keep looking your audience in the eye or at the lens of your camera if your speech is presented virtually.

Explain Your Presentation Aids

Always set your visuals in a verbal context. Don't just unceremoniously announce, "Here are the recent statistics on birth rates in the United States," and hold up your visual without further explanation. Tell the audience how to interpret the data.

Do Not Pass Objects among Members of Your Audience

What can you do if your object is too small to be seen without passing it around? If no other speaker follows your speech, you can invite audience members to come up and see your object when your speech is over. If your audience is only two or three rows deep, you can even hold up the object and move in close to the audience to show it while you maintain control. Or you can take photos of the object, embed the photos in presentation software, and project the images at a size even a large audience can see.

Use Animals with Caution

Many actors are unwilling to work with animals—and for good reason. At best, they may steal the show. And most often, they are unpredictable. You may think you have the smartest, best-trained dog in the world, but you really do not know how your dog will react to a strange environment and an unfamiliar audience. The risk of having an animal detract from your speech may be too great to make planning a speech around one worthwhile.

Use Handouts Effectively

Many public speaking instructors believe you should not distribute handouts during a speech. Handing out papers in the middle of your presentation will only distract your

audience. However, many audiences in business and other types of organizations expect a summary of your key ideas in written form or a printout of your slides. If you do find it necessary to use written material to reinforce your presentation, consider using the suggestions in the How To box.



Use Handouts

- Don't distribute your handout *during* the presentation unless your listeners need to refer to the material while you're talking about it.
- Control listeners' attention by telling them where in the handout you want them to focus.
- Clearly number the pages on your handout material to make it easy for you to direct audience members to specific pages.
- If your listeners do not need the information during your presentation, tell them that you will distribute a summary of the key ideas at the end of your talk.

Time the Use of Visuals to Control Your Audience's Attention

A skillful speaker knows when to show a supporting visual and when to put it away. For example, it's not wise to begin your speech with all your charts, graphs, and drawings in full view, unless you are going to refer to them in your opening remarks. Time the display of your visuals to coincide with your discussion of the information contained in them.

- If possible, use a remote control to advance computer-generated slides so you do not have to stay anchored to your computer.
- When you are making a point or telling a story not related to any of your presentation aids, make sure

you mute, use a blank page, or otherwise remove any images or objects from the audience's view.

- Consider asking someone to help you hold your presentation aid or turn the pages of your flip chart. Make sure you rehearse with your assistant beforehand so that all goes smoothly during your presentation.

Use Technology Effectively

Some novice speakers are tempted to overuse presentation aids simply because they can quickly produce eye-catching visuals. Resist this temptation.

Also, don't assume that the hardware and software you need will be available in the room where you are speaking. Be sure to ask what kinds of technology exist.

Remember Murphy's Law

According to Murphy's Law, if something can go wrong, it will. When you use presentation aids, you increase the chances that problems or snags will develop when you present your speech. The chart may fall off the easel, you may not find a dry erase marker, or the computer in the room may not be compatible with your software. Be prepared. Bring backup supplies and have an alternative plan in case your original plans go awry.

If something doesn't go as you planned, do your best to keep your speech on track. If the chart falls, pick it up and keep talking; don't offer lengthy apologies. If you can't find a dry erase marker, ask a friend to hunt for one in another room. No computer-generated slides as you had planned? Have all key pieces of information in your notes rather than relying on your computer slides. A thorough rehearsal, a double-check of your equipment, backup images, and extra supplies such as extension cords and masking tape can help repeal Murphy's Law.

QUICK CHECK

Use Presentation Aids Effectively

- Rehearse until you feel at ease with your presentation aids.
- Make eye contact with the audience or the camera if presenting remotely.
- Explain your presentation aids.
- Do not pass objects among members of your audience.
- Use animals with caution.
- Use handouts and technology effectively.
- Time your visuals to control your audience's attention.
- Remember Murphy's Law.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

21.1 Follow three guidelines for developing effective presentation aids.

Effective presentations are easy to see, simple, and safe to use.

21.2 Identify guidelines for effectively using presentation aids.

As you present your speech, remember to look at your audience and not at your presentation aid; talk about your visual and don't just show it; avoid passing objects among your audience; use handouts to reinforce the main points in your speech; time your visuals carefully; and be sure to have backup supplies and a contingency plan.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** You have prepared handouts, several charts, and a short video clip to support your speech. What steps should you take to make sure your presentation is effective?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Ceally wants to play audio clips of offensive lyrics to demonstrate to his college classmates the increased use of profanity in contemporary music. Would you advise Ceally to play these songs, even though doing so might offend several members of his audience?
3. **Critical Assessment** Nikki plans to give a talk encouraging listeners to support funding for a new library. She wants to make sure they understand how cramped and inadequate the current library is. What type of visual support could she use to make her point?

PART 6
Types of Speeches



INFORMATIVE SPEAKING

OBJECTIVES

22.1 Describe three goals and five different types of informative speeches.

22.2 Effectively and appropriately use three strategies to enhance audience understanding.

22.3 Effectively and appropriately use three strategies to maintain audience interest.

22.4 Effectively and appropriately use four strategies to enhance audience recall of information presented in an informative speech.

22.5 Develop an audience-centered informative speech.

GOALS AND TYPES OF INFORMATIVE SPEECHES

22.1 Describe three goals and five different types of informative speeches.

When you inform someone, you assume the role of a teacher by defining, illustrating, or elaborating on a topic. A **speech to inform** shares information with others to enhance their knowledge or understanding of the information, concepts, and ideas you present. The skill of teaching and enhancing understanding is important in virtually any profession.

When you speak to inform, you typically attempt to achieve these three goals:

- *You speak to enhance understanding.* Understanding occurs when a listener accurately interprets the intended meaning of a message.

- *You speak to maintain interest.* If your listeners are bored and not focusing on your message, you won't achieve your informative-speaking goal.
- *You speak to be remembered.* The day after hearing a presentation, most listeners remember only about 50 percent of what they were told. By two days later, they recall only about 25 percent. Your job as an informative speaker is to improve those statistics.

Informative speeches can be classified according to the subject areas they cover. As Table 22.1 shows, classifying your speech can help you decide how to organize the information you want to present. Good organization will help your audience process your message.

STRATEGIES TO ENHANCE AUDIENCE UNDERSTANDING

22.2 Effectively and appropriately use three strategies to enhance audience understanding.

How do you enhance someone's knowledge or understanding? We can suggest several powerful strategies.

Speak with Clarity

To speak with clarity is to express ideas so that the listener understands the intended message accurately. Speaking clearly is an obvious goal of an informative speaker. What is not so obvious is *how* to speak clearly. As a speaker you may think you're being clear, but only the listener can tell you whether they have received your message.

Give careful thought to how you will help listeners understand your message. Here are several research-based strategies you can use to enhance message clarity and turn information into communication.[1]

- Preview your main ideas in your introduction.
- Tell your listeners how new information relates to a previous point.
- Provide reasons the audience needs to listen to your message.[2]

Table 22.1 Types of Informative Speeches

Topic	Purpose	Typical Organization Patterns	Examples
Objects	Present information about tangible things	Topical Spatial Chronological	The Rosetta Stone Museums The Mars Rover Religious icons
Procedures	Review how something works or describe a process	Chronological Topical Complexity	How to . . . Use an app to help you lose weight Operate a nuclear-power plant Buy a quality used car Trap lobsters
People	Describe famous people or personal acquaintances	Chronological Topical	Sojourner Truth Nelson Mandela J. R. R. Tolkien Your grandmother Your favorite teacher
Ideas	Present abstract information or discuss principles, concepts, theories, or issues	Topical Complexity	Socialism Immigration Buddhism Reincarnation
Events	Describe an event that either has happened or will happen	Chronological Topical Spatial	May Day in Oxford, England Inauguration Day Cinco de Mayo

- Frequently summarize key ideas.
- Use effective transitions and signposts; enumerate your major ideas.
- Provide a visual outline to help listeners follow your ideas.
- Provide a handout prior to your talk with the major points outlined; leave space so that listeners can jot down key ideas.
- Once you announce your topic and outline, stay on message.
- Provide clear examples.[3]
- Tell your listeners what your point is, and then offer an example.[4]

Use Principles and Techniques of Adult Learning

Andragogy is the art and science of teaching adults. The How To box summarizes some effective andragogical, or adult-learning, principles found by researchers and scholars.[5]



Use Adult-Learning Principles

- **Give adults information they can use right away.** Listeners are more likely to focus on and understand information they can apply immediately to their mental "to-do" list.
- **Actively involve your audience in the learning process.** Consider asking them questions to think about or, in some cases, to respond to on the spot.
- **Connect learners' life experiences with new information.** First, know the kinds of experiences that your listeners have had, and then refer to those experiences as you present your ideas.
- **Explain how new information is relevant to listeners' needs and their busy lives.** Show how the ideas you share are relevant to them.
- **Seek ways to relate the ideas you present to listeners' problems, obstacles, or hassles.** People will be more likely to pay attention to information that helps them better understand and solve their problems, overcome obstacles, or even avoid hassles.

Clarify Unfamiliar Ideas or Complex Processes

Research suggests you can demystify a complex process if you first provide a simple overview of the process using a comparison or a vivid, descriptive word picture.[6]

Use a Comparison Helping your listeners compare or visualize something they already understand with something new will make your message clearer. For example, if you're teaching your grandmother how a voice-activated smart speaker works, you could note similarities between something she already knows how to use, such as a phone.

Use an Analogy An **analogy** may compare two things that are similar (a literal analogy) or dramatically different (figurative analogy). To comprehend the vastness of the Milky Way galaxy, for instance, you might use a figurative analogy by pointing out that if the Milky Way were the size of North America, our entire solar system would fit inside a coffee cup.[7]

Use a Simile A **simile** is a comparison that uses the word *like* or *as*. Saying, "Listening to that choir is like hearing a bunch of squawking chickens" is a simile.

Use a Metaphor A **metaphor** makes an implied comparison between two things without using the words *like* or *as*.[8] Using a well-worded metaphor can help your listeners visualize more precisely what you mean. Some common metaphors you may have heard before are "All the world's a stage" and "You are a bright star."

Use a Vivid, Descriptive Word Picture When you *describe*, you provide more detail than when you just define something. One way to describe a situation or event is with a word picture. A **word picture** is a lively description that helps your listeners form a mental image by appealing to their senses of sight, taste, smell, sound, and

touch. To create an effective word picture, begin by forming your own clear mental image of the person, place, object, or process before you try to describe it. See it with your "mind's eye."

- What would listeners see if they were looking at it?
- What would listeners hear?
- If they could touch the object or participate in the process, how would it feel to them?
- If your listeners could smell or taste it, what would that be like?

To describe these sensations, choose the most specific and vivid words possible. Onomatopoeic words—words that resemble the sounds they name—such as *buzz, snort, hum, crackle*, or *hiss*, are powerful. So are similes and other comparisons. "The rock was as rough as sandpaper" and "the pebble was as smooth as a baby's skin" appeal to both the visual and the tactile senses.

For some speeches, you may want to use a descriptive word picture to elicit certain feelings or emotions from your audience. Ultimately, your goal is to use just the right descriptive words to evoke an emotional response. If you experienced the situation, describe your own emotions. Use specific adjectives rather than general terms such as *happy* or *sad*. One speaker, talking about her first speech assignment, described her reaction this way: "My heart stopped. Panic began to rise up inside. For the next week, I lived in dreaded anticipation of the event."[9] Note how effectively her choices of such words and phrases as "my heart stopped," "panic," and "dreaded anticipation" describe her terror at the prospect of making a speech—much more so than if she had said, "I was scared." The more vividly and accurately you can describe emotion, the more intimately involved in your description the audience will become.

QUICK CHECK

Strategies to Enhance Audience Understanding

- Speak with clarity.
- Use principles and techniques of adult learning.
- Clarify unfamiliar ideas or complex processes.

STRATEGIES TO MAINTAIN AUDIENCE INTEREST

22.3 Effectively and appropriately use three strategies to maintain audience interest.

Before you can inform an audience, you must gain and maintain their interest. No matter how carefully crafted your definitions, skillfully delivered your description of a process, or visually reinforcing your presentation aids, if your listeners aren't paying attention, you won't achieve your goal. Strategies for gaining and holding interest are vital in achieving your speaking goal.

Motivate Your Audience to Listen to You

Most audiences probably will not be waiting breathlessly for you to talk to them. You will need to motivate them to listen to you. Unless you hold the power to reward or punish your listeners, you will need to find more creative ways to get your audience to listen to you. Pique their interest with a story. Explain how the information you present will be of value to them. Use an unexpected twist or rhetorical question.

Tell a Story

Good stories with interesting characters and riveting plots have fascinated listeners for millennia; the words "Once upon a time" are usually a surefire attention getter.

Stories are also a way of connecting your message to people from a variety of cultural backgrounds.[10]

The characteristics of a well-told tale are simple yet powerful. A good story includes conflict, incorporates action, creates suspense, and may also include humor.

- **Conflict.** Stories that pit one side against another and describe opposing ideas and forces in government, religion, or personal relationships foster attention.
- **Action.** An audience is more likely to listen to an action-packed message that includes concrete and memorable images than to one that listlessly lingers on an idea.[11] The key to maintaining interest is a plot that moves along. Good stories have a beginning that sets the stage, a heart that moves to a conclusion, and an ending that ties up all the loose ends.
- **Suspense.** Keeping people on the edge of their seats because they don't know what will happen next is an element in good storytelling.
- **Humor.** Using a bit of humor makes the point while holding the listener's attention. Not all stories have to be funny. Stories may be sad or dramatic. However, adding humor when appropriate usually helps maintain interest.

Present Information That Relates to Your Listeners

Being an audience-centered informative speaker means being aware of information that your audience can use. If, for example, you are going to teach your audience about composting, be sure to talk about specific composting efforts on your campus or in your community. Adapt your message to the people who will be in your audience.

Use the Unexpected

Advertisers know that listeners will focus on the unexpected. If you add a surprise twist to a quotation or story,

audience members will increase their attention. You can also create a "mini-mystery" by asking a rhetorical question to get listeners to actively process your words.[12]

STRATEGIES TO ENHANCE AUDIENCE RECALL

22.4 Effectively and appropriately use four strategies to enhance audience recall of information presented in an informative speech.

Some speakers are better than others at presenting information in a memorable way. Here are some strategies that will help your audiences remember you and your message.

Build in Redundancy

When you speak, repeat key points. Provide a clear preview at the beginning of your talk as well as a summary statement in your conclusion. Include internal summaries—short summaries after key points during your speech—to help audiences remember key ideas. Use numeric signposts (numbering key ideas verbally by saying, "My first point is…, My second point is…".) to make sure your audience can identify and remember key points.

A reinforcing visual aid that displays your key ideas can also enhance recall. If you really want to ensure that listeners come away from your speech with essential information, consider preparing a handout or an outline of key ideas.

Make Your Key Ideas Short and Simple

Don't verbally bombard your listeners with lengthy lists. One classic research study concluded that people can hold only about seven pieces of information in their short-term memories.[13] So try to keep it short and simple. When you can, distill your key ideas down to a few brief and simple phrases, so your audience will be more likely to remember what you say.[14]

Pace Your Information Flow

Organize your speech so that you present an even flow of information, rather than bunching up a number of significant details around one point. If you present too much new information too quickly, you may overwhelm your audience.[15]

Make sure your audience has time to process any new information. Use supporting materials both to help clarify new information and to slow down the pace of your presentation. Do not try to see how much detail and content you can cram into a speech.

Reinforce Key Ideas

Reinforcing key ideas is one of the most powerful techniques of all.

Reinforce Ideas Verbally You can reinforce an idea by using such phrases as "This is the most important point," or "Be sure to remember this next point." Suppose you have four suggestions for helping your listeners avoid serious sunburns, and your last suggestion is the most important. How can you make sure your audience knows that? Just tell them. "Of all the suggestions I've given you, this last tip is the most important one. The higher the SPF level on your sunscreen, the better." Be careful not to overuse this technique. If you claim that every other point is a key point, soon your audience will not believe you.

Reinforce Ideas Nonverbally You can also signal the importance of a point with nonverbal emphasis. Gestures serve the purpose of accenting or emphasizing key phrases, as italics do in written communication.

- A well-placed pause can provide emphasis and reinforcement to set off a key point. Pause just before or just after making an important point to focus attention on it.
- Raising or lowering your voice can also reinforce a key idea.

- Movement can help emphasize major ideas. Moving from behind the lectern to tell a personal anecdote can signal that something special and more intimate is about to be said.
- Your movement and gestures should be meaningful and natural, rather than seemingly arbitrary or forced.

DEVELOPING AN AUDIENCE-CENTERED INFORMATIVE SPEECH

22.5 Develop an audience-centered informative speech.

Use the audience-centered speaking model, shown in Figure 3.1, to guide you step-by-step through the process of preparing an informative speech.

Consider Your Audience

As with any type of speech, an informative talk requires that you consider three general questions of audience analysis:

- *To whom are you speaking*?
- *What are their interests, attitudes, beliefs, and values*?
- *What do they expect from you*?

When your general purpose is to inform, you should focus on specific aspects of these three general questions. Considering who is in your audience and what they may or may not have in common is an important first step. Determining listeners' interests, attitudes, beliefs, and values can help you balance your use of strategies to enhance understanding and recall with your need to maintain their interest. For example, you won't need to work as hard to maintain the interest of an audience who is already highly interested in your topic. Careful consideration of audience members' expectations can also help you maintain their interest, perhaps by surprising them with something they do not expect.

Once your topic and purpose are clearly established, continue to consider your audience when developing your central idea and generating your main ideas. Interesting

and appropriate supporting material will make your message clear, engaging, and memorable. Most informative speeches are primarily organized using topical, chronological, or complexity strategies. As with any speech, rehearsing several times will help you deliver a message that your audience will listen to and perceive as credible. If you are presenting your speech online or via video, review Chapter 27 (Mediated Public Speaking) for tips and suggestions for presenting a speech in mediated settings.

QUICK CHECK

Audience-Centered Informative Speaking

- **Select topic**—Consider who your listeners are, as well as their interests and needs.
- **Formulate central and main ideas**—Make them clear and simple.
- **Gather supporting material**—Decide what will help the audience maintain interest and learn.
- **Organize**—Consider topical, chronological, or complexity as the primary organizational strategy for an informative speech.
- **Rehearse**—Deliver a polished message that your audience will listen to and perceive as credible.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

22.1 Describe three goals and five different types of informative speeches.

Informative speakers must enhance listeners' understanding, maintain their interest, and be remembered.

They can make speeches about objects, procedures, people, ideas, and events.

22.2 Effectively and appropriately use three strategies to enhance audience understanding.

To enhance your listeners' understanding of a message: (1) speak with clarity, (2) use principles and techniques of adult learning, and (3) clarify unfamiliar ideas or complex processes.

22.3 Effectively and appropriately use three strategies to maintain audience interest.

To gain and maintain listeners' interest, you must motivate your audience to listen to you. Tell a story, present information that relates to your listeners, or use the unexpected.

22.4 Effectively and appropriately use four strategies to enhance audience recall of information presented in an informative speech.

Help your listeners remember what you tell them by being redundant, keeping your key ideas short and simple, pacing the flow of information, and reinforcing important points.

22.5 Develop an audience-centered informative speech.

When preparing an informative speech, use the audience-centered speaking model introduced in Chapter 3 as a step-by-step guide.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** What strategies do your instructors use in class to motivate students to listen, enhance listeners' understanding, and improve their recall?
2. **Ethics Assessment** To give a 5-minute speech about wind energy, you must greatly simplify a complex process. How can you avoid misrepresenting your topic? Should you let your audience know how much you are simplifying the process?
3. **Critical Assessment** You have been asked to speak to a kindergarten class about your chosen profession. How can you make your message clear, interesting, and memorable to your audience?

UNDERSTANDING PRINCIPLES OF PERSUASIVE SPEAKING



OBJECTIVES

- **23.1** Describe the goals of persuasive messages.
- **23.2** Explain classical and contemporary theories of how persuasion occurs.
- **23.3** Describe four ways to motivate listeners to respond to a persuasive message.
- **23.4** Prepare and present an audience-centered persuasive speech.

THE GOALS OF PERSUASION

23.1 Describe the goals of persuasive messages.

Persuasion is the process of changing or reinforcing attitudes, beliefs, values, or behaviors. In a persuasive speech, the speaker invites the audience to make a choice, rather than just informing them of the options. To advocate a particular view or action successfully, you must understand your listeners' positions before you speak.

Attitudes

Our attitudes represent our likes and dislikes. Stated more precisely, an **attitude** is a learned predisposition to respond favorably or unfavorably toward something.[1] Attitudes are easier to change than either beliefs or values.

Beliefs

A **belief** is what you understand to be true or false. If you believe in something, you are convinced that it exists or is true. Most beliefs are based on past experiences

or evidence, but some are based on faith—we haven't directly experienced something, but we believe anyway. A belief is more susceptible to change than a value is, but it is still difficult to alter. Beliefs are changed by evidence. Usually it takes a great deal of evidence to change a belief and alter the way your audience structures reality.

Values

A **value** is an enduring conception of right or wrong, good or bad. If you value something, you classify it as good or desirable, and you tend to think of its opposite or its absence as bad or wrong. If you do not value something, you are indifferent to it. Speeches that focus on changing or reinforcing audience values emphasize how and why something is better than something else. Values form the basis of our life goals and the motivating force behind our behavior. Therefore, listeners' values are difficult to change. Understanding what your listeners value can, however, help you adapt the content of your speech to their values.

Behaviors

Persuasive messages often attempt to do more than change or reinforce attitudes, beliefs, or values—they attempt to change or strengthen behaviors. It seems logical that knowing someone's attitudes, beliefs, and values will help us predict precisely how that person will behave. But we are complicated creatures, and human behavior is not always neatly predictable. Sometimes our attitudes, beliefs, and values may not appear to be consistent with how we act.

HOW PERSUASION WORKS

23.2 Explain classical and contemporary theories of how persuasion occurs.

There are many theories and considerable research on how persuasion works. We'll discuss two approaches here: (1) a classical approach identified by the ancient

Greek rhetorician Aristotle and (2) the elaboration likelihood model (ELM), a contemporary theory that builds on the classical approach. Both suggest that persuasion is a complex process and that not all of us are persuaded in the same way. Aristotle's theory emphasizes what a *speaker* should do to influence an audience, whereas ELM theory describes how *listeners* process the messages they hear.

Aristotle's Traditional Approach: Using Ethos, Logos, and Pathos to Persuade

Aristotle, a Greek philosopher and rhetorician who lived and wrote in the fourth century BCE, defined *rhetoric* as the process of discovering, in any particular case, the available means of persuasion. He identified three general methods (or, using his language, "available means") of persuasion. They are ethos, logos, and pathos.[2]

ETHOS To use **ethos** to persuade, an effective communicator must be credible. Aristotle believed that to be credible, a public speaker should be perceived as being ethical, possessing good character, having common sense, and being concerned for the well-being of the audience. The more credible and ethical a speaker is perceived to be, the greater the chances are that a listener will believe in, trust, and respond positively to the speaker's persuasive message.

LOGOS The word **logos** literally means "the word." Aristotle used this term to refer to the words a speaker uses to develop rational, logical arguments to persuade someone. A skilled persuader not only reaches a logical conclusion but also supports the message with evidence and reasoning.

PATHOS Aristotle used the term **pathos** to refer to the use of appeals to emotion in persuasion. Emotion-arousing stories and concrete examples, as well as pictures and music, all appeal to listeners' emotions.

ELM's Contemporary Approach: Using a Direct or Indirect Path to Persuade

The **elaboration likelihood model (ELM) of persuasion** has a long name but is actually a simple idea that explains how you are persuaded to do or think about something.[3]

To **elaborate** means that you *think* about the information, ideas, and issues related to the content of the message. When you elaborate on a message, you are critically evaluating what you hear by paying special attention to the arguments and evidence the speaker is using. The likelihood of whether or not you elaborate on a message (hence, the name *elaboration likelihood model*) varies from person to person and depends on the topic of the message. The theory suggests that there are two ways you can be persuaded:

1. You follow the **direct persuasion route** when you elaborate, consciously think about, or critically evaluate a message.
2. The **indirect persuasion route** occurs when you don't elaborate and are more influenced by the peripheral factors of the message and messenger. You might, for example, be persuaded by a speaker's appearance or their use of an emotionally charged story.

QUICK CHECK

Theories of Persuasion

Aristotle

Focus is on speaker's actions:

- Ethos—speaker credibility and ethics
- Logos—logic, evidence
- Pathos—emotion

ELM

Focus is on listeners' actions:

- Direct route—elaboration on logic, evidence
- Indirect route—no elaboration, persuaded by factors such as credibility and emotion

In addition to presenting well-reasoned arguments with credible evidence, ELM theory suggest that, as a speaker, you must also be attuned to indirect factors that can influence your listeners, such as your delivery, appearance, and your audience's general impression of how prepared you are.

HOW TO MOTIVATE LISTENERS

23.3 Describe four ways to motivate listeners to respond to a persuasive message.

Motivation is the underlying desire to think, feel, or behave in a certain way. Persuasion works when listeners are motivated to respond to a message. An audience is more likely to be persuaded if you help members solve their problems or otherwise meet their needs. They can also be motivated when you convince them that good things will happen if they follow your advice or bad things will occur if they don't.

Use Cognitive Dissonance

According to dissonance theory, when you are presented with information inconsistent with your current attitudes, beliefs, values, or behavior, you experience a kind of discomfort called **cognitive dissonance**.[4] The word *cognitive* refers to thoughts; *dissonance* means "lack of harmony or agreement." So cognitive dissonance means that you are experiencing a way of thinking that is inconsistent and uncomfortable. Most people seek to avoid feelings of dissonance; thus, creating dissonance with a persuasive speech can be an effective way to change attitudes and behavior.

If you want to create cognitive dissonance as a speaker, you must first identify an existing problem or a need. Then use evidence such as facts, statistics, or expert testimony to document your claims. Never use false claims to create dissonance; to do so would be unethical. Finally, suggest ways listeners can minimize or eliminate their dissonance.

Your listeners may react in several ways to your use of dissonance, only one of which serves your purpose.[5]

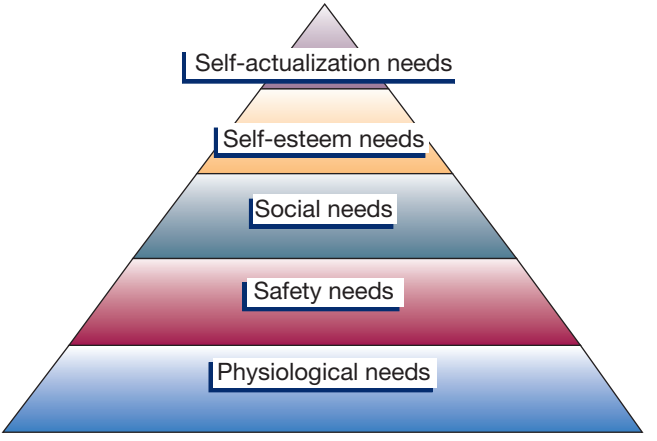
- **Listeners may discredit the source (you).** You need to ensure that your audience will perceive you as competent and trustworthy so that they will accept your message.
- **Listeners may reinterpret the message.** They may choose to focus on the parts of your message that are consistent with what they already believe and ignore the unfamiliar or controversial parts.[6] To counter this tendency, make your message as clear as possible.
- **Listeners may seek new information.** Audience members may look for additional information to negate your position. Be sure your own evidence is trustworthy, making it harder to refute.
- **Listeners may stop listening.** Some messages are so much at odds with listeners' current positions that they may decide to stop listening. The principle of selective exposure suggests that we tend to pay attention to messages that are consistent with our points of view and to avoid those that are not. Being aware of listeners' existing attitudes, beliefs, and values can help you ensure they don't tune out.
- **Listeners may change their attitudes, beliefs, values, or behavior—as the speaker wishes them to do.** If listeners change their attitudes, they can reduce their dissonance and restore their sense of balance.

Use Listeners' Needs

Need is one of the best motivators. The more you understand what your listeners need, the greater the chances are that you can gain and hold their attention and ultimately get them to do what you want.

Abraham Maslow suggested that a hierarchy of needs, as shown in Figure 23.1, motivates everyone's behavior.[7] Maslow suggested that we must meet basic physiological needs (such as food, water, and air) before

Figure 23.1 Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs.



SOURCE: Based on Abraham H. Maslow, "A Theory of Human Motivation," in *Motivation and Personality* (New York: Harper & Row, 1954), chap. 5.

we can be motivated to respond to higher-level needs. Although research suggests that we are not limited to hierarchical order and can be motivated by several needs at the same time, Maslow's hierarchy provides a useful checklist of potential listener motivations that a persuasive speaker can activate in order to change or reinforce attitudes, beliefs, values, or behavior.

Physiological Needs The most basic needs for all humans are physiological: We all need air, water, and food. According to Maslow's theory, unless those needs are met, it will be difficult to motivate a listener to satisfy other needs. Be sensitive to the basic physiological needs of your audience so that your appeals to higher-level needs will be heard.

Safety Needs Once basic physiological needs are met, listeners are concerned about their safety. We all need to feel safe, secure, and protected. Persuasive speakers often appeal to our need to provide for our own and our loved ones' safety.

Social Needs We all need to feel loved and valued. We need contact with others and reassurance that they care

about us. According to Maslow, these social needs translate into our need for a sense of belonging to a group (a fraternity, a religious organization, a circle of friends). Powerful persuasive appeals are based on our need for social contact.

Self-Esteem Needs The need for self-esteem reflects our desire to think well of ourselves. Advertisers often appeal to that need when they encourage us to believe that we will be noticed by others or stand out in a crowd if we purchase their product.

Self-Actualization Needs The need for **self-actualization** is the need to fully realize our highest potential, which Maslow suggested could be addressed only after we have satisfied our needs at the other four levels. Persuasive calls to be the best at something appeal to this need.

Use Positive Motivation

Positive motivational appeals are statements suggesting that good things will happen to listeners who heed the speaker's advice. A key to using positive motivational appeals effectively is to know what your listeners value.[8] Knowing what audience members view as desirable, good, and virtuous can help you select the benefits of your persuasive proposal that will best appeal to them. Knowing that your listeners value clean air, for example, may help you persuade them to support your proposal for new limits on emissions.

Use Negative Motivation

The use of a threat to change someone's attitude or behavior is one of the most effective persuasive strategies.[9] Negative motivation, also known as a **fear appeal**, takes the form of an "if–then" statement. If you don't do *X*, then awful things will happen to you. An important need will go unmet unless the desired behavior or attitude change occurs. Ethical and successful fear appeals require careful consideration of your audience. Consider the tips in the How To box.



Use Fear Appeals to Persuade

- **Threaten listeners' loved ones.** A strong threat to a loved one tends to be more successful than a fear appeal directed at the audience members themselves.
- **Establish your credibility.** The more credible your audience perceives you to be, the more likely it is that your fear appeal will be effective.
- **Make sure the threat is real.** Fear appeals are more successful if you can convince listeners that the threat will probably occur unless they take the action you are advocating.
- **Make the threat scary.** Increasing the intensity of a fear appeal increases the chances that it will be effective.[10]
- **Empower listeners to act.** Make sure you tell your listeners what they can do to reduce the threat.[11]
- **Don't exaggerate.** As an ethical speaker, you must be truthful when using fear appeals.

DEVELOPING YOUR PERSUASIVE SPEECH

23.4 Prepare and present an audience-centered persuasive speech.

The process of developing a persuasive speech follows the same audience-centered path you would take to develop any speech.

Consider the Audience

Although being audience-centered is important in every speaking situation, it is vital when your objective is to persuade. It would be extremely difficult to persuade someone without knowing something about their interests, attitudes, beliefs, values, and behaviors.

Remember that persuasion occurs differently for different cultural and ethnic groups. Always consider the diversity of your audience when planning your speech.

Don't design a persuasive message using strategies that would be effective only for you or those with your cultural or ethnic background.

Select and Narrow Your Persuasive Topic

The best persuasive topics are those you feel passionate about. You'll present a better speech if you select a topic you can speak about with sincere conviction. However, the ideal topic should also reflect your audience's passions and interests. Current events and controversial issues—questions about which people disagree—also make excellent sources for persuasive topics. In choosing a controversial topic, you need to be audience-centered. Know the local, state, national, or international issues that interest your listeners.

Determine Your Persuasive Purpose

When you want to persuade others, you don't always have to strive for dramatic changes in their attitudes, beliefs, values, and behavior. Your speaking goal may be only to move listeners a bit closer to your ultimate persuasive objective. **Social judgment theory** suggests that when listeners are confronted with a persuasive message, their responses fall into one of three categories: (1) a latitude of acceptance, in which they generally agree with you; (2) a latitude of rejection, in which they disagree; or (3) a latitude of noncommitment, in which they are not yet committed.[12] It is important to know which latitude category your listeners fall into before you begin so you can choose a realistic persuasive goal.[13] If most of your listeners are in the latitude of rejection, it will be difficult to move them to the latitude of acceptance with a single speech. A more realistic goal might be to make them less certain of their rejection.

Develop Your Central Idea and Main Ideas

When persuading others, most speakers find it useful to state their central idea in the form of a proposition.

A **proposition** is a statement with which you want your audience to agree. There are three categories of propositions.

Proposition of Fact A **proposition of fact** focuses on whether something is true or false or on whether it did or did not happen. To be a good speech topic, a proposition of fact must be debatable, such as "Low-carbohydrate diets are safe and effective." It should not be a fact, such as who won the last Super Bowl, that can be easily verified. Most persuasive speeches that focus on propositions of fact begin by identifying one or more reasons why the proposition is true.

Proposition of Value A **proposition of value** is a statement that calls for the listener to judge the worth or importance of something. Value propositions often directly compare two things, or two courses of action, and suggest that one of the options is better than the other.

Proposition of Policy The third type of proposition, a **proposition of policy**, advocates a specific action—changing a policy, procedure, or behavior. Typically, propositions of policy include the word *should*. For example, "Public schools should encourage more physical activity."

Gather Supporting Material

Keep in mind Aristotle's three "available means" of persuasion as you gather supporting materials: (1) *ethos* includes using credible and ethical supporting material; (2) *logos* requires you to use effective logic, reasoning, and evidence to support your main ideas; and (3) *pathos* suggests using appropriate emotional support.

Organize Your Speech

Your audience and your specific purpose can help you decide how to begin your message, organize your ideas, and conclude your talk. We'll discuss specific approaches and tips for organizing a persuasive speech in the next chapter.

Rehearse and Deliver Your Speech

The last two elements of the speechmaking process are to rehearse your message aloud and then, finally, to present your talk to your audience. Remember that ELM predicts that the emotional energy of your delivery can, in itself, be persuasive to some of your listeners. No matter how well-reasoned your message, at least some of your listeners are likely to fail to elaborate or critically consider it. Instead, these listeners may be persuaded by an indirect route, one based on the emotional connection you make with them in the course of delivering your speech.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

23.1 Describe the goals of persuasive messages.

The goals of persuasion are to change or reinforce attitudes, beliefs, values, or behavior.

23.2 Explain classical and contemporary theories of how persuasion occurs.

Aristotle suggested using ethos, logos, and pathos to persuade. The elaboration likelihood model of persuasion suggests that listeners either follow a direct route to persuasion, in which they elaborate (think about) the issues and evidence, or they can be persuaded via an indirect route when they don't elaborate.

23.3 Describe four ways to motivate listeners to respond to a persuasive message.

Persuasive speakers can motivate listeners through cognitive dissonance, satisfying listeners' needs, positive motivational appeals, or fear appeals.

23.4 Prepare and present an audience-centered persuasive speech.

You can apply the principles of persuasion to each step of the audience-centered speechmaking process.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** If you were attempting to sell a new computer system to the administration of your school, what persuasive principles would you draw on to develop your message?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Is it ethical to develop a persuasive message that supports an attitude or belief with which you personally disagree?
3. **Critical Assessment** Martha has been asked to speak to the Association for the Preservation of the Environment. What possible persuasive topics and propositions would be appropriate for her audience?

USING PERSUASIVE STRATEGIES



OBJECTIVES

- **24.1** Identify strategies to improve your initial, derived, and terminal credibility.
- **24.2** Use principles of effective reasoning to develop a persuasive message.
- **24.3** Employ effective techniques of using emotional appeal in a persuasive speech.
- **24.4** Use strategies for effectively organizing a persuasive speech.
- **24.5** Adapt your persuasive message to receptive, neutral, and unreceptive audiences.

ENHANCING YOUR CREDIBILITY

24.1 Identify strategies to improve your initial, derived, and terminal credibility.

Credibility, which Aristotle referred to as *ethos*, is the audience's perception of a speaker's competence, trustworthiness, and dynamism.

- **Competence.** To be a **competent** speaker is to be considered informed, skilled, or knowledgeable about one's subject. You can enhance your perception as a competent speaker by telling your listeners that you have knowledge, expertise, or experience related to your topic.
- **Trustworthiness.** While delivering your speech, demonstrate your **trustworthiness** by conveying honesty and sincerity. One way to earn the audience's trust is by demonstrating that you have had experience dealing with the issues you talk about. Your trustworthiness may be suspect, however, if you advocate something that will result in a direct benefit to you.

- **Dynamism.** You project **dynamism**, or energy, through your delivery. **Charisma** is a form of dynamism. A charismatic person possesses charm, talent, magnetism, and other qualities that make the person attractive and energetic.

The more credible your listeners find you, the more effective you will be as a persuasive communicator. Speakers establish their credibility in three phases.

- **Initial credibility** is the impression listeners have of your credibility before you speak. Even before you open your mouth, listeners have a perception of you based on your appearance, what they may have heard about you, and the previous times they have heard you speak.
- **Derived credibility** is the perception of your credibility that listeners form as you present yourself and your message.
- **Terminal credibility** is the perception listeners have of your credibility when you finish your speech. The lasting impression you make on your audience is influenced by how you were first perceived (initial credibility) and what you did as you presented your message (derived credibility).

It's one thing to understand what credibility is and how it evolves, but quite another to develop it. To improve your credibility, we suggest you think about what you can do before, during, and after your speech to appear competent, trustworthy, and dynamic. Consider the following suggestions for improving your credibility.

- Make a good first impression by giving careful thought to your appearance and establishing eye contact before you begin your talk.
- Establish common ground with listeners by indicating in your opening remarks that you share their values and concerns.

- Support your arguments and conclusions with evidence.
- Present a logically organized, well-delivered message. Using appropriate internal summaries, signposts, and enumeration of key ideas can enhance your credibility as a competent and rational advocate.
- Use strategies to gain and maintain attention. Effective delivery helps you gain and maintain listener attention and affects whether listeners will like you.[1] If you can capture your listeners' attention, and if they like you, you'll be more persuasive.
- End with a good impression. Maintain eye contact with your audience as you deliver your conclusion. Don't start leaving the lectern or speaking area until you have finished your closing sentence. If the audience expects a question-and-answer period, be ready to listen and respond to their questions.

USING REASONING EFFECTIVELY

24.2 Use principles of effective reasoning to develop a persuasive message.

Logic is a formal system of rules for making inferences. Persuasive speakers need to pay careful attention to the way they use logic, or *logos* in Aristotle's wording, to reach a conclusion. Present *evidence* and then use appropriate *reasoning* to lead your listeners to the conclusion you advocate. **Evidence** consists of facts, examples, statistics, and expert opinions you use to support and prove the points you wish to make. **Reasoning** is the process of drawing a conclusion from evidence. *Proof* consists of the evidence plus the conclusion you draw from it. Using the principles of reasoning, logic, and evidence will help you develop strong arguments to both persuade others and effectively evaluate the persuasive messages of others.

A Model of Reasoning

Building on Aristotle's ideas, Stephen Toulmin, a British expert in logic and reasoning, proposed a detailed description of how we construct logical arguments using reasoning and evidence.[2] His **Toulmin Model of Argument** consists of the following three essential elements:

- The **data** consist of the evidence (facts, statistics, examples, and opinions) used to reach a conclusion.
- The **claim** is the conclusion that is reached from the data or evidence presented.
- The **warrant** is the logical connection that links the evidence to the conclusion.

A well-constructed persuasive argument includes data (evidence) to support a claim (conclusion), with a logical connection (warrant) that links the data and the conclusion. Sometimes the warrant or underlying logic may be implied rather than explicitly stated.

Understanding Types of Reasoning

There are several ways you can structure an argument to reach a logical conclusion. We will examine the following three ways in detail: inductively, deductively, and causally.

Inductive Reasoning Using **inductive reasoning**, you reach a general conclusion based on specific examples, facts, statistics, and opinions. You may not know for certain that the specific instances prove the conclusion is true, but you decide that, in all probability, the specific instances support the general conclusion.

To judge the validity of a **generalization** arrived at inductively, ask these questions:

- Are there enough specific instances to support the conclusion?
- Are the specific instances typical?
- Are the instances recent?

Reasoning by Analogy *Reasoning by analogy* is a special type of inductive reasoning. An *analogy* is a comparison. This form of reasoning compares one thing, person, or process with another to predict how the second thing will perform and respond. You could reason that a law that works in one state would have the same effect if used in another state.

There are questions that you should ask to check the validity of conclusions reached via analogy:

- Do the ways in which the two things (such as two states) are alike outweigh the ways in which they are different?
- Is the assertion true?

Reasoning by Sign *Reasoning by sign*, another special type of inductive reasoning, occurs when two things are so closely related that the existence of one thing means that the other thing will happen. For example, a clap of thunder and dark, swirling clouds are signs that rain will happen. When you use or hear reasoning by sign, you must establish that there is a strong, predictive relationship between the sign and the conclusion. Multiple signs improve your ability to predict.

Deductive Reasoning Reasoning from a general statement or principle to reach a specific conclusion is called **deductive reasoning**. This is the opposite of inductive reasoning.

Deductive reasoning can be structured in the form of a **syllogism**, which includes three elements:

1. A **major premise** is a general statement. A classic example of a major premise is based on mythology: All gods are immortal.
2. A **minor premise** is a more specific statement about an example linked to the major premise. The minor premise in our classic example might be: Zeus is a god.

3. The **conclusion** is based on the major premise and the minor premise. Following our example, we could conclude: Zeus is immortal.

You need to ensure that both the major and the minor premises are true and can be supported with evidence. (In the previous example, proving that Zeus is a god would be very difficult.) If they are both true, then you can state with certainty—rather than just probability—that your conclusion is also true.

Causal Reasoning **Causal reasoning** relates two or more events in such a way as to conclude that one or more of the events *caused* the others.

There are two ways to structure a causal argument:

- Reasoning from cause to effect, you move from a known fact to a predicted result, or from something that has occurred to something that has not yet occurred. For example, "If we allow the current pollution of the river to continue, townspeople will become ill."

QUICK CHECK

Types of Reasoning

- *Inductive reasoning* draws a conclusion based on specific examples, facts, statistics, and opinions. Reasoning by analogy and by sign are special types of inductive reasoning.
- *Deductive reasoning* applies a general statement or principle to a specific conclusion. It is the opposite of inductive reasoning. A deductive syllogism contains a major premise, minor premise, and conclusion.
- *Causal reasoning* relates two or more events in such a way as to conclude that one or more events caused the others. Your causal reasoning can proceed from a known cause to an unknown effect or from a known effect to an unknown cause.

- Reasoning from effect to cause, you move from known effect to unknown cause. You might show that many townspeople have illnesses that are a known effect of polluted water and then point to the river as the likely cause of their illnesses.

Adapt Reasoning for a Culturally Diverse Audience

Most of the logical, rational methods of reasoning discussed in this chapter evolved from classical Greek and Roman traditions of argument. Rhetoricians from the United States typically use a factual-inductive method of supporting ideas and reaching conclusions.[3] They identify facts and link them to support a specific proposition or conclusion. However, not all cultures prefer a direct, state-your-case-and-prove-it approach to reaching a conclusion.[4] If your audience is from another cultural tradition, you may need to use alternative strategies. For example, some cultures place a high value on relationships; people from such cultures tend to seek a personal connection with listeners before debating issues. Depending on the background and cultural expectations of your listeners, effective strategies for achieving your persuasive objective will vary.

Using Types of Evidence

When attempting to persuade listeners, make sure that your evidence logically supports the inductive, deductive, or causal reasoning you are using to reach your conclusion. Evidence in persuasive speeches consists of facts, examples, expert opinions, and statistics.

- A **fact** is something that has been directly observed to be true or can be proved to be true. Without direct observation or valid and reliable measurement, we can only make an inference. An **inference** is a conclusion based on available evidence or partial information.
- **Examples** are illustrations that are used to dramatize or clarify a fact. Only valid, true examples should be

used to help prove a point. A hypothetical example, one that is fabricated to illustrate a point, should not be used to reach a conclusion. It should be used only to clarify.

- **Opinions** can serve as evidence if they are expressed by an expert. Opinions are usually most persuasive if they are combined with other evidence, such as facts or statistics, that support the expert's position.
- A **statistic** is a number used to summarize several facts or samples.

If you use inductive reasoning (moving from specific examples to a general conclusion), you need to make sure you have enough facts, examples, statistics, and credible opinions to support your conclusion. If you reason deductively (from a generalization to a specific conclusion), you need evidence to document the truth of your initial generalization. When you are developing an argument using causal reasoning, evidence is also vital, as you attempt to establish that one or more events caused something to happen.

Once you have gathered evidence, follow these strategies to use it effectively:[5]

- **Use credible evidence.** Listeners are more likely to respond to your arguments if they determine that your evidence is from a trustworthy, knowledgeable, and unbiased source. One type of evidence that is especially powerful is reluctant testimony. **Reluctant testimony** is a statement by someone who has reversed their position on a given issue or is a statement made that is not in the speaker's best interest.
- **Use new evidence.** In addition to seeking up-to-date evidence, try to find evidence that the listener hasn't heard before—evidence that's new to the listener.
- **Use specific evidence.** Avoid vague terms, such as "many people." Use specific numbers and descriptions whenever possible.

- **Use evidence to tell a story.** Your evidence will be more powerful if the facts, examples, statistics, and opinions fit together to tell a story to make your point.
- **Use evidence appropriate to a diverse audience.** Listeners from some cultures will be more persuaded by stories or eyewitness testimony, whereas others will more likely be swayed by statistics.[6] You may need to ask a sampling of audience members or someone who knows the audience well what kind of evidence will be the most convincing.

Avoid Faulty Reasoning

Many persuaders use inappropriate techniques called *fallacies*. A **fallacy** is false reasoning that occurs when someone attempts to persuade without adequate evidence or with arguments that are irrelevant or inappropriate. You will be a better and more ethical speaker and a better listener if you avoid using the following reasoning fallacies.

Causal Fallacy The **causal fallacy** involves making a causal connection without enough evidence to support the cause-and-effect conclusion. Simply because one event follows another does not mean that the two are related.

Bandwagon Fallacy Someone who argues that "everybody thinks it's a good idea, so you should too" is using the **bandwagon fallacy**. Simply saying that "everyone" is "jumping on the bandwagon," or supporting a particular point of view, does not make the point of view correct.

Either–Or Fallacy Someone who argues that there are only two approaches to a problem is trying to oversimplify the issue by using the **either–or fallacy**.

Hasty Generalization A person who reaches a conclusion from little or no evidence is making a **hasty generalization**. For example, just because one person became ill after eating the meatloaf in the cafeteria does not mean

that everyone eating in the cafeteria will develop food poisoning.

Ad Hominem Fallacy Also known as attacking the person, an **ad hominem** (Latin for "to the man") **fallacy** involves attacking irrelevant characteristics of the person who is proposing an idea, rather than attacking the idea itself.

Red Herring Fallacy The **red herring fallacy** is used when someone attacks an issue by using irrelevant facts or arguments as distractions. This fallacy gets its name from an old trick of dragging a red herring across a trail to divert any dogs that may be following.

Appeal to Misplaced Authority Ads that use athletes to sell automobiles make an **appeal to misplaced authority**. Although we have great respect for athletes in their own fields, they are no more expert than we are about the product they are promoting.

Non Sequitur If you argue that a new parking garage should not be built on campus because the grass has not been mowed on the football field for three weeks, you are guilty of a **non sequitur**. Your conclusion simply does not follow from your statement.

Slippery Slope Fallacy When someone claims that an initial action or proposal is the first step toward disastrous consequences, they are using a **slippery slope fallacy**. It is a reasoning fallacy because pronouncing an action as a slippery slope and assuming it is something bad, may not necessarily be true; it may, or it may not be bad.

USING EMOTION TO PERSUADE

24.3 Employ effective techniques of using emotional appeal in a persuasive speech.

As suggested by the two major theories of persuasion described in Chapter 23, we are often persuaded by emotion, which Aristotle called *pathos*, as well as logic.



Use Emotion to Persuade

- Use concrete examples that help your listeners visualize what you describe.
- Use emotion-arousing words.
- Tell stories with an emotional message.
- Use nonverbal behavior to communicate your emotional message.
- Use images to evoke emotions.
- Use appropriate metaphors and similes.
- Use appropriate fear appeals.
- Consider using appeals to several emotions, including hope, pride, courage, and reverence.

As a public speaker trying to sway your listeners to your viewpoint, your job is to ethically use emotional appeals to achieve your goal.

Your key concern as a public speaker is "How can I ethically use emotional appeals to achieve my persuasive purpose?" The How To box provides general strategies.

Another way to arouse listeners' emotions is to reference a **myth**, a belief held in common by a group of people that is based on their values, cultural heritage, or faith. Referring to a shared myth is a way for you to identify and develop a bond with your listeners and to help them see how your ideas support their ideas.

Keep in mind that listeners' cultures can influence how receptive they are to emotional expressions and appeals. To identify listeners' expectations, you can observe other successful speakers addressing similar audiences.

Avoid Misusing Emotional Appeals: Ethical Issues

Regardless of which emotions you use to motivate your audience, you have an obligation to be ethical and forthright. Making false claims, misusing evidence to arouse

emotions, or relying only on emotions without supplying any evidence to support a conclusion violates ethical standards of effective public speaking.

ORGANIZING PERSUASIVE MESSAGES

24.4 Use strategies for effectively organizing a persuasive speech.

How you decide to organize your speech has a major effect on your listeners' response to your message. The How To box offers general suggestions for organizing your speech. You can also use or combine the following specific organizational patterns.



Organize Your Persuasive Speech

- If you think your audience will be hostile to your point of view, advance your strongest arguments first. If you save your best argument for last, your audience may have already stopped listening.
- Do not bury key arguments and evidence in the middle of your message. Your listeners are more likely to remember information presented first and last.[7]
- If you want your listeners to take some action, it is best to tell them at the end of your speech what you want them to do. Don't call for action in the middle of your speech. It will be more powerful if you wait until your conclusion.
- It is usually better to present both sides of an issue rather than just the advantages of the position you advocate. If you don't acknowledge the counterarguments—arguments against your position—that your listeners have heard, they will probably think about them anyway.
- After you mention counterarguments, refute them with evidence and logic that show how your proposal is better.
- Adapt your organization to the culture of your audience. Most US audiences tend to like a highly structured message, whereas audiences from some other cultures may expect a less formal structure.

Problem–Solution

The most basic organizational pattern for a persuasive speech is to make the audience aware of a problem and then to present a solution that clearly solves it. The problem-solution pattern works best when a clearly evident problem can be documented and a solution can be proposed to deal with the well-documented problem. You'll also need to convince your listeners that the solution you are advocating for is the best way to resolve the problem.

Refutation

Another way to persuade an audience to support your point of view is to prove that the arguments against your position are false—that is, to refute them. To use refutation, you first identify objections to your position and then refute or overcome those objections with arguments and evidence. Credible evidence, facts, and data will be more effective than emotional arguments at overcoming any objections to your position that your listeners may hold.

Cause and Effect

As Chapter 11 describes, you can organize your persuasive cause-and-effect speech by discussing an effect, or problem, and then identifying the causes of the problem. You can also organize a message by noting the problem and then spelling out the effects of the problem. With either approach, the goal of using cause-and-effect organization is to convince your listeners that one event *causes* another. Simply because two events occur at the same time or in close succession does not prove that there is a cause-and-effect relationship.

The Motivated Sequence

The motivated sequence is a five-step organizational plan.[8] It uses the *cognitive dissonance* approach: First disturb your

listeners, and then point them toward the specific change you want them to adopt.

1. **Attention.** The attention step is, in essence, the introduction to your speech. Grab your listeners' attention with a personal or hypothetical example, a startling statement, an unusual statistic, a rhetorical question, or a well-worded analogy.
2. **Need.** Next, you arouse dissonance. Establish why your topic should concern your listeners. You must also convince listeners that there is a need for a change and that the need affects them directly.
3. **Satisfaction.** After you present the problem, identify the solution—your plan to satisfy the need. Be brief, but present enough information so that your listeners have a general understanding of how the problem may be solved.
4. **Visualization.** *Positive visualization* paints a verbal picture of how wonderful the future will be if your solution is adopted. *Negative visualization* helps listeners see how awful things will be if your solution is not adopted. Use either type alone, or both together.
5. **Action.** As the basis of your conclusion, tell your audience the specific action they can take to implement your solution. Identify exactly what you want your listeners to do. Give them simple, clear, easy-to-follow steps to achieve your goal.

The motivated sequence is a guide, not an absolute formula. Modify it to suit the needs of your topic and audience.

ADAPTING IDEAS TO PEOPLE AND PEOPLE TO IDEAS

24.5 Adapt your persuasive message to receptive, neutral, and unreceptive audiences.

Audience members may hold differing views of you and your subject. Your task is to find out if there is a prevailing viewpoint held by a majority of your listeners. If they

are generally friendly toward you and your ideas, you need to design your speech differently than you would if your listeners were neutral, apathetic, or hostile. We offer some suggestions to help.

Persuading the Receptive Audience

In speaking to a receptive group, you can explore your ideas in greater depth.

- Identify with your audience. Emphasize the similarities between you and your listeners.
- Clearly state your speaking objective. Provide an overview of your major point or purpose.
- Be explicit in directing your listeners' behavior. Tell your audience exactly what you want them to do and how you expect them to respond to your message.
- Ask listeners for an immediate show of support to help cement the positive response you have developed during your speech.
- Use emotional appeals effectively. You are more likely to move a favorable audience to action with strong emotional appeals while also reminding them of the evidence supporting your conclusion.
- Make it easy for your listeners to act. Make sure that what you're asking them to do is clear and easy.

Persuading the Neutral Audience

Many audiences will simply be neutral or indifferent. Your challenge is to make them interested in your message.

- Capture your listeners' attention early in your speech.
- Refer to beliefs that many listeners share.
- Relate your topic not only to your listeners but also to their families, friends, and loved ones.
- Be realistic about what you can accomplish. People who start with an attitude of indifference are probably not going to become as enthusiastic as you are after hearing just one speech.

Persuading the Unreceptive Audience

One of the biggest challenges in public speaking is to persuade audience members who are against you or your message. If they are hostile toward you personally, your job is to find ways to enhance your credibility and persuade them to listen to you. If they are unreceptive to your point of view, there are several approaches that you can use.

- Don't immediately announce that you plan to change their minds.
- Begin your speech by noting areas of agreement before you discuss areas of disagreement.
- Be realistic about what you can achieve. Don't expect a major shift in attitude from a hostile audience.
- Acknowledge the opposing points of view. Your listeners will be more likely to listen to you if they know you understand their viewpoint.[9]
- Establish your credibility. Let your audience know about the experience, interest, knowledge, and skills that give you special insight into the issues at hand.

Sometimes your audience disagrees with you because its members just don't understand your point. Or they may harbor a misconception of you and your message.[10] For such listeners, consider explaining rather than advocating. To enhance accurate understanding or correct a misconception, experienced speakers use a four-part strategy.[11]

1. Summarize the common misconceptions about the issue or idea you are discussing.
2. State why these misconceptions may seem reasonable.
3. Dismiss the misconceptions. Provide evidence to support your point; you need sound and credible data to be persuasive.
4. State the accurate information that you want your audience to remember. With a clear summary statement, reinforce the conclusion you want your listeners to draw from the information you presented.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

24.1 Identify strategies to improve your initial, derived, and terminal credibility.

Your competence, trustworthiness, and dynamism contribute to your credibility before, during, and after you speak.

24.2 Use principles of effective reasoning to develop a persuasive message.

Three general types of reasoning are inductive, which includes reasoning by analogy and by sign; deductive; and causal. Evidence includes facts, examples, opinions, and statistics.

24.3 Employ effective techniques of using emotional appeal in a persuasive speech.

Speakers can evoke persuasive levels of pleasure, arousal, and dominance among listeners by using examples, emotion-arousing words, nonverbal behavior, shared myths, and selected appeals to fear and other emotions.

24.4 Use strategies for effectively organizing a persuasive speech.

Four patterns for organizing a persuasive speech are problem–solution, refutation, cause-and-effect, and the motivated sequence.

24.5 Adapt your persuasive message to receptive, neutral, and unreceptive audiences.

Explore your ideas in depth when persuading a receptive audience. You must capture the interest of a neutral audience. Look for areas of agreement and choose a realistic goal with an unreceptive audience.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** What specific strategies can you implement to enhance your initial, derived, and final credibility as a public speaker in the minds of your public-speaking classmates?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Does dynamism always contribute to credibility? Should audiences be wary of charismatic speakers?
3. **Critical Assessment** Janice wants to persuade the management of her company to establish a wellness program. Draft outlines for Janice's main ideas according to each of the organizational patterns outlined in this chapter.

SPEAKING ON SPECIAL OCCASIONS



OBJECTIVES

25.1 Describe guidelines for effective public-relations speaking.

25.2 Identify occasions and best practices for ceremonial speeches.

25.3 List and explain strategies for creating humor in a speech.

PUBLIC-RELATIONS SPEAKING

25.1 Describe guidelines for effective public-relations speaking.

Public-relations speeches are designed to inform the public and improve relations with them—either in general or because a particular program or situation has raised some questions. If you are called upon to make a public-relations speech, use the following guidelines:

- First, discuss the need or problem that has prompted the speech.
- Go on to explain how the company or organization is working to meet the need or solve the problem, or why it feels there is no problem.
- Anticipate criticism, whether it comes from the audience as a whole or from a minority contingent, and take care not to become unpleasantly defensive.
- Acknowledge and counter potential problems or objections to the policy or program.
- Emphasize the positive aspects of the policy or program. You want to leave the impression that the company or organization has carefully worked through potential pitfalls and drawbacks.

CEREMONIAL SPEAKING

25.2 Identify occasions and best practices for ceremonial speeches.

Ceremonial, or **epideictic, speeches** make up a broad class of speeches delivered on many kinds of occasions.

Make Introductions

A **speech of introduction** is much like an informative speech. The speaker delivers the introduction to provide information to the audience about the main speaker. When you are asked to introduce a featured speaker or an honored guest, your purposes are similar to those of a good speech introduction: You need to capture the audience's attention, build the speaker's credibility, and introduce the speaker's general subject. You also need to make the speaker feel welcome, while revealing some of their personal qualities so the audience feels as if they know the speaker more intimately. There are two cardinal rules of introductory speeches:

- **Be brief.** The audience has come to hear the main speaker or to honor the guest, not to listen to you.
- **Be accurate.** Ask the person you are going to introduce to supply you with relevant biographical data beforehand. If someone else provides you with information about the speaker's background, make sure the information is accurate. Be certain that you know how to pronounce the speaker's name and any other names or terms you will need to use.

Keep the needs of your audience in mind at all times. If the person you are introducing truly needs no introduction, do not give one! Just welcome the speaker and step aside. Note that the president of the United States is always introduced simply: "Ladies and gentlemen, the president of the United States."

Make Toasts

Most people are asked at some time or another to provide a **toast** for some momentous occasion—a wedding, a celebration, a birth, a reunion, or a successful business venture. A toast is a brief salute to such an occasion, usually accompanied by a round of drinks and immediately followed by the raising or clinking together of glasses or goblets.

The modern toast is usually quite short—only a few sentences at most. Some toasts are personal, as, for example, one given by a best man who is a close friend of both the bride and the groom. In contrast, a toast made by someone who does not know the primary celebrants as intimately may be more generic in nature.

If you are asked to make an impromptu toast, let your audience and the occasion dictate what you say. Sincerity is more important than wit.

Present Awards

Presenting an award is somewhat like introducing a speaker or a guest: Remember that the audience did not come to hear you, but to see and hear the winner of the award. Making an **award presentation**, a speech accompanying the conferring of an award, is an important responsibility. An award presentation has several distinct components.

Refer to the Occasion Awards are often given to mark the anniversary of a special event, the completion of a long-range task, the accomplishments of a lifetime, or high achievement in some field.

Explain the History and Significance of the Award This section of the speech may be fairly long if the audience knows little about the award; it will be brief if the audience already knows the history and purpose of the award. Whatever the award, a discussion of its significance will add to its meaning for the person who receives it.

Name the Person The longest part of this segment is a glowing description of the achievements that elicited the award. If the name of the person receiving the award has already been made public, you may refer to them by name throughout your description. If you are going to announce the individual's name for the first time, you will probably want to recite the achievements first and leave the person's name for last. Even though some members of the audience may recognize the recipient from your description, you should still save the drama of the actual announcement until the last moment.

Nominate Candidates

Nomination speeches are similar to award presentations. They, too, involve noting the occasion and describing the purpose and significance of, in this case, the office to be filled. The person making the nomination should explain clearly why the nominee's skills, talents, and past achievements serve as qualifications for the position. And the actual nomination should come at the end of the speech.

Accept Awards

For every award or nomination, there is usually at least a brief **acceptance speech**. If you ever have to give an acceptance speech, it may be impromptu because you may not know that you have won until the award is presented. A fairly simple formula should help you compose a good acceptance speech on the spur of the moment.

- First, thank the person making the presentation and the organization they represent. It is also gracious to thank a few people who have contributed greatly to your success—but not a long list of everyone you have ever known, down to the family dog.
- Next, comment on what the award means to you. You may also wish to reflect on the larger significance of the award to the people and ideals it honors.

- Finally, try to find some meaning the award may have for your audience—people who respect your accomplishments and who may themselves aspire to similar achievements.

Present Keynote Addresses

A **keynote address** is usually presented at or near the beginning of a meeting or conference. It sets the theme and tone for other speakers and events. Your challenge as a keynote speaker is to arouse the interest of the audience and motivate them to learn more or work harder. One way is to incorporate examples and illustrations to which your audience can relate. You should also emphasize the importance of the topic or the purpose of the meeting.

Present Commencement Addresses

To be audience-centered, a **commencement address** must fulfill two important functions. First, the commencement speaker should praise the graduating class. Because the audience includes the families and friends of the graduates, the commencement speaker can gain their goodwill (as well as that of the graduates themselves) by pointing out the significance of the graduates' accomplishments.

A second function of an audience-centered commencement speech is to turn graduates toward the future. Commencement speakers should suggest new goals and try to inspire the graduates to reach for them.

Honor with Commemorative Addresses

A **commemorative address**, a speech delivered during special ceremonies held to celebrate some past event, is likely to include a tribute to the person or persons involved. A commemorative speech is, in part, an informative speech. The speaker needs to present some facts about the event or people being celebrated. Then the speaker builds on those facts, urging the audience to let past accomplishments inspire them to achieve new goals.

Pay Tribute with Eulogies

A **eulogy**—a speech delivered when someone has died—can be one of the most significant and memorable and also one of the most challenging forms of tribute. When you deliver a eulogy, you should mention—indeed, linger on—the unique achievements of the person to whom you are paying tribute and, of course, express a sense of loss. It is also proper in a eulogy to include personal and even tasteful humorous recollections of the person who has died. Finally, turn to the living, and encourage them to transcend their sorrow and sense of loss and feel instead gratitude that the dead person had once been alive among them.

QUICK CHECK

Types of Ceremonial Speeches

- Introductions
- Toasts
- Award presentations
- Nominations
- Acceptances
- Keynote addresses
- Commencement addresses
- Commemorative addresses and tributes
- Eulogies

AFTER-DINNER SPEAKING: USING HUMOR EFFECTIVELY

25.3 List and explain strategies for creating humor in a speech.

After-dinner speeches, which may not always be *after* dinner, may present information or persuade, but their primary purpose is to entertain. Speakers, actors, and comedians frequently employ the following strategies to make audiences laugh.



Choose Humorous Speech Topics

Your audience "gives attempts at humor their success or failure."[1] The following ideas can help you choose a topic that your audience will agree is funny.

- **Use what makes you laugh.** Chances are that if you have found an experience funny, an audience will, too.
- **Make fun of yourself.** Audiences almost always enjoy hearing self-deprecating humor.
- **Find humor in serious subjects.** Although your speech, as a whole, may be serious, you can often find humor in certain aspects of your topic. In his documentary film *Sicko*, Michael Moore showed a scrolling text of medical conditions that health insurance companies use to deny clients coverage against an outer-space backdrop while playing the *Star Wars* theme music.[2]
- **Avoid inappropriate subjects.** Topics that create a great deal of emotional noise for your audience (such as grief or anger) are not good subjects for humorous speeches.

Tell Humorous Stories

Humorous stories should be simple. Complicated stories and jokes are rarely perceived by audiences as funny. Successful after-dinner speakers also need a broad repertoire of jokes, humorous anecdotes, and one-liners. However, if you decide to use an anecdote, make sure you know it really well. Only if you know the material can you hope to deliver it with the intonation and timing that will make it funny.

Employ Humorous Verbal Strategies

Either a humorous anecdote or a shorter "one-liner" may rely on one of the following verbal strategies for humorous effect.

Play on Words **Puns** rely on double meanings to create humor. **Spoonerisms** occur when someone switches the initial sounds of words in a single phrase—for example, "sublic peaking" instead of "public speaking."

Malapropism is the mistaken use of a word that sounds much like the intended word—*destruction* for *instruction*, for example.

HYPERBOLE **Hyperbole**, or exaggeration, is often funny. In an after-dinner speech on "The Alphabet and Simplified Spelling," Mark Twain claimed,

> Simplified spelling brought about sun-spots, the San Francisco earthquake, and the recent business depression, which we would never have had if spelling had been left all alone.[3]

Of course, spelling could not have caused such catastrophes, but by using hyperbole, Twain makes his point in a humorous way.

UNDERSTATEMENT The opposite of hyperbole, **understatement** involves downplaying a fact or event.

VERBAL IRONY Speakers who employ **verbal irony** say just the opposite of what they really mean. Student Chris O'Keefe opens his speech on reading Shakespeare with the following statement:

> At a certain point in my life, I came to the realization that I wanted to spend my life's effort to become a great playwright.[4]

Chris reveals the irony of the statement when he continues:

> It has been about an hour and a half now and the feeling is still going strong.

WIT One of the most frequently used verbal strategies for achieving humor is the use of **wit**, which is relating an incident that takes an unexpected turn at the end. Accepting the Oscar for Best Actress in *The Queen*, Helen Mirren paid tribute to the monarch she had portrayed on screen in *The Queen*:

> Elizabeth Windsor has maintained her dignity, her sense of duty, and her hairstyle.[5]

The wit occurs in the final phrase "her hairstyle," which catches the audience off-guard because they anticipate another majestic attribute.

Use Humorous Nonverbal Strategies

After-dinner speakers often create humor through nonverbal cues such as posture, gesture, and voice, which are discussed in detail in Chapter 17 and Chapter 18. Well-timed pauses are especially crucial delivery cues for after-dinner speakers to master.

Even if you are a person who is not "naturally" funny, you can use the strategies outlined in this chapter to prepare and deliver an after-dinner speech that is lighthearted and clever. Such a speech can still be a success.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

25.1 Describe guidelines for effective public-relations speaking.

A public-relations speaker discusses the problem or particular program that prompted the speech, anticipating and countering criticisms.

25.2 Identify occasions and best practices for ceremonial speeches.

Chances are that at some time you will be called on to apply your speaking skills to make an introduction, toast, award presentation, nomination, acceptance speech, keynote, commencement or commemorative address, or a eulogy.

25.3 List and explain strategies for creating humor in a speech.

After-dinner speakers entertain through the use of humorous topics and stories, humorous verbal strategies, and humorous nonverbal strategies.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** You will be introducing a Pulitzer Prize–winning poet before her reading on your campus. How do you follow the cardinal rules of introductory speeches?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Several websites offer eulogy-writing services or prewritten generic eulogies. If you were asked to deliver a eulogy, would it be ethical to buy such a speech?
3. **Critical Assessment** A friend has been invited to give an after-dinner speech to a local service group but has no idea what to talk about. What advice can you offer?

SPEAKING IN SMALL GROUPS



OBJECTIVES

26.1 Identify and describe the five steps for solving problems in groups and teams.

26.2 Identify appropriate leadership roles and styles for small groups.

Small group communication is interaction among three to a dozen people who share a common purpose, feel a sense of belonging to the group, and influence one another.[1] Groups typically make better-quality decisions than do individuals because they have more information available, spark creativity among members, and can better recall and more actively process information. Group members are also usually more satisfied with participatory decisions than if someone just told them what to do. However, group members may also feel pressure to conform to the view of the group or of one dominant member. In addition, some members may shirk their responsibilities.[2] The goal of this chapter is to help decrease the disadvantages and increase the advantages of working with others.

SOLVING PROBLEMS IN GROUPS AND TEAMS

26.1 Identify and describe the five steps for solving problems in groups and teams.

A central purpose of many groups is solving problems—finding ways of overcoming obstacles to achieve a desired goal.

John Dewey, a philosopher and educator, suggested using **reflective thinking**, a series of steps to solve problems:[3]

1. Identify and define the problem.
2. Analyze the problem.

3. Generate possible solutions.
4. Select the best solution.
5. Test and implement the solution.

Although not every problem-solving discussion has to follow these steps, you can use them as a blueprint to relieve some of the uncertainty that exists when groups try to solve problems.

Identify and Define the Problem

Groups work best when they define their problem clearly and early in the problem-solving process. To reach a clear definition, the group should consider the following questions:

- What is the specific problem that concerns us?
- What terms, concepts, or ideas do we need to understand to solve the problem?
- Who is harmed by the problem?
- When do the harmful effects occur?

Policy questions can help define a problem and identify a course of action to solve it. Policy questions begin with phrases such as, "What should be done about … ?" or "What could be done to improve … ?" For example, "What should be done to improve security at US airports?" "What can we do to improve nutrition in school cafeterias?"

Analyze the Problem

Once the group understands the problem and has a well-worded question, the next step is to analyze the problem. **Analysis** is a process of examining the causes, effects, symptoms, history, and other background information that will help a group eventually reach a solution. When analyzing a problem, a group should consider the following questions:

- What is the history of the problem?
- How extensive is the problem?

- What are the causes, effects, and symptoms of the problem?
- Can the problem be subdivided for further definition and analysis?
- What methods do we already have for solving the problem, and what are their limitations?
- What obstacles might prevent a solution?

As part of the process of analyzing the problem, a group should identify **criteria**, standards for identifying an acceptable solution. Criteria not only help you recognize a good solution when you discover one but also help the group stay focused on its goal. Typical criteria for an acceptable solution may specify that the solution should be implemented on schedule, should be agreed to by all group members, should be achieved within a given budget, and should remove the obstacles causing the problem.

Generate Possible Solutions

When your group has identified, defined, and analyzed the problem, you will be ready to generate possible solutions using group brainstorming, as described in the How To box on the next page.

Select the Best Solution

Next, the group needs to select the solution that best meets the criteria and solves the problem. At this point, the group may need to modify its criteria or even its definition of the problem.

In evaluating the solution, consider the following questions:

- Which of the suggested solutions deals best with the obstacles?
- Is the solution effective in both the short and the long term?



Brainstorm with a Group

- **Set aside judgment and criticism.** Criticism and faultfinding stifle creativity.
- **Consider anonymous brainstorming.** If group members find withholding judgment difficult, have the individual members write suggestions on paper first and then share the ideas with the group or use an electronic brainstorming app that allows participants to share ideas anonymously.
- **Think of as many possible solutions to the problem as you can.** All ideas are acceptable, even wild and crazy ones. Piggyback off one another's ideas.
- **Record all the ideas that are mentioned.** Use a flipchart, chalkboard, electronic whiteboard, or other device so that all group members can see and respond to all the ideas.
- **After a set time has elapsed, evaluate the ideas.** Use the criteria the group has established. Approach the solutions positively. Do not be quick to dismiss an idea, but do voice any concerns or questions you might have. The group can brainstorm again later if it needs more creative ideas.

- What are the advantages and disadvantages?
- Does the solution meet the established criteria?
- Should the group revise its criteria?
- What is required to implement the solution?
- When can the group implement the solution?
- What result will indicate success?

To achieve **consensus**—all members supporting the final decision—it helps to summarize frequently and keep the group oriented toward its goal. Emphasizing where group members agree, clarifying misunderstandings, writing down known facts for all members to see, and keeping the discussion focused on issues rather than on emotions are also strategies that facilitate group consensus.[4]

Test and Implement the Solution

The group may want to develop a step-by-step plan for implementing the solution, a time frame for implementation, and a list of individuals who will be responsible for carrying out specific tasks.

LEADING SMALL GROUPS

26.2 Identify appropriate leadership roles and styles for small groups.

To lead is to influence others. Some think of a leader as one individual empowered to delegate work and direct the group. In reality, however, group leadership is often shared.

Leadership Responsibilities

Leaders help groups accomplish their tasks and maintain a healthy social climate. Rarely does one person perform all leadership responsibilities, even if a leader is formally appointed or elected. Most often, individual group members assume some specific leadership task, based on their personalities, skills, sensitivity, and the group's needs.

Leadership Styles

Leaders can be described by the patterns of behavior, or leadership styles, they exhibit. The following describe four general leadership styles.[5]

- *Authoritarian leaders* assume positions of superiority, giving orders and taking control of the group's activity. Although authoritarian leaders can usually organize group activities with a high degree of efficiency and virtually eliminate uncertainty about who should do what, most problem-solving groups prefer democratic leaders.
- *Democratic leaders* involve group members in the decision-making process, rather than dictate what should be done. Democratic leaders focus more on guiding discussion, facilitating group interactions, and listening.

- *Laissez-faire leaders* allow group members complete freedom in all aspects of the decision-making process. They do little to help the group achieve its goal. This style of "nonleadership" often leaves a group frustrated because it lacks guidance and has to struggle with organizing the work.
- *Transformational leaders* influence others by building a shared vision of the future, inspiring others to achieve, developing high-quality individual relationships with others, and helping people see how what they do is related to a larger framework or system.[6] Transformational leaders are good communicators who support and encourage rather than demean or demand.

What is the most effective leadership style? No single style is effective in every group situation. The best leadership style depends on the nature of the group task, the power of the leader, and the relationship between leader and group members.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

26.1 Identify and describe the five steps for solving problems in groups and teams.

To solve problems, groups must (1) identify and define the problem, (2) analyze the problem, (3) generate possible solutions, (4) select the best solution, and (5) test and implement the solution.

26.2 Identify appropriate leadership roles and styles for small groups.

Group members often share leadership responsibility to help groups accomplish tasks and maintain a healthy

social climate. Styles of leadership include authoritarian, democratic, laissez-faire, and transformational.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Your work team has been assigned to develop a new process for filling orders. What process should the team follow to solve its problem?
2. **Ethics Assessment** One member of Corey's problem-solving group has been skipping meetings and not doing their fair share of the work. Is it ethical for other group members to do extra work to make up for the slacker?
3. **Critical Assessment** Karl has been chosen to lead a group at work on a complicated project that's due in a short amount of time. Given the tight schedule and complexity of the project, what type of leadership style should Karl adopt? Why would this style be more successful than another?

MEDIATED PUBLIC SPEAKING



OBJECTIVES

- **27.1** Describe the basic principles of mediated public speaking.
- **27.2** Discuss how to effectively rehearse for an online presentation.
- **27.3** Explain how to effectively deliver an online presentation.
- **27.4** Describe the qualities of a good digital citizen.

AN INTRODUCTION TO MEDIATED COMMUNICATION

27.1 Describe the basic principles of mediated public speaking.

Mediated communication is any communication, written or oral, that uses technology (or another medium) to connect the speaker and the audience. The rapid growth of communication technology has changed the way we live, where we work, and how we interact with people. **Mediated public speaking** occurs when you prepare and present a speech to share with an audience who is not physically present with you. For example, at school you may prepare and record a speech to upload for an online class or at work you may use Zoom to present a business proposal to the company CEO, whose office is in another state. Some mediated presentations include both video and audio; others may be audio-only presentations, such as a podcast.

Many of the basic principles of in-person, audience-centered public speaking still apply to mediated public speaking. However, you will also need to consider whether you will give a live or prerecorded presentation,

how you will address an audience that you may not know much about, and what technology you will use.

Types of Online Presentations

Online presentations are divided into two categories: synchronous and asynchronous. A **synchronous presentation** takes place in real time. An **asynchronous presentation** is prerecorded and watched or listened to at a later time.

In a synchronous presentation, you deliver your presentation directly to the audience in real time, but you and the audience member(s) are in different locations. Most likely you will be using streaming video software such as Zoom, Skype, or FaceTime, or webinar software like Webex. With presentation software such as Webex, you can share files, respond to the audience via chat boxes, or use screencasting. **Screencasting** involves sharing your computer screen or desktop with an online audience.

Unlike synchronous presentations, asynchronous presentations, such as YouTube videos, podcasts, and vodcasts, are prerecorded for your audience to listen to or view at a later time. **Podcasts** use audio recording only. **Vodcasts** are similar to podcasts except they include images or video clips.

Hybrid presentations combine aspects of live and recorded presentations. They can take two forms. One form involves an original, live presentation over media (synchronous), which is also recorded for anyone to watch or rewatch at a later time (asynchronous). The second form consists of an original presentation given to both a live, in-person audience and an audience watching over media (either live or delayed).

The Advantages and Disadvantages of Mediated Public Speaking

Mediated public speaking presentations have both advantages and disadvantages.

The Advantages Online presentations allow for greater flexibility, as well as time and space efficiency. They can also be more cost effective than in person meetings. Depending on the type of technology used, synchronous presentations allow you to see and hear your audience while giving your speech. Receiving immediate feedback from your listeners is vital for an audience-centered speaker. Mediated public speaking can also help you communicate more easily with people in different time zones all over the world. And with the help of translators, it can also assist you in overcoming language barriers.

The Disadvantages Even if you are giving a synchronous presentation, you will receive limited sensory cues from audience members and generally feel a lack of connection with them. Noise and technology failures can interfere with your presentation. But perhaps the biggest disadvantage is that with an asynchronous presentation, you can't see or hear your audience. So you won't be able to adapt to your audience by gauging their reactions.

Considering Your Audience

For online presentations, you will need to consider the target audience, the amorphous audience, whether the audience is public or private, and how to capture your audience's attention.

Target Audience As we noted in Chapter 5, your target audience is the specific segment of your audience that you most want to address or influence. It is your **primary audience**. In a synchronous or hybrid presentation, your primary audience is the live audience. In an asynchronous presentation, your primary audience is the group of people you most want to reach with your presentation.

You may also have a **secondary audience** for your presentation. For a hybrid presentation, the secondary audience is anyone who watches the recorded version of the presentation. For an asynchronous presentation, the secondary audience includes individuals who are not in

your target audience but are involved in some way. For example, a secondary audience for your YouTube video on basic car maintenance tips may be more experienced mechanics or a child learning about cars.

For both hybrid and asynchronous presentations, the primary audience is typically more important, but you should not forget about the secondary audience. The secondary audience is often the amorphous audience.

Amorphous Audience For a presentation that you are going to upload to the internet for anyone to view, you will have an **amorphous audience**, one without a specific size and without specific demographics. This audience could be one person, or it could be millions of people.

Public versus Private Audience A business presentation via Zoom that is scheduled for a specific time and will not be recorded likely has a private audience. Asynchronous presentations recorded or saved in some way, such as on YouTube, may have a public audience.

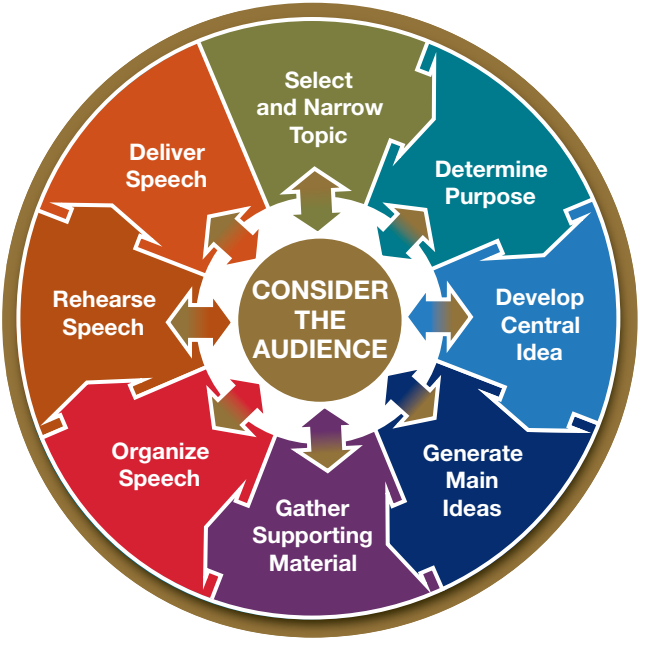
Online presentations come under the scrutiny of a vast number of people, all of whom have different viewpoints. Due to the anonymous nature of online communication (for example, comments posted about a YouTube video), audience members can often be harsh and unfeeling toward you as a speaker. Try not to take hurtful comments from anonymous audience members personally.

Preparing for Your Online Presentation

Like any speech, preparing for an online presentation involves following each step of the audience-centered model of public speaking (Figure 27.1). However, preparing for a mediated speech requires some additional considerations.

Selecting the Type of Presentation Will your presentation be synchronous or asynchronous? Will it involve audio only or both audio and video? Will you need additional presentation aids, such as graphics or a slide show? Will it involve screensharing? Will you need someone to

Figure 27.1 Consider the Audience.
The reminder to consider the audience is at the center of this model of the speechmaking process because your audience influences your work on each task involved in designing and presenting a speech.



run the camera, or will you do that yourself? All of these factors play a role in how you develop your speech and prepare for your presentation.

Selecting Technology Selecting the right technology is essential to the success of your online presentation. If you are using audio only, choose a microphone that will transmit your voice clearly. Make sure you maintain a consistent distance from the microphone when talking. If you are using both audio and video, select a camera with quality video and audio that is easy to use. If you are using digital visual aids, select software that allows you to create an effective visual presentation, whether your aids include graphs and tables, photos and illustrations, videos, or other graphics.



Capture Your Audience's Attention Online

When giving an online presentation, you may experience difficulty engaging your audience and holding their attention. Here are several strategies for capturing their attention:

- **Emphasize common ground.** If you know your audience, try to make connections with each audience member on a personal basis. If you don't know them, share stories they can identify with or familiar points of connection.
- **Ask rhetorical questions.** Rhetorical questions make the audience think but don't require a verbal answer. For example, you could ask, "How much time do you spend on social media?" Pausing to allow the audience time to think about their answer provides a dramatic effect for your point, personalizes the presentation, and helps to engage your listeners, even if you are giving an asynchronous presentation.
- **Maintain focus.** It's better to choose two or three relevant points and cover them thoroughly than to try to cover every point without any depth. Use signposts to help your audience track your train of thought and keep you focused on the topic throughout the presentation.
- **Highlight takeaways.** Takeaways are sentences or phrases that summarize the key points of your presentation that you want your listeners to remember. By repeating your takeaways at strategic points, you engage the audience and make your key points memorable.
- **Use variety.** Avoid boring your audience by standing in one place, using the same tone of voice, and not using hand gestures. Instead, vary your vocal pitch and speaking rate. Use purposeful, nondistracting body movement and hand gestures. Thoughtful facial expressions can communicate emotion. Use a variety of visual aids and camera angles.
- **Use images.** Consider using PowerPoint or other computer-generated slides to spark visual interest. Photos or images that support your message, rather than word-crowded slides, can help maintain listener interest.

Setting the Stage Once you have selected your technology, you need to consider the "stage" for your presentation. For a business presentation, for example, your background may be a conference room or office. Whatever background you choose, make sure that it is neat and tidy and does not distract the viewer.

Find a place that has minimal background noises. Make sure to place a note on the door indicating that a recording is in session, so you don't get interrupted.

For video presentations, lighting is a primary consideration. Use a primary light source that is behind the camera and directed at you. Avoid sitting in front of a strong backlight or large window that will make your face appear in shadow. The light should make the room bright enough for you and your visual aids to be clearly seen but not so bright as to make you appear washed out. A light ring can be a good investment if you know you will be giving video presentations frequently.

If you plan to use a camera, your clothing should set you apart from the background without being distracting. In general, single neutral colors are the best choice. Avoid dangly jewelry that may cause both visual and auditory distractions during the presentation.

Finally, when setting the stage, you should consider camera positioning. Typically, the camera should show you at least from the waist up (seeing only your head can be boring for the audience). In addition, the camera should be placed at eye level. Looking directly at the camera gives the impression of making eye contact with the audience, which keeps the audience engaged.

REHEARSING YOUR ONLINE PRESENTATION

27.2 Discuss how to effectively rehearse for an online presentation.

Before giving or recording your online presentation, you will want to rehearse your presentation several times. If you are giving a synchronous presentation that will

include a question-and-answer (Q&A) session, you will want to spend time preparing for that as well.

Rehearsing the Presentation

When rehearsing and presenting your speech, several useful tips can make your presentation more enjoyable for the audience.

- Imagine you are speaking to a live audience rather than to a camera. This will help you become more animated and connect with the audience better.
- Use a rate of delivery that is not too fast or too slow. Pause at natural stopping points, such as at the ends of sentences or paragraphs or between main points.
- Avoid hand gestures that are too big or are out of the camera's view.
- Use a voice volume that is similar to what you would use if you were speaking in a conference room.

Your practice session should be as close as possible to the actual event. Use the same equipment. Practice with your camera operator if you have one. If you can, wear the same clothes. Stand or sit in the same location using the same background and speaking notes you plan to use during your presentation. Do a voice check by recording a small part of your speech and playing it back to make sure it is loud enough. If you are doing a live presentation, consider asking someone to view your practice session remotely to check for signal strength and to make sure the connection can handle any media you plan to use. Consider recording your presentation so you can analyze it.

Rehearsing a Q&A Session

If you plan to have a Q&A session after your presentation, you will want to practice answering some questions. You may want to analyze your presentation and come up with possible questions the audience will ask so you can be prepared with answers. Also, consider asking some friends to watch your presentation and ask questions.

DELIVERING OR RECORDING YOUR ONLINE PRESENTATION

27.3 Explain how to effectively deliver an online presentation.

To ensure that the recording of your presentation goes as smoothly as possible, we recommend you follow some simple preparation tips. First, learn how to use your equipment properly. Whether you are using a video camera, computer, camera phone, or simply a microphone, understand how it works. Know how to adjust the sound and lighting. Learn how to adjust the focus and zoom. Figure out how to easily start and stop the recording.

You also need to understand how to use the software. If you are transmitting live, you will be streaming through a specific platform such as Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Webex, Google Hangouts, or GoToMeeting. Be familiar with how the software works and what each button does. If you are recording your presentation for upload later, make sure you know how to use software to save and edit your presentation.

If you are recording an asynchronous presentation, give yourself time for several takes and for editing the presentation. You may also be able to edit the presentation if you are skilled at using editing software. However, if you are recording a presentation for a class, make sure your instructor allows editing.

Depending on the complexity of your technology, you may find that trying to manage all aspects of the presentation is overwhelming. Don't be afraid to ask for help.

Finally, before you transmit or record your presentation, eliminate any distractions. Turn off or silence any devices that may emit unwanted or distracting sounds. Close down files or programs on your computer that you don't need. Close your door and post a sign on it so people know you are recording and won't interrupt you.

ONLINE ETIQUETTE: DIGITAL CITIZENSHIP

27.4 Describe the qualities of a good digital citizen.

Any time you upload content to the internet, you must use online etiquette, or proper online conduct.[1] Online etiquette begins with a discussion of digital citizenship. A **digital citizen** is a person who uses technology to communicate with others and participate in society.[2] If you want to use technology to interact with society, you must learn how to make responsible decisions about the content you upload or post, because even though you may think your postings are private or temporary, most information posted online is neither. What, then, does digital citizenship mean in the context of mediated public speaking? Let's look at this topic from two perspectives: the speaker and the audience.

Speaker

If you are giving a mediated presentation, good digital citizenship includes making sure content is appropriate for all audiences, since you cannot ensure who will view the presentation. Keep language and visual aids "clean," without swear words or sexually suggestive content. If your visual aids include video or pictures, make sure that they don't represent illegal behavior, such as underage drinking, drug use, or poor driving habits. Remember, this presentation will help build your digital reputation and may be viewed by future employers. If your presentation includes graphic content by necessity, such as pictures of a medical procedure or photographic evidence to build a legal case, include a warning that the presentation contains graphic content that some viewers may find disturbing.

Audience

If you are an audience member instead of the speaker, you also have the responsibility to be a good digital citizen. If you decide to interact with the speaker, your questions should be intelligent and applicable to the topic. Do not

make fun of or belittle the speaker or start an argument. Although it is appropriate to have a constructive conversation about opposing points of view, trying to discredit the other person or make that person appear foolish is not part of being a good digital citizen.



STUDY GUIDE

MEET YOUR OBJECTIVES

27.1 Describe the basic principles of mediated public speaking.

Mediated public speaking can be synchronous, asynchronous, or hybrid. Consider your target audience, the amorphous audience, whether the audience is public or private, and how to capture your audience's attention. An important aspect of preparing an online presentation is selecting the right technology and setting the stage.

27.2 Discuss how to effectively rehearse for an online presentation.

Your practice session should be as close as possible to the actual event. Ask someone to watch your presentation and provide feedback. Record and analyze your presentation.

27.3 Explain how to effectively deliver an online presentation.

Be familiar with the equipment and software you plan to use. Allow time for several takes.

27.4 Describe the qualities of a good digital citizen.

As a speaker, make sure your content is appropriate for all audiences. Keep language and visual aids "clean." As an audience member, ask intelligent questions that are applicable to the topic. Treat the speaker with respect.

THINK ABOUT THESE QUESTIONS

1. **Self-Assessment** Explain how you would prepare for an online synchronous presentation. How would you set the stage? How would you rehearse?
2. **Ethics Assessment** Under what circumstances would it be ethical to use graphic content in an online presentation?
3. **Critical Assessment** Justice plans to give an online presentation on rock climbing to a group of college students who are interested in trying the sport. What kind of presentation aids should she use to engage her audience? What kind of technology should she use?

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Chapter 27 Mediated Public Speaking

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Glossary

acceptance speech A speech of thanks for an award, nomination, or other honor

accommodation Sensitivity to the feelings, needs, interests, and backgrounds of other people

ad hominem fallacy An attack on irrelevant characteristics of the person who is proposing an idea, rather than an attack on the idea itself

after-dinner speech A humorous presentation, usually delivered in conjunction with a mealtime meeting or banquet

alliteration The repetition of a consonant sound (usually the first consonant) several times in a phrase, clause, or sentence

amorphous audience An audience without a specific size and without specific demographics

analogy A comparison

analysis Examination of the causes, effects, and history of a problem in order to understand it better

analytical listener Someone who prefers messages that are supported with facts and details

andragogy The art and science of teaching adults

androgynous Exhibiting both masculine and feminine characteristics

anecdote An illustration or story

antithesis Opposition, such as that used in parallel two-part sentences in which the second part contrasts in meaning with the first

appeal to misplaced authority Use of the testimony of an expert in a given field to endorse an idea or product for which the expert does not have the appropriate credentials or expertise

articulation The production of clear and distinct speech sounds

asynchronous presentation A presentation that is prerecorded and watched or listened to at a later time

attend To focus on incoming information for further processing

attitude A learned predisposition to respond favorably or unfavorably toward something; likes and dislikes

audience adaptation The process of ethically using information about an audience to adapt one's message so that it is clear and achieves the speaking objective

audience analysis The process of examining information about those who are expected to listen to a speech

award presentation A speech that accompanies the conferring of an award

bandwagon fallacy Faulty reasoning that if everyone else believes something or is doing something, then it must be valid or correct

bar graph A graph in which bars of various lengths represent information

belief An individual's perception of what is true or false

blueprint The central idea of a speech, plus a preview of the main ideas

boom microphone A microphone suspended from a bar and moved to follow the speaker; often used in movies and TV

brainstorming A creative problem-solving technique used to generate ideas

brief illustration An unelaborated example, often only a sentence or two long

built-in microphone A microphone that is integrated into your computer, phone, or tablet

cadence The rhythm of language

causal fallacy A faulty cause-and-effect connection between two things or events

causal reasoning Reasoning in which the relationship between two or more events leads you to conclude that one or more of the events caused the others

cause-and-effect organization Organization that focuses on a situation and its causes or a situation and its effects

central idea A one-sentence statement of what a speech is *about*

ceremonial (epideictic) speech A speech delivered on a special occasion for celebration, thanksgiving, praise, or mourning

channels The visual and auditory means by which a message is transmitted from sender to receiver

charisma Characteristic of a talented, charming, attractive speaker

chart A display that summarizes information by using words, numbers, or images

chronological organization Organization by time or sequence

citation manager Web-based software package for collecting, organizing, and formatting citation information

claim An element of the Toulmin Model of Argument that identifies the conclusion based on evidence

classification A "dictionary definition," constructed by both placing a term in the general class to which it belongs and differentiating it from all other members of that class

clip art Digital or print images that can be used as illustrations in a presentation aid

closed-ended questions Questions that offer alternatives from which to choose, such as true/false, agree/disagree, or multiple-choice

closure The quality of a conclusion that makes a speech "sound finished"

code A verbal or nonverbal symbol for an idea or image

cognitive dissonance The sense of mental discomfort that prompts a person to change when new information conflicts with previously organized thought patterns

commemorative address A speech delivered during ceremonies held in memory of some past event and/or the person or persons involved

commencement address A speech delivered at a graduation or commencement ceremony

common ground Similarities between a speaker and audience members in attitudes, values, beliefs, or behaviors

competent Being informed, skilled, or knowledgeable about one's subject

complexity Arrangement of ideas from simple to more complex

conclusion The logical outcome of a deductive argument, which stems from the major premise and the minor premise

connotation The meaning listeners associate with a word, based on their experience

consensus The support and commitment of all group members for the group's final decision

context The environment or situation in which a speech occurs

credibility An audience's perception of a speaker as competent, knowledgeable, dynamic, and trustworthy

crisis rhetoric Language used by speakers during momentous or overwhelming times

criteria Standards for identifying an acceptable solution to a problem

critical listener Someone who prefers to evaluate messages

critical listening Evaluating the quality of information, ideas, and arguments presented by a speaker

critical thinking Making accurate judgments about the conclusions presented in what you see, hear, and read

culture A learned system of knowledge, behavior, attitudes, beliefs, values, and norms shared by a group of people

data An element of the Toulmin Model of Argument that includes the use of evidence to reach a conclusion

declamation The delivery of an already famous speech

declarative sentence A grammatically complete sentence, rather than a clause, phrase, or question

decode To translate verbal or nonverbal symbols into ideas and images

deductive reasoning Reasoning that moves from a general statement of principle to a specific, certain conclusion

definition A statement about what a term means or how it is applied in a specific instance

demographics Statistical information about people, such as age, race, gender, sexual orientation, educational level, and religious views

denotation The literal meaning of a word

derived credibility The perception of a speaker's credibility that is formed during a speech

description A statement creating a mental image that makes people, places, and events come alive

dialect A consistent style of pronouncing words common to an ethnic group or geographic region

digital citizen A person who uses technology to communicate with others and to participate in society

direct persuasion route Persuasion that occurs when audience members critically examine evidence and arguments

domain Category in which a website is located on the internet, indicated by the last three letters of the site's URL

dynamism An aspect of a speaker's credibility that reflects whether the speaker is perceived as energetic

either–or fallacy The oversimplification of an issue into a choice between only two outcomes or possibilities

elaborate From the standpoint of the elaboration likelihood model (ELM) of persuasion, to think about information, ideas, and issues related to the content of a message

elaboration likelihood model (ELM) of persuasion The theory that people can be persuaded by logic, evidence, and reasoning, or through a more peripheral route that may depend on the credibility of the speaker, the sheer number of arguments presented, or emotional appeals

elocution The expression of emotion through posture, movement, gesture, facial expression, and voice

empowerment Having resources, information, and attitudes that lead to action to achieve a desired goal

encode To translate ideas and images into verbal or nonverbal symbols

ethical speech Speech that is responsible, honest, and tolerant

ethics The beliefs, values, and moral principles by which people determine what is right or wrong

ethnic vernacular A variety of English that includes words and phrases used by a specific ethnic group

ethnicity A social classification that includes such factors as nationality, religion, language, and ancestral heritage shared by a group of people with a common geographic origin

ethnocentrism The assumption that one's own cultural traditions and perspectives are superior to those of others

ethos The term Aristotle used to refer to a speaker's credibility

eulogy A speech of tribute delivered when someone has died

evidence The facts, examples, statistics, and expert opinions used to support a logical conclusion

examples Illustrations used to dramatize or clarify a fact

expert testimony An opinion offered by someone who is an authority on a subject

explanation A statement that clarifies how something is done or why it exists in its present form or existed in its past form

extemporaneous speaking Speaking from a written or memorized general outline without having memorized the exact wording of the speech

extended illustration A detailed example that resembles a story

external noise Physical sounds that interfere with communication

fact Something that has been directly observed to be true or can be proven to be true by verifiable evidence

fake news Reported information that is fabricated

fallacy False reasoning that occurs when someone attempts to persuade without adequate evidence or with arguments that are irrelevant or inappropriate

fear appeal Seeking to motivate or persuade by threatening harm or danger unless action is taken to reduce the harm or danger

feedback Verbal and nonverbal responses provided by an audience to a speaker

figurative analogy A comparison between two essentially dissimilar things that share some common feature on which the comparison depends

figurative language Words that deviate from their ordinary, expected meaning to make a description or comparison unique, vivid, and memorable

final summary A restatement of the main ideas of a speech, occurring near the end of the speech

First Amendment The amendment to the US Constitution guaranteeing free speech; the first of the ten amendments to the US Constitution known collectively as the Bill of Rights

flowchart A diagram that illustrates steps or the sequence in a multistep process

fonts Particular styles of typefaces

free speech The open exchange of information and ideas

gender The culturally constructed and psychologically based perception of one's self as feminine, masculine, or androgynous (a combination of both feminine and masculine traits)

general purpose The overarching goal of a speech—to inform, persuade, or entertain

generalization An all-encompassing statement

graph A pictorial representation of statistical data

hard evidence Factual examples and statistics

hasty generalization A conclusion reached without adequate evidence

hybrid presentations Presentations that combine both live and recorded aspects

hyperbole Exaggeration

hypothetical illustration An example that might happen but that has not actually occurred

illustration A story or anecdote that provides an example of an idea, issue, or problem a speaker is discussing

immediacy The degree of perceived physical or psychological closeness between people

impromptu speaking Delivering a speech without advance preparation

indirect persuasion route Persuasion that occurs as a result of factors peripheral to a speaker's logic and argument, such as the speaker's charisma or emotional appeals

inductive reasoning Reasoning that uses specific instances or examples to reach a general, probable conclusion

inference A conclusion based on partial information or an evaluation that has not been directly observed

inflection The variation in the pitch of the voice

initial credibility The impression of a speaker's credibility that listeners have before the speaker starts a speech

initial preview A statement in the introduction of a speech about what the main ideas of the speech will be

internal noise Physiological or psychological interference with communication

internal preview A statement in the body of a speech that introduces and outlines ideas that will be developed as the speech progresses

internal summary A restatement in the body of a speech of the ideas that have been developed so far

invention The development or discovery of ideas and insights

inversion Reversal of the normal word order of a phrase or sentence

jargon The specialized language of a profession or interest group

keynote address A speech that sets the theme and tone for a meeting or conference

lavaliere microphone A microphone that can be clipped to an article of clothing or worn on a cord around the neck

lay testimony An opinion or description offered by a nonexpert who has firsthand experience

line graph A graph that uses lines or curves to show relationships between two or more variables

listening The process by which receivers select, attend to, understand, remember, and respond to senders' messages

listening styles Preferred ways of making sense out of spoken messages

literal analogy A comparison between two similar things

literary quotation An opinion or description by a writer who speaks in a memorable and often poetic way

logic A formal system of rules for making inferences

logos Literally, "the word"; the term Aristotle used to refer to logic—the formal system of using rules to reach a conclusion

main ideas The key points of a speech

major premise A general statement that is the first element of a syllogism

malapropism The mistaken use of a word that sounds much like the intended word

manuscript speaking Reading a speech from a written text

mediated communication Any communication, written or oral, that uses technology (or another medium) to connect the speaker and the audience

mediated public speaking A speech prepared for and presented to an audience who is not physically present with the speaker

memorized speaking Delivering a speech word for word from memory without using notes

message The content of a speech and the mode of its delivery

metaphor An implied comparison between two things or concepts

minor premise A specific statement about an example that is linked to the major premise; the second element of a syllogism

model A small object that represents a larger object

motivation The internal force that drives people to achieve their goals

myth A story that includes a shared belief based on the underlying values, cultural heritage, and faith of a group of people

nomination speech A speech that officially names someone as a candidate for an office or a position

non sequitur Latin for "it does not follow"; an idea or conclusion that does not logically relate to or follow from the previous idea or conclusion

nonverbal transition A facial expression, vocal cue, or physical movement indicating that a speaker is moving from one idea to the next

omission Leaving out a word or phrase that the listener expects to hear

online databases Subscription-based electronic resources that may offer access to abstracts or the full texts of entries, as well as bibliographic data

onomatopoeia When a word is pronounced like its meaning

open-ended questions Questions that allow for unrestricted answers by not limiting answers to choices or alternatives

operational definition A statement that shows how something works or what it does

opinion Testimony or a quotation that expresses someone's attitudes, beliefs, or values

oral citation The spoken presentation of source information, including the author, title, and year of publication

parallelism Use of the same grammatical pattern for two or more phrases, clauses, or sentences

patchwriting Failing to give credit for phrases taken from another source

pathos The term used by Aristotle to refer to appeals to human emotion

personal illustration An anecdote drawn from the speaker's experience

personification The attribution of human qualities to inanimate things or ideas

persuasion The process of changing or reinforcing a listener's attitudes, beliefs, values, or behavior

picture graph A graph that uses images or pictures to symbolize data

pie graph A circular graph divided into wedges that show each part's percentage of the whole

pitch How high or low a voice sounds

plagiarism Presenting someone else's words or ideas as though they were one's own

podcasts Speeches with audio recording only

prejudice Preconceived opinions, attitudes, and beliefs about a person, place, thing, or message

preliminary bibliography A list of potential resources to be used in the preparation of a speech

preparation outline A detailed outline of a speech that includes the central idea, main ideas, and supporting material; it may also include references, the specific purpose, the introduction, and the conclusion

presentation aid Any image, object, or sound that reinforces your point visually or aurally so that your audience can better understand it

preview A statement of what is to come

primacy Arrangement of ideas from the most to the least important

primary audience The main target audience for a presentation

problem–solution organization Organization focused on a problem and its various solutions or on a solution and the problems it would solve

pronunciation The use of sounds to form words clearly

proposition A statement that summarizes the ideas a speaker wants an audience to agree with

proposition of fact A proposition focusing on whether something is true or false or whether it did or did not happen

proposition of policy A proposition advocating a change in a policy, procedure, or behavior

proposition of value A proposition calling for the listener to judge the worth or importance of something

psychological audience analysis Examining the attitudes, beliefs, values, and other psychological information about an audience to develop a clear and effective message

public speaking The process of presenting a spoken message to an audience

public relations speeches Speeches designed to inform the public, to strengthen alliances with them, and in some cases to recommend policy

pun The use of double meanings to create humor

race A group of people with a common cultural history, nationality, or geographical location who may share some genetically transmitted physical attributes

reasoning The process of drawing a logical conclusion from evidence

receiver A listener or an audience member

recency Arrangement of ideas from the least to the most important

red herring fallacy Irrelevant facts or information used to distract someone from the issue under discussion

reflective thinking A method of structuring a problem-solving discussion that involves (1) identifying and defining the problem, (2) analyzing the problem, (3) generating possible solutions, (4) selecting the best solution, and (5) testing and implementing the solution

regionalisms Words or phrases used uniquely by speakers in one part of a country

relational-oriented listener Someone who is comfortable listening to others express feelings and emotions

relationship An ongoing connection you have with another person

reluctant testimony A statement by someone who has reversed their position on a given issue

remember To recall ideas and information

repetition Use of a key word or phrase more than once for emphasis

respond To react with a change in behavior to a speaker's message

rhetorical criticism The process of using a method or criteria to evaluate the effectiveness and appropriateness of messages

rhetorical question A question intended to provoke thought rather than elicit an answer

screencasting Sharing the speaker's computer screen or desktop with an online audience

secondary audience In a hybrid presentation, anyone who watches the recorded version of the presentation; in an asynchronous presentation, individuals who are not in the target audience

select To single out a message from several competing messages

self-actualization need The need to achieve one's highest potential

sex A person's biological status as male or female, as reflected in their anatomy and reproductive system

signposts Cues about the relationships between a speaker's ideas

simile A comparison between two things that uses the word *like* or *as*

situational audience analysis Examination of the time and place of a speech, the audience size, and the speaking occasion to develop a clear and effective message

slippery slope fallacy A reasoning fallacy claiming that an initial action or proposal will result in further negative consequences.

small group communication Interaction among three to twelve people who share a common purpose, feel a sense of belonging to the group, and influence one another

social judgment theory A theory that categorizes listener responses to a persuasive message according to the latitude of acceptance, the latitude of rejection, or the latitude of noncommitment

socioeconomic status A person's perceived importance and influence based on income, occupation, and education level

soft evidence Supporting material based mainly on opinion or inference; includes hypothetical illustrations, descriptions, explanations, definitions, and analogies

source The public speaker

spatial organization Organization based on location or direction

speaking notes A brief outline used when a speech is delivered

specific purpose A concise statement of the desired audience response, indicating what you want your listeners to remember, feel, or do when you finish speaking

speech act A behavior, such as flag burning, that is viewed by law as nonverbal communication and is subject to the same protections and limitations as verbal speech

speech to inform A speech that teaches others new information, ideas, concepts, principles, or processes to enhance their knowledge or understanding about something

speech of introduction A speech that provides information about another speaker

spoonerism A phrase in which the initial sounds of words are switched

stacks The shelves where collections of books are stored in a library

Standard American English (SAE) The English taught in the United States by schools and used in media, business, and government

standard outline formatting Numbered and lettered headings and subheadings arranged hierarchically and indented to indicate the relationships among parts of a speech

stationary microphone A microphone attached to a lectern, sitting on a desk, or standing on the floor

statistics Numerical data

storyboard A simple visual or graphic representation of the ideas and images that will be used to support a message

supporting material Material used to clarify, support, and develop a speech's major ideas

summary A recap of what has been said

suspension Withholding a key word or phrase until the end of a sentence

syllogism A three-part argument that consists of a major premise, a minor premise, and a conclusion

synchronous presentation A presentation that takes place in real time

target audience A specific segment of an audience that you most want to influence

task-oriented listener Someone who prefers information that is well organized, brief, and precise

terminal credibility The final impression listeners have of a speaker's credibility after a speech concludes

toast A brief salute to a momentous occasion

topical organization Arrangement of the natural divisions in a central idea according to recency, primacy, complexity, or the speaker's discretion

Toulmin Model of Argument A model that identifies the key elements in an argument as the data, claim, and warrant

transition A verbal or nonverbal signal indicating that a speaker has finished discussing one idea and is moving to another

trustworthiness An aspect of a speaker's credibility that reflects whether the speaker is perceived as being believable and honest

understand To assign meaning to the information to which you attend

understatement A statement downplaying a fact or event

value An enduring concept of good and bad, right and wrong

verbal irony A statement that expresses the exact opposite of the intended meaning

verbal transition A word or phrase that indicates the relationship between two ideas

vertical search engine A website that indexes World Wide Web information in a specific field

visual rhetoric The use of images as an integrated element in the total communication effort a speaker makes to achieve a speaking goal

vodcasts Speeches with audio and images or video clips

volume The softness or loudness of a speaker's voice

warrant An element of the Toulmin Model of Argument that provides the logical connection between the data (evidence) and claim (conclusion) in an argument

wit Verbal means of relating an incident or a statement so that it concludes in an unexpected way

word picture A vivid description that appeals to the senses

working memory theory of listening A theory suggesting that listeners find it difficult to concentrate and remember when their short-term working memories are full

written citation The print presentation of source information, including the author, title, and year of publication, usually formatted according to a conventional style guide

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